

ደብረ ብርሃን ዩኒቨርሲቲ
Debre Berhan University

Practical Education For a Better Success!

የተግባር ሕዝባዊ ክብርት!

Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)

Standard Operating Procedures

FIRST VERSION

NOVEMBER, 2025

P.O. Box 445

Tel: 251 118697147 /251 118494102 Fax: 011-681-20-65

Email: AWHSC-IRB@dbu.edu.et

DEBRE BIRHAN, ETHIOPIA

List of AWHSC-IRB SOPs

No_	List of SOPs	Code
1.	Preparing Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and Guidelines for Research Ethics Board	
1.1.	Writing Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)	AWHSC-IRB-001
1.2.	Preparation of Guidelines	AWHSC-IRB-002
2.	Constituting Ethics Board	
2.1.	Constituting Institutional Review Board committee	AWHSC-IRB-003
2.2.	Confidentiality / Conflict of Interest Agreements	AWHSC-IRB-004
2.3.	Training Personnel and IRB Members	AWHSC-IRB-005
2.4.	Selection of Independent Consultants	AWHSC-IRB-006
3.	Initial Review Procedures	
3.1.	Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB-007
3.2.	Use of Study Assessment Form	AWHSC-IRB-008
3.3.	Initial Review of Submitted Protocol	AWHSC-IRB-009
3.4.	Expedited Review	AWHSC-IRB-010
3.5.	Review of New Medical Device Studies/Evaluation	AWHSC-IRB-011
4.	Protocol Amendments, Continuing Review, and End of Study	
4.1.	Review of Protocol Amendments	AWHSC-IRB-012
4.2.	Review of resubmitted Protocol	AWHSC-IRB-013
4.3.	Continuing Review of Study Protocol	AWHSC-IRB-014
4.4.	Review of Final Reports	AWHSC-IRB-015
5.	Monitoring Protocol Implementation	
5.1.	Non-Compliance/Violation Intervention	AWHSC-IRB-016
5.2.	Response to Research Participants' Requests	AWHSC-IRB-017
5.3.	Management of Study Termination	AWHSC-IRB-018
6.	Monitoring and Evaluation of Adverse Events	

6.1.	Review of Safety Report (Serious Adverse Event (SAE), Unanticipated events, Protocol Deviation Reports	AWHSC-IRB-019
7.	Site Monitoring	
7.1.	Site Monitoring Visits	AWHSC-IRB-020
8.	Preparation of Review Meeting Agenda and Communication Records	
8.1.	Agenda Preparation, Meeting Procedure and Minutes	AWHSC-IRB-021
8.2.	Emergency Meeting	AWHSC-IRB-022
8.3.	Communication Records	AWHSC-IRB-023
9.	Managing Study Files	
9.1.	Maintenance of Active Study Files	AWHSC-IRB-024
9.2.	Archive and Retrieval of Documents	AWHSC-IRB-025
9.3.	Maintaining Confidentiality of AWHSC-IRB's Documents	AWHSC-IRB-026
10.	Auditing and Inspection of the IRB	AWHSC-IRB-027
11.	Glossary of Terms and Definitions	AWHSC-IRB-028

Acknowledgement

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) document was produced with the SOP teams of AWHSC-IRB, Debre Berhan University. During preparation different relevant documents from National Research Ethics Review Board and other sources were used. The following individuals are gratefully acknowledged for their dedication and hard work.

S.N	Name	Specialization	Role
1.	Mr. Eyosiyas Yeshialem	Reproductive Health	IRB member
2.	Dr. Awraris Hailu		IRB member
3.	Dr. Ermyas Endwnetu	Internal Medicine	IRB member
4.	Dr. Tizazu Zenebe	Medical Microbiology	IRB member
5.	Mis. Tesfanesh Lemma	Maternity Health Nursing	IRB member
6.	Mr. Desal Abate	Clinical Pharmacy	IRB member
7.	Mr. Birhan Tsegaw	Clinical Midwifery	IRB member
8.	Mr. Yonas Urge	Medical Physiology	IRB member



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
1.1.Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	Page 4 of 13

Table of Contents

Contents

1. Purpose.....	5
2. Scope.....	5
3. Responsibility	5
3.1. Secretariat of IRB/SECRETARIAT :	5
3.2. SOP team:.....	6
3.3. Chairperson/ Coordinator of the IRB:	6
3.4. IRB members and involved administrative staff:	6
4. Flow chart	6
5. Detailed instructions	7
5.1. List all relevant SOPs	7
5.2. Format and layout.....	7
5.3. Write and approve a new/revised SOP	8
5.4. Implement, distribute and file all SOPs.....	8
5.5. Review and revise an existing SOP	8
5.6. Manage and archive superseded SOPs	9
6. Glossary	9
7. Annex	10
8. References.....	11
Annex 1: List of AWHSC-IRB SOPs.....	12
Annex 2: SOP main contents and definitions	14
Annex 3: Document History	15
Annex 4: Log of SOP Recipients.....	16
Annex 5: Request for Revision of an SOP	17



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
1.1.Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	Page 5 of 13

1. Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the process for writing, reviewing, distributing and amending SOPs within the Institutional Review Board (IRB) of Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus (AWHSC). The SOPs will provide clear, unambiguous instructions so that the related activities in the IRB are conducted in accordance with the WHO Operating Guidelines for IRB that Review Biomedical Research, International guidelines for Biomedical research involving human subjects (Council for International Organizations of Medical Science), National Research Ethics Review Guideline, ICH (International Conferences on Harmonization), and Good Clinical Practice (GCP).

2. Scope

This SOP covers the procedures of writing, reviewing, distributing and amending SOPs within the IRB of AWHSC.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the Secretariat of IRB/Scientific Ethical Review Office (SECRETARIAT) to appoint the SOP Team to formulate the SOPs by following the same procedures, format, and coding system when drafting or editing any SOP of the institute.

3.1.Secretariat of IRB/Secretariat:

- Coordinates activities of writing, reviewing, distributing and amending SOPs
- Maintains on file all current SOPs and the list of SOPs
- Maintains an up-to-date distribution list for each SOP distributed
- Distributes the SOPs with a receipt to all users
- Ensures all IRB members and involved administrative staff have access to the SOPs
- Ensures the IRB members and involved staff are working according to current versions of SOPs



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
1.1. Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	Page 6 of 13

3.2. SOP team:

- Proposes required SOPs
- Selects the format and coding system
- Drafts the SOP in consultation with IRB members and involved administrative staff
- Assesses the request for SOP revision in consultation with the Secretariat/ and Chairperson

3.3. Chairperson/ Officer of the IRB:

- Reviews and approves the SOPs
- Signs and dates receipt of the approved SOPs

3.4. IRB members and involved administrative staff:

- Sign and date when they receive the approved SOPs
- Maintain a file of all SOPs received
- Return all out-of-dated SOPs to IRB Secretariat

4. Flow chart

No	Activity	Responsibility
1	List all relevant SOPs ↓	SOP Team
2	Design a format and layout ↓	SOP Team
3	Write and approve a new/revised SOPs ↓	SOP Team and Chair person
4.	Endorsement of SOPs ↓	Campus CED
5	Implement, distribute and file all SOPs	IRB Secretariat



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
1.1. Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	Page 7 of 13

	↓	
6	Review and revise existing SOPs ↓	SOP Team /IRB members/
7	Manage and archive superseded SOPs	Administrative staff/ IRB Coordinator

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. List all relevant SOPs

- Write down step by step all IRB procedures.
- Organize, divide and name each process.
- Make a list of SOPs with coding reference, effectively and expiry dates (Annex AWHSC-IRB AF 01-001/01.1)

5.2. Format and layout

Each SOP should be given a number and a title that is self-explanatory and is easily understood. A unique code number with the format AWHSC-IRB SOP/XXX/YY.W will be assigned to each SOP item by Secretariat/SECRETARIAT. XXX is a three-digit number assigned specifically to the SOP. YY is a two-digit number identifying the version of the SOP and W is a one-digit number identifying the version of SOP with minor changes in the SOP. The number of version should be started from 01 and the W should be started with 0, for example, AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.0 is the SOP number 001 version 01 with zero minor revision ie. 01.0.

Each Annex will be given unique code number with the format AWHSC-IRB AF BB-XXX/YY.W. AF is the abbreviation for Annex Form, BB is a two-digit number identifying the number of the annex, for example AWHSC-IRB AF 01-001/01.0 means Annex Form number one of the AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.0

Each SOP will be prepared according to the standard template. Please refer to Annex 2 – AWHSC-IRB AF 02-001/01.0. Each SOP will contain standard structure containing Purpose,



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
1.1. Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	Page 8 of 13

Scope, Responsibility, Flow Chart, and Detailed instructions, Glossary, Reference and Annex (See Annex 3 AWHSC-IRB AF 03-001/01.1).

5.3. Write and approve a new/revised SOP

If an SOP supersedes a previous version, indicate the previous SOP version and the main changes in the historical form (Annex 4 – AWHSC-IRB AF 04-001/01.1). When the need for a new SOP has been identified and agreed on, a draft will be written by a designated member of the SOP team. The draft SOP will be discussed with IRB members and all relevant administrative staff. The SOP should be agreed upon by the people involved in that particular task. The final version will be passed to the Chairperson for review and approval; and chief executive director for endorsement.

5.4. Implement, distribute and file all SOPs

The approved SOPs will be implemented from the effective date. The approved SOPs will be distributed to the IRB members and the relevant staff by the Secretariat according to the distribution list (Annex 5 – AWHSC-IRB AF 05-001/01.1). The SOP will also be uploaded into the university website. When revised version is distributed, the old version will be retrieved and destroyed. One complete original set of current SOPs will be filed centrally in the SOP Master file, by the Secretariat of the IRB and keep the file in the Secretariat office.

5.5. Review and revise an existing SOP

Any member of the IRB, Secretariat or administrative staff who notices an inconsistency between two SOPs or has any suggestions on how to improve a procedure should use the form in Annex 6 – AWHSC-IRB AF 06-001/01.1) to make a request. If the SOP Team agrees with the request, an appropriate team will be designated to proceed with the revision process. If the IRB does not agree, the chairperson will inform the person who made the request of the decision. Revision of the SOPs will be reviewed and approved in the same manner as new SOPs (section 5.3). The Secretariat office will identify issues that require minor changes and submit to the IRB for approval and endorsement. The Secretariat is expected to organize the SOP review team to revise the SOPs



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
1.1. Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	Page 9 of 13

within a maximum of three years following endorsement by the Chief Executive Director of the campus and record the dates of review on the SOP Master file.

5.6. Manage and archive superseded SOPs

- Superseded SOPs should be retained and clearly marked “superseded” and archived in the historical file by the Secretariat.

6. Glossary

IRB members	Individuals serving as regular and alternate members on the institute’s operational boards (i.e., IRB membership). These boards are constituted in accordance with the EC membership requirements set forth in ICH GCP.
SOP	Detailed, written instructions, in a certain format, describe all activities and action undertaken by an organization to achieve uniformity of the performance of a specific function. The aim of the SOPs and their accompanying checklists and forms is to simplify the organization and documentation of operation, whilst maintaining high standards of Good Clinical Practice.
SOP Team	A selected IRB of the campus members and administrative staff who oversee the creation, preparation, review and periodic revision of the institute SOPs.
Master SOP files	An official collection of the institute standard operating procedures (SOP) accessible to all staff, IRB members, students, auditors and government inspectors as a paper copy with an official stamp on each page and the approval signatures. Photocopies made from these official paper versions of the SOP cannot be considered current or official.
SOP historical files	A collection of previous official versions of a SOP, table of contents, relevant information regarding changes and all pre-planned deviations.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
1.1.Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	Page 10 of 13

7. Annexes

Annex 1 AWHSC 01-001 List of AWHSC-IRB SOPs

Annex 2 AWHSC 02-001 Standard Operating Procedures Template

Annex 3 AWHSC 03-001 Document History

Annex 4 AWHSC 04-001 Log of SOP Recipients

Annex 5 AWHSC 05-001 Request for Revision of an SOP



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
1.1.Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	Page 11 of 13

8. References

1. World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.
2. International Council for Harmonization of Technical Requirements for Pharmaceuticals for Human Use, Guidance for Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) E6(R2), 2016.
3. Relevant National and International Guidelines for Ethical Review IRB that Review Biomedical Research (Geneva 2000) www.who.int/tdr/publications/publications/ - accessed 11 February 2005)
4. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
5. National Health Research Ethics Review Guideline. Addis Ababa, Ethiopia. 4th Edition revised in June 2005
6. Drug Administration and Control Authority of Ethiopia www.daca.gov.et/Documents/GCP-narreted.pdf
7. National Research Ethics Review Technical guidelines. FDRE Ministry of Education. June, 2022.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 1.1. Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 12 of 13

Annex 1: List of AWHSC-IRB SOPs

(AWHSC-IRB AF 01-001/01.1)

No_	List of SOPs	Code	Version	Effective date
1.	Preparing Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and Guidelines for Research Ethics Board		01.1	November 2025
1.1.	Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures	AWHSC-IRB-001	01.1	November 2025
1.2.	Preparation of Guidelines	AWHSC-IRB-002	01.1	November 2025
2.	Constituting Ethics Board		01.1	November 2025
2.1.	Constituting Institutional Review Board committee	AWHSC-IRB-003	01.1	November 2025
2.2.	Confidentiality / Conflict of Interest Agreements	AWHSC-IRB-004	01.1	November 2025
2.3.	Training Personnel and IRB Members	AWHSC-IRB-005	01.1	November 2025
2.4.	Selection of Independent Consultants	AWHSC-IRB-006	01.1	November 2025
3.	Initial Review Procedures			November 2025
3.1.	Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB-007	01.1	November 2025
3.2.	Use of Study Assessment Form	AWHSC-IRB-008	01.1	November 2025
3.3.	Expedited Review	AWHSC-IRB-009	01.1	November 2025
3.4.	Initial Review of Submitted Protocol	AWHSC-IRB-010	01.1	November 2025
3.5.	Review of New Medical Device Studies/Evaluation	AWHSC-IRB-011	01.1	November 2025
4.	Protocol Amendments, Continuing Review, and End of Study			November 2025
4.1.	Review of Protocol Amendments	AWHSC-IRB-012	01.1	November 2025
4.2.	Review of resubmitted Protocol	AWHSC-IRB-013	01.1	November 2025
4.3.	Continuing Review of Study Protocol	AWHSC-IRB-014	01.1	November 2025
4.4.	Review of Final Reports	AWHSC-IRB-015	01.1	November 2025
5.	Monitoring Protocol Implementation			November 2025
5.1.	Non-Compliance/Violation Intervention	AWHSC-IRB-016	01.1	November 2025



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 1.1. Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 13 of 13
---	---

5.2.	Response to Research Participants' Requests	AWHSC-IRB-017	01.1	November 2025
5.3.	Management of Study Termination	AWHSC-IRB-018	01.1	November 2025
6.	Monitoring and Evaluation of Adverse Events			November 2025
6.1.	Review of Safety Report (Serious Adverse Event (SAE), Unanticipated events, Protocol Deviation Reports	AWHSC-IRB-019	01.1	November 2025
7.	Site Monitoring			November 2025
7.1.	Site Monitoring Visits	AWHSC-IRB-020	01.1	November 2025
8.	Preparation of Review Meeting Agenda and Communication Records		01.1	November 2025
8.1.	Agenda Preparation, Meeting Procedure and Minutes	AWHSC-IRB-021	01.1	November 2025
8.2.	Emergency Meeting	AWHSC-IRB-022	01.1	November 2025
8.3.	Communication Records	AWHSC-IRB-023	01.1	November 2025
9.	Managing Study Files			November 2025
9.1.	Maintenance of Active Study Files	AWHSC-IRB-024	01.1	November 2025
9.2.	Archive and Retrieval of Documents	AWHSC-IRB-025	01.1	November 2025
9.3.	Maintaining Confidentiality of AWHSC-IRB's Documents	AWHSC-IRB-026	01.1	November 2025
10.	Auditing and Inspection of the IRB	AWHSC-IRB-027	01.1	November 2025
11.	Glossary of Terms and Definitions	AWHSC-IRB-028	01.1	November 2025



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 1.1. Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 14 of 13
---	---

Annex 2: SOP main contents and definitions

(AWHSC-IRB AF 02-001/01.1)

1. **Administrative staff:** - Technical staff working for AWHSC-IRB Secretariat office
2. **Purpose:** - summarizes and explains the objectives of the procedure.
3. **Scope:** – states the range of activities that the SOP applies to.
4. **Responsibility** – refers to person(s) assigned to perform the activities involved in the SOP
5. **Flow chart:** – simplifies the procedures in step-by-step sequence and states clearly the responsible person(s) or position for each activity
6. **Detailed instructions:** – describe procedures step by step in short and clear phrases or sentences. Split a long sentence into shorter ones.
7. **Glossary:** – clarifies uncommon or ambiguous words or phrases by explanation.
7. **References:** – lists sources of the information given in the SOP.
8. **Annex:** - documents that explain further or clarifies complex descriptions.
 “Description-by-example” is always recommended to avoid difficult texts which may be hard to understand.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
1.1. Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	Page 15 of 13

Annex 3: Document History

(AWHSC-IRB AF 03-001/01.1)

The first draft for version 01.0 of AWHSC-IRB SOP history is the output of the first circulation of the document and the final version is the version after the approval by the Chairperson; and endorsement by the Chief Executive Director.

Authors	Version	Date	Describe The Main Change
	0.1	20-01-2025	First Draft
	0.2	05-02-2025	Second Draft
	01.1	01-03-2025	Final Version



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 1.1. Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 16 of 13
---	---

Annex 4: Log of SOP Recipients

(AWHSC-IRB AF 04-001/01.1)

No.	Name of Recipients	SOP#	No. of Copies	Signature	Date
1.		SOP/001/01.1 SOP/002/01.1 SOP/011/01.1			
2.		SOP/003/01.1 SOP/004/01.1 SOP/005/01.1 SOP/006/01.1			
3.		SOP/007/01.1 SOP/008/01.1 SOP/009/01.1 SOP/010/01.1			
4.		SOP/012/01.1 SOP/013/01.1 SOP/014/01.1 SOP/015/01.1			
5.		SOP/016/01.1 SOP/017/01.1 SOP/018/01.1			
6.		SOP/019/01.1 SOP/020/01.1 SOP/027/01.1 SOP/028/01.1			
7.		SOP/021/01.1 SOP/022/01.1 SOP/023/01.1			
8.		SOP/024/01.1 SOP/025/01.1 SOP/026/01.1			



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/001/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
1.1. Writing, Reviewing, Distributing and Amending Standard Operating Procedures for IRB	Page 17 of 13

Annex 5: Request for Revision of an SOP (AWHSC-IRB AF 06-001/01.1)

Please complete this form whenever a problem or a deficiency in an SOP is identified and maintained with the SOP until an authorized replacement is in place.

AWHSC-IRB 001/01.1	
Title:	Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus -Institutional Review Board SOPs (AWHSC-IRB SOPs) November 2025, First Edition
Details of problems or deficiency in the SOP:	
Identified by:	Date (DD/MM/YYYY):
Discussed with:	
SOP revision required: ☐ Yes ☐ No	
If yes, to be carried out by whom?	
If no, why not?	
Date SOP approved:	DD/MM/YYYY
Date SOP becomes effective:	DD/MM/YYYY



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/002/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/12/2025</u> Page 1 of 9
1.2. Preparation of Guidelines	

Table of Contents

1. Purpose	2
2. Scope	2
3. Responsibility.....	2
4. Flow chart.....	2
5. Detailed instructions.....	3
5.1. Numbering of the Guidelines.....	3
5.2. Numbering of the Version.....	3
5.3. Contents and Layout of a Guideline	3
5.3.1. Cover Page.....	3
5.3.2. Table of Contents.....	4
5.3.3. Main Text.....	4
5.3.4. Appendices	4
5.4. Approval of New and Updated Guidelines	4
5.5. Information for Personnel	4
5.6. Distribution of Guidelines.....	4
6. Glossary	5
7. References.....	5
8. ANNEXS	5
Annex 1: Cover Page of a Guideline	6
Annex 2: List of Signatures	8
Annex 3: Log of Guideline Distribution	9



1.2. Preparation of Guidelines

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how to prepare a new guideline or update an existing one as well as the layout and format of each guideline.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to any IRB guidelines and their amendment versions published and distributed by the institute. The Institutional Review Board (IRB) of the AWHSC works according to internal rules that must be described in written standard operating procedures (SOPs). The approved SOP will be uploaded into the university Webpage.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the IRB and/or Secretariat and/or designated persons to prepare or amend the Institute guidelines as and when the need arises. The designated persons will manage the preparation/amendment of the guidelines with the assistance of the Secretariat.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1.	Numbering of Guidelines ↓	IRB Secretariat
2.	Numbering of the Version ↓	IRB Secretariat
3.	Contents and Layout of a Guideline ↓	IRB and/or Secretariat
4.	Drafting of Guideline ↓	IRB and/or Secretariat and/or designated persons
5.	Approval of New and Updated Guidelines ↓	IRB Chairperson
6.	Endorsement of approved guideline ↓	Chief Executive director
7.	Information for Personnel ↓	IRB Secretariat
8.	Distribution of Guidelines	IRB Secretariat



1.2. Preparation of Guidelines

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Numbering of the Guidelines

- Procedure AWHSC-IRB SOP/002/1.1 lists all procedures and guidelines used by the IRB of the institute
- When a new guideline will be created, a subsequent number should be allocated at the end of the list of existing Guidelines
- When a guideline is no longer used, its status is changed to “inactive.” It is not allowed to reuse the guideline number of an inactive guideline
- All guidelines are named and numbered in the following format: GL# AWHSC-IRB 01/XX. W to GL#AWHSC-IRB 99/XX. W (XX Guideline number, W- version number)

5.2. Numbering of the Version

➤ Number guideline versions as follows:

• Draft versions:

All draft versions are always indicated as “version 1.0” followed by the word “draft”

For example: Version 1.0, draft

• For minor changes on a final version:

Version V.0, final to Version V.n, final

For example, the third update concerning minor issues on “version 2.2, final” will be indicated as “version 2.3, final”

• For major changes on a final version:

Version V.n, final to Version (V+1).0, final be indicated as “version 2.3, final”. (n –number

For example, major changes on “version 2.3, final” will be indicated as “version 3.0, final.”

5.3. Contents and Layout of a Guideline

A new or updated guideline has five sections:

1. Cover Page
2. Table of Contents
3. Main text
4. References
5. Appendices

Sections 1 to 4 are mandatory. The “Appendices” section is not mandatory.

5.3.1. Cover Page

The cover page will have the following information:

- Logo of DBU-AWHSC and related information (address, telephone number, fax number, email address, Facebook address, tweeter address)
- Title, number of the guideline and date of implementation of the guideline
- Date of the previous issues. If not applicable, the date of pervious issue is indicated by “N/A” (= not applicable)
- Name (directory names and path included) of the corresponding computer document, if relevant.
- Name of the editors and address of the contact office.



1.2. Preparation of Guidelines

- A copyright declaration.
- Refer to Annex (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-002/01.1) for an example of a cover page.

5.3.2. Table of Contents

- The table of contents lists all major headers and subheadings of the guideline, including the appendices and page numbers on which these appear in the guideline.

5.3.3. Main Text

- Introduction
- Summarize and explain the purpose of the guideline
- A short note on how the guideline was prepared
- A short note on how to use the guideline

Detailed description

- The final text should be short and clear.
- Long guidelines should be split into shorter ones.
- Wherever possible and relevant references should be added
- Limitation of the guidelines may be mentioned

5.3.4. Appendices

- Replace long and complex descriptions.
- “Descriptions-by-example” are always recommended to avoid writing difficult and hard to understand texts.
- Glossary
- Full form of abbreviations

5.4. Approval of New and Updated Guidelines

- The members of the IRB shall prepare a new guideline or update an existing guideline.
 - The Chairperson of the IRB and the Research Director of the Institute should approve and endorse respectively each new or updated guideline.

5.5. Information for Personnel

- All members of the IRB must read and understand a new or updated guideline
 - Each member will sign a form indicating that they have read and understood each new or updated guideline
- If the guideline is for investigators/students/institute personnel then they should be given a copy of the guideline after taking their signature

5.6. Distribution of Guidelines



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/002/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/12/2025</u> Page 5 of 9
1.2. Preparation of Guidelines	

- Guidelines are not confidential and may be disclosed for use by investigators, scientific experts and IRB members.
- A Log of Guideline Distribution should be maintained for inventory records (Annex 3, AWHSC-IRB AF 03-025/2.1).

6. Glossary

Guideline Any suggestion, rules, etc., intended as a guide for specific practice

7. References

1. World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.
2. International Council for Harmonization of Technical Requirements for Pharmaceuticals for Human Use, Guidance for Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) E6(R2), 2016.

8. Annexes



1.2. Preparation of Guidelines

Annex 1: Cover Page of a Guideline

(AWHSC-IRB AF 01-002/1.1)

GL#1

AWHSC-IRB XX.W (*First Edition*)

AWHSC

Institutional Review Board (IRB)

Address:

Institutional Review Board

AWHSC, Debre Berhan University

Debre Berhan, Ethiopia

Telephone: +

E-mail: AWHSC-IRB@dbu.edu.et



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)

AWHSC-IRB SOP/002/01.1
Effective Date: 30/12/2025
Page 7 of 9

1.2. Preparation of Guidelines

Information on the back of the cover page

Number of copies printed:

Title of the Guideline:

Version No:

Month/Year of Publication

ISBN:

Author:

Editor:

Publisher:

Computer Record:



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/002/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/12/2025</u> Page 8 of 9
1.2. Preparation of Guidelines	

Annex 2: List of Signatures

(AWHSC-IRB 02-002/01.1)

Title of the Guideline:

Number of the Guideline: GL# AWHSC-IRB XX.W (XX Guideline number, W-version number)

The following listed persons with their signatures have read this guideline.

No	Full number of IRB members	Signature	Date
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			
6.			
7.			
8.			
9.			



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/002/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/12/2025</u> Page 9 of 9
1.2. Preparation of Guidelines	

Annex 3: Log of Guideline Distribution

(AWHSC-IRB AF 03-002/01.1)

#	Name of participants	Affiliation	Guideline #	Number of copies	Dates



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/003/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 10 of 9
2.1. Constituting an Ethics Committee	

Table of Contents

1. Purpose.....	11
2. Scope.....	11
3. Responsibility	11
4. Flow Chart	11
5.1 Ethical basis.....	13
5.2 Composition of the AWHSC-IRB	14
5.3 Membership requirements.....	14
5.4 Resignation, Disqualification, Replacement of Members	15
5.5 Independent Consultants.....	15
5.6 Conditions of Appointment.....	16
5.7 Officers.....	16
5.8 Secretariat	16
5.9 Roles and responsibilities of AWHSC-IRB members.....	17
5.10 Quorum Requirements	17
5.11 Dissolving of the AWHSC-IRB.....	18
6. Glossary	9
7. References.....	9



2.1. Constituting an Ethics Committee

1. Purpose

The AWHSC-IRB was established in 2021 and has been functioning since then to provide independent guidance, advice, and decision (in the form of “approval/recommendation/stipulation/ disapproval”) on health research or other specific research protocols involving human subjects. These guidelines will provide an additional tool to improve the activities of the AWHSC-IRB.

The AWHSC-IRB is composed of both scientists and community representatives. It is independent in its reflection, advice, and decision.

These standard operating procedures describe the Terms of Reference (TOR) which provide the framework for constitution, responsibilities and activities of the AWHSC-IRB. The TOR is further supported by the Standard Operating Procedures of AWHSC-IRB.

2. Scope

The SOP applies to all activities under the AWHSC IRB

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the AWHSC-IRB members, and Secretariat to read understand and respect the rules set by the AWHSC-IRB

4. Flow Chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1.	Ethical basis/Guidelines ⇓	AWHSC-IRB Members, Secretariat
2.	Composition of the AWHSC-IRB ⇓	AWHSC-IRB Members and Secretariat, AWHSC Chief Executive Director
3.	Membership Requirements ⇓	AWHSC-IRB Members and Secretariat
4.	Resignation, Disqualification, of Members Replacement	AWHSC-IRB Members and Secretariat, AWHSC- executive

2.1. Constituting an Ethics Committee

	↓	director
5.	Independent Consultants with Recommendation or Invitation letter ↓	AWHSC-IRB members and Secretariat AWHSC- executive director
6.	Conditions of Appointment ↓	AWHSC-IRB members and Secretariat
7.	Officers ↓	AWHSC-IRB Chairperson
8.	Secretariat ↓	AWHSC-IRB secretary
9.	Quorum Requirements ↓	AWHSC-IRB members and Secretariat
10.	Dissolving of the AWHSC-IRB	AWHSC-IRB members and Secretariat



5. Detailed Instructions

5.1 Ethical basis

- The AWHSC-IRB recognizes that the protocols it approves may also be approved by national and/or local ethics IRBs prior to their implementation in specific localities.
- In evaluating protocols and ethical issues, the AWHSC-IRB is aware of the diversity of laws, cultures and practices governing research and medical practices in various countries around the world and within the country itself.
- It attempts to inform itself where possible of the requirements and conditions of the various localities where proposed AWHSC-IRB research is being considered.
- The AWHSC-IRB also seeks to be informed, as appropriate, by national/local ethics IRBs and researchers of the impact of the research it has approved.
- The AWHSC-IRB is guided in its reflection, advice, and decision by the ethical principles expressed in the Declaration of Helsinki (1964 and subsequent revisions).
- It makes further reference to the National and International Ethical Guidelines for Biomedical Research Involving Human Subjects (CIOMS), the Belmont Report, and the European Convention on Human Rights and Biomedicine.
- The AWHSC-IRB establishes its own standard operating procedures based on the Operational Guidelines for Ethics IRBs That Review Biomedical Research (WHO), the WHO & ICH Guidelines for Good Clinical Practice and the local regulations.
- The AWHSC-IRB seeks to fulfill the requirements for international assurances and is established and functions in accordance with the national law and regulations according to the most recent guidelines.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/003/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 14 of 9
2.1. Constituting an Ethics Committee	

5.2 Composition of the AWHSC-IRB

- The AWHSC-IRB is composed of **at least 9 voting members**
- The members should have various backgrounds to promote complete and adequate review of research activities commonly conducted by the campus.
- Shall have members with professional competence and mix of varying backgrounds, gender representation, a community representative, research ethics training and experience
- Members who have been worked at department/school IRB will have an added value during recruitment of new membership to replace IRB members whose term is over.
- Consultants to support AWHSC-IRB (consultants will be non-voters, but signed confidentiality agreement)
- The AWHSC-IRB cannot consist entirely of men or entirely of women.
- The AWHSC-IRB should have representatives from the older and younger generations.

5.3 Membership requirements

- New members will be nominated by members of AWHSC-IRB and approved by a full board meeting
- The chief executive Director of AWHSC is responsible for handling the appointment of IRB members proposed by the AWHSC-IRB
- Members are selected in their personal capacities, based on their interest, ethical and/or scientific training, knowledge and expertise, as well as on their commitment and willingness to volunteer the necessary time and effort for the AWHSC-IRB work.
- Members must disclose in writing any interest or involvement – financial, professional, or otherwise – in a project or proposal under consideration.
- The AWHSC-IRB will decide the extent to which members that might have a conflict of interest may participate in bringing out an advice/decision; refer to AWHSC-IRB SOP/004/ - Confidentiality / Conflict of Interest Agreement.



2.1. Constituting an Ethics Committee

- Members will be required to sign a confidentiality agreement at the start of their term.
- The confidentiality agreement protects the privacy and confidentiality of all parties whose information may be disclosed to the AWHSC-IRB in the course of its work.
- Members are appointed for a period of 2 years.
- Their appointments may be renewed by the Director of the campus for up to two consecutive terms.
- The AWHSC-IRB will include some rotation after a period of two-year for up to two consecutive terms, but it will also strive to ensure continuity within the AWHSC-IRB by staggering replacement of members.

5.4 Resignation, Disqualification, Replacement of Members

- Members may resign their positions by submitting a letter of resignation to the Chairperson.
- Members may also be disqualified from continuance. The Chairperson should provide written arguments to the (other) members and there should be unanimous agreement.
- Members that have resigned or have been disqualified may be replaced by selection and appointment of new members proposed by the IRB.

5.5 Independent Consultants

- Independent Consultants may further support the AWHSC-IRB in its reflections on specific protocols or requests for advice on specific ethical issues.
- Independent Consultants are proposed by the IRB and approved by AWHSC-IRB Chairperson. The selected Independent Consultants will then be appointed by the AWHSC chief executive Director.
- Their professional qualifications may be in the areas of community and/or patient representation, medicine, statistics, social science, law, ethics, and religion. Independent Consultants are appointed for the duration of the period sought (see AWHSC-IRB SOP/006/01.0)



**Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)**

AWHSC-IRB SOP/003/01.1
Effective Date: 30/11/2025
Page 16 of 9

2.1. Constituting an Ethics Committee

5.6 Conditions of Appointment

- Members and Independent Consultants are appointed to the AWHSC-IRB under the following conditions:
 - Willingness to publicize his/her full name, profession, and affiliation;
 - All financial accountability, reimbursement for work and expenses, if any, within or related to the AWHSC-IRB should be recorded and made available to the public upon request;
 - All AWHSC-IRB members and Independent Consultants must sign Confidentiality / Conflict of Interest Agreements regarding meeting deliberations, applications, information on research participants, and related matters.

5.7 Officers

- The following officers through their respective responsibilities contribute to the good functioning of the AWHSC-IRB:
 - **Chairperson**
 - Responsible to chair the meetings and liaise directly with the chief executive director of AWHSC report the meeting outcomes to the director, invite independent consultant to provide special expertise to the AWHSC-IRB on proposed research protocol
 - **Vice-Chairperson**
 - Responsible to chair the meetings in the absence of the Chairperson and act as vice-chair during meetings with the Chairperson
 - **Secretariat**
 - Responsible for the administrative aspect of the AWHSC-IRB (see 5.8 - below)
- The officers are elected by the AWHSC-IRB members for three years. They may be re-elected but not for more than two consecutive terms. Should they resign or be disqualified; the AWHSC-IRB members elect a replacement until the completion of the normal term.

5.8 Secretariat

- The Secretariat is composed of the AWHSC-IRB secretary and the administrative supporting staff.
- The supporting staff are staff members of AWHSC-IRB appointed by the AWHSC chief executive Director
- The Secretariat shall have the following functions:
 - Organizing an effective and efficient tracking procedure for each proposal received (see AWHSC-IRB SOP/007, 024).



**Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)**

AWHSC-IRB SOP/003/01.1
Effective Date: 30/11/2025
Page 17 of 9

2.1. Constituting an Ethics Committee

- Preparation, maintenance and distribution of study files (see AWHSC-IRB SOP/024)
- Organizing regular AWHSC-IRB meetings (AWHSC-IRB SOP/021).
- Preparation and maintenance of meeting agenda and minutes (see AWHSC-IRB SOP/021)
- Maintaining the AWHSC-IRB documentation and archives (See AWHSC-IRB SOP/011 and AWHSC-IRB SOP/ 025)
- Communicates with the AWHSC-IRB members and applicants (AWHSC-IRB SOP/023)
- Arrangement of training for personnel and AWHSC-IRB members (see AWHSC-IRB SOP/005)
- Organizing the preparation, review, revision and distribution of SOPs and guidelines (see AWHSC-IRB SOP/001 and AWHSC-IRB SOP/ 002)
- Providing the necessary administrative support for AWHSC-IRB related activities to the Chairperson of the IRB (e.g., communicating a decision to the applicant - AWHSC-IRB SOP/023, AWHSC-IRB SOP/ 007- AWHSC-IRB SOP/ 017.)
- Providing updates on relevant and contemporary issues related to ethics in health research, as well as relevant contemporary literature to the IRB members.

5.9 Roles and responsibilities of AWHSC-IRB members

- Participate in the AWHSC-IRB meeting
- Review, discuss and consider research proposals submitted for evaluation
- Monitor serious adverse event reports and recommend appropriate action(s) (AWHSC-IRB SOP 019)
- Review the progress reports and monitor ongoing studies as appropriate
- Evaluate final reports and outcomes
- Maintain confidentiality of the documents and deliberations of AWHSC-IRB meetings (AWHSC-IRB SOP 025)
- Declare any conflict of interest
- Participate in continuing education activities in biomedical ethics and biomedical research
- Perform other related activities

5.10 Quorum Requirements

- A minimum of 50% of the members must be present at a meeting in order to issue a valid advice and/or decision.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)

AWHSC-IRB SOP/003/01.1
Effective Date: 30/11/2025
Page 18 of 9

2.1. Constituting an Ethics Committee

- Professional qualifications of the quorum requirements should consist of:
 - ✓ At least one member whose primary area of expertise is in a non-scientific area, one medical scientist and at least one member who is independent of the institution/research site.

5.11 Dissolving of the AWHSC-IRB

- At any point in time, should the campus cease to exist, the AWHSC-IRB is automatically dissolved.
- The chief executive Director of AWHSC, following written notification to each of the members, may also dissolve the AWHSC-IRB at any time.
- Upon AWHSC breach of ethics
- Upon failure to perform duties and responsibilities specified in this SOP

6. Glossary

- Confidentiality:** Prevention of disclosure, to other than authorized individuals, of AWHSC-IRB information and documents
- AWHSC-IRB:** Is an independent IRB whose responsibility is to ensure the protection of the rights, safety and well-being of human subjects involved in a research project and to provide public assurance of that protection.
- Scientists:** Professionals with advanced training and expertise in the medical or non-medical areas related to the protocol being reviewed.

7. References

- World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics IRBs that Review Biomedical Research, 2000.
- International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
- Related SOPs: AWHSC-IRB SOP #002, 004-005, 007-017, 019, 021, 023, 024, 02



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/004/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 1 of 10
2.2. Confidentiality/ Conflict of Interest Agreement	

Table of Contents

1.	Purpose.....	2
2.	Scope.....	2
3.	Responsibility	2
4.	Flow chart	2
5.	Detailed instruction.....	3
5.1.	Read the text carefully and thoroughly.	3
5.2.	Ask questions, if any.....	3
5.3.	Sign with consent.....	3
5.4.	Keep the Agreement in mind.....	3
6.	Glossary	3
7.	Annex.....	4
8.	Reference	4
Annex 1.....		5
Annex 1.....		7
Annex 2.....		8
Annex 3.....		9



1. Purpose

The purpose of this section is to provide a form of Confidentiality / Conflict of Interest Agreement and identify who should read, understand, accept, keep in mind, sign and date the form. The procedures provide details when and where to sign as well as how the signed document should be kept.

2. Scope

This SOP covers the Agreements on both Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest concerning information and procedures followed by the AWHSC-IRB.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of all newly-appointed AWHSC-IRB members to read, understand, accept and sign the agreement contained in the Confidentiality / Conflict of Interest form before beginning their ethical review tasks with the AWHSC-IRB to protect the rights of study participants.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1.	Read the text carefully and thoroughly ↓	AWHSC-IRB members / guestattendeess / observers
2.	Ask questions, if any ↓	AWHSC-IRB members / guestattendeess / observers
3.	Sign to indicate consent ↓	AWHSC-IRB members / guestattendeess / observers
4.	Keep the Agreement in mind. ↓	AWHSC-IRB members / guestattendeess / observers



5. Detailed instruction

1.1. Read the text carefully and thoroughly.

- ☐ Newly appointed members obtain two copies of the Agreement Form AF 01-004.
- ☐ Read through the text of the form very carefully.
- ☐ The members fill in their names and their office on the blanks.

1.2. Ask questions, if any.

- ☐ Direct questions to the Secretariat, if any part or sentences is not clear.
- ☐ Let the officer explain or clarify the contents of the document.

1.3. Sign with consent.

- 1.3.1. Sign and date both copies at the document before a member of the Secretariat.
- 1.3.2. Give the forms back to the secretary to sign and date.
- 1.3.3. The members keep a copy for their records.

1.4. Keep the Agreement in mind.

- 1.4.1. The AWHSC-IRB Secretariat keeps a copy of the signed Agreement as the Institute's records.
- 1.4.2. Keep the copies in a Confidentiality/Conflict of Interest Agreement file.
- 1.4.3. Store the file in a secure cabinet with limited key holders.

6. Glossary

- **Confidentiality:** The nonoccurrence of unauthorized disclosure of information. Sometimes called Secrecy or Nondisclosure agreements.
- **Confidentiality Agreement:** An agreement designed to protect information, expertise and other trade secrets from being misused by those who have learned about them. The type of information that can be included under the umbrella of confidential information is virtually unlimited. Most confidentiality agreements exclude certain types of information from the definition of confidential information. It is very important that the recipient include these exceptions in the confidentiality agreement. An important point that must be covered in any



confidentiality agreement is the standard by which the parties will handle the confidential information. The agreement must establish a time period during which disclosures will be made and the period during which confidentiality of the information is to be maintained.

- **Conflict of Interest:** A situation in which a person, such as a public official, an employee, or a professional, has a private or personal interest sufficient to appear to influence the objective exercise of his or her official duties. There are three key elements in this definition: financial interest; official duties; professional interest. A conflict of interest occurs when:
 - An individual's private interest differs from his other professional obligations to the institute.
 - Professional actions or decisions occur that an independent observer might reasonably question.
 - A conflict depends upon situation and not on the character or actions of the individual.
 - Potential conflicts of interest must be disclosed and managed as per policy.

7. Annex

Annex 1: AWHSC 01-004 Confidentiality / Conflict of Interest Agreement Form

Annex 2: AWHSC 02-004 Confidentiality Agreement for Guest /Observer Attendees to AWHSC-IRB Meetings

Annex 3: AWHSC 03-004 Confidentiality Agreement for Non-members Requesting Copy (ies) of AWHSC-IRB Documents

8. Reference

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics IRBs that Review Biomedical Research, 2000.
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. National Health Research Ethics Review Guideline. Addis Ababa, Ethiopia. 4th. edition revised in June 2005



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/004/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 5 of 10
2.2. Confidentiality/ Conflict of Interest Agreement	

ANNEX 1

AF 01-004

Confidentiality / Conflict of Interest Agreement Form

In recognition of the fact, that I.....*member's name, and his/her affiliation*.... herein referred to as the “Undersigned”, has been appointed as a member of AWHSC-IRB has been asked to assess research studies involving human subjects in order to ensure that they are conducted in a humane and ethical manner, with the highest standards of care according to the applied national, local regulations, institutional policies and guidelines;

Whereas, the appointment of the undersigned as a member of AWHSC-IRB is based on individual merits and not as an advocate or representative of a home province/ territory/ community nor as the delegate of any organization or private interest;

Whereas, the fundamental duty of an AWHSC-IRB member is to independently review both scientific and ethical aspects of research protocols involving human subjects and make a determination and the best possible objective recommendations, based on the merits of the submissions under review;

Whereas, AWHSC-IRB must meet the highest ethical standards in order to merit the trust and confidence of the communities in the protection of the rights and well-being of human subjects;

The undersigned, as a member of the AWHSC-IRB, is expected to meet the same high standards of ethical behavior to carry out its mandate.

This Agreement thus encompasses any information deemed Confidential or Proprietary provided to the Undersigned in conjunction with the duties as a member of AWHSC-IRB. Any written information provided to the Undersigned that is of a Confidential, Proprietary, or Privileged nature shall be identified accordingly.

As such, the Undersigned agrees to hold all Confidential or Proprietary trade and other secrets (“information”) in trust or confidence and agrees that it shall be used only for contemplated purposes, shall not be used for any other purpose or disclosed to any third party. Written Confidential information provided for review shall not be copied or retained. All Confidential information (and any copies and notes thereof) shall remain the sole property of AWHSC-IRB.

The Undersigned agrees not to disclose or utilize, directly or indirectly, any Confidential or Proprietary information belonging to a third party in fulfilling this agreement. Furthermore, the Undersigned confirms that his/her performance of this agreement is consistent with the institute’s policies and any contractual obligations they may have to third parties.



Conflict of Interest

It is recognized that the potential for conflict of interest will always exist but has faith in AWHSC-IRB and its Chairperson to manage the conflict issues so that the ultimate outcome is the protection of human subjects.

It is the policy of AWHSC-IRB that no member may participate in the review, comment or approval of any activity in which he/she has a conflict of interest except to provide information as requested by the AWHSC-IRB.

The Undersigned will immediately disclose to the Chairperson of AWHSC-IRB any actual or potential conflict of interest that he/she may have in relation to any particular proposal submitted for review by the IRB, and to abstain from any participation in discussions or recommendations in respect of such proposals.

If an applicant submitting a protocol believes that an AWHSC-IRB member has a potential conflict, the investigator may request that the member be excluded from the review of the protocol.

The request must be in writing and addressed to the Chairperson. The request must contain evidence that substantiates the claim that a conflict exists with the EC member(s) in question. The IRB may elect to investigate the applicant's claim of the potential conflict.

When a member has a conflict of interest, the member should notify the Chairperson and may not participate in the AWHSC-IRB review or approval except to provide information requested by the IRB.

Examples of conflict-of-interest cases may be any of the following:

- A member is involved in a potentially competing research program.
- Access to funding or intellectual information may provide an unfair competitive advantage.
- A member's personal biases may interfere with his or her impartial judgment.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/004/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 7 of 10
2.2. Confidentiality/ Conflict of Interest Agreement	

ANNEX 1

AWHSC 01-004

Agreement on Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest

Please sign and date this Agreement, if the Undersigned agrees with the terms and conditions set forth above. The original (signed and dated Agreement) will be kept on file in the custody of the AWHSC-IRB. A copy will be given to you for your records.

In the course of my activities as a member of the AWHSC-IRB, I may be provided with confidential information and documentation (which we will refer to as the "Confidential Information"). I agree to take reasonable measures to protect the Confidential Information; subject to applicable legislation, including the Access to Information Act, not to disclose the Confidential Information to any person; not to use the Confidential Information for any purpose outside the IRB's mandate, and in particular, in a manner which would result in a benefit to myself or any third party; and to return all Confidential Information (including any minutes or notes I have made as part of my IRB duties) to the Chairperson upon termination of my functions as a IRB member.

Whenever I have a conflict of interest, I shall immediately inform the Chairperson not to count me toward a quorum for voting.

I,, have read and accept the aforementioned terms and conditions as explained in this Agreement.

Undersigned Signature _____ Date _____

AWHSC-IRB Officer _____ Date _____



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/004/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 8 of 10
2.2. Confidentiality/ Conflict of Interest Agreement	

ANNEX 2

AWHSC 02-004

Confidentiality Agreement Form
for Guest Attendees to IEC/IRB Meetings

I....., understand that I am allowed to attend the AWHSC-IRB meeting as a guest or an observer. In the course of the meeting of the AWHSC-IRB, some confidential information may be disclosed or discussed. Upon signing this form, I agree to take reasonable measures to keep the information as Confidential.

Indicate the details (date and number) of the AWHSC-IRB meeting attended:

.....
.....
.....

Signature of the Guest or Observer _____

_____ Date

AWHSC-IRB Officer _____

_____ Date



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 2.2. Confidentiality/ Conflict of Interest Agreement	AWHSC-IRB SOP/004/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 9 of 10
--	---

ANNEX 3

AWHSC 03-004

Confidentiality Agreement Form
for Non-members Requesting Copies of AWHSC-IRB Documents

I....., as a non-member of AWHSC-IRB, understand that the copy (ies) given to me by the AWHSC-IRB is (are) confidential. I shall use the information only for the indicated purpose as described to the AWHSC-IRB and shall not duplicate, give or distribute these documents to any person(s) without permission from the AWHSC-IRB. Upon signing this form, I agree to take reasonable measures and full responsibility to keep the information as Confidential.

I have received copies of the following AWHSC-IRB documents:

.....
.....
.....
.....

Signature of the recipient

Date

AWHSC-IRB Officer

Date



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 2.3. Training Personnel and IRB Members	AWHSC-IRB SOP/005/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 1 of 5
--	---

Table of Contents

1.Purpose.....	2
2. Scope.....	2
3. Responsibility.....	2
4. Flow chart.....	2
5. Detailed Instructions.....	3
5.1. Topics for training.....	3
5.2. How to get trained.....	3
5.3. Keeping the training records.....	4
6. Glossary.....	4
8. Annex.....	5



1. Purpose

The purpose of this section is to inform the IRB personnel and members why training is necessary and how the members should seek to occasionally attend training or workshop programs to up-date themselves on the progress of technology, information and ethics. AWHSC recognizes the importance of training and continuing professional development, therefore the institution will allocate an annual budget for specific training and study visits for IRB personnel and members. New IRB members are required to undergo a training program prior to joining the IRB.

2. Scope

The SOP applies to all personnel and members of the IRB.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the institute, chairperson and IRB members to have themselves educated, to arrange/ train periodically.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1	Topics for training ↓	IRB members / staff
2	How to get trained ↓	IRB members / staff
3	Keeping the training record.	IRB members / staff

5. Detailed Instructions

5.1. Topics for training

IRB members should maintain competence by ensuring currency of their knowledge of:

- Good Research Practice
- Good laboratory practice (GLP)
- Good Clinical Practice (GCP)
- Data management
- Declaration of Helsinki
- Ethical Issues
- Relevant laws, national and international guidelines, manual and SOP's
- Developments in relevant science, technical and environmental, health and safety aspects
- Relevant requirements of health, safety and environmental laws and regulations and



related documents

- Audit procedures
- And other relevant topics
- An interchange of ideas, information and experiences with overseas institutions and organizations related to research ethics is also being carried out. International cooperation is also necessary to discuss ways of tackling harmful information distribution and joint efforts to tackle such distribution patterns. Efforts are being made to collect information on overseas trends and to attend international specialist meetings organized for the exchange of experience and information.

5.2. How to get trained

- Get information about training courses, workshops, conferences, meeting etc. which are periodically announced on websites, bulletin boards and various channels.
- Select the ones you need.
- Finalize administrative and financial issues
- Register and attend.
- Settle the finance according to AWHSC regulation

5.3. Keeping the training records

- Submit the copy of training certificate to Secretariat
- Fill in the form AWHSC-IRB AF 01-005/01.1 to record the training / workshop / conference activities in chronological order.
- Make a copy of the form.
- Keep the original form as your record.
- Give the copy to the administrative staff to keep in the IRB file.

6. Glossary

- **Conference:** A meeting of individuals or representatives of various organizations for the purpose of discussing and/or acting on topics of common interest.
- **Meeting:** Deliberations between at least two (2) persons where such deliberations determine or result in the joint conduct or disposition of business
- **Workshop:** A group of people engaged in study or work on a creative Project or subject

7. References

1. World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.
2. International Council for Harmonization of Technical Requirements for Pharmaceuticals for Human Use Guidance for Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) E6(R2), 2016.



8. Annex Curriculum vitae

First name:	Last name:
Staff / Membership since:	Status:
Education Background:	
Work Experience:	

Training Experience:

#	Courses / Workshops / Conferences / Meetings Attended	Organized by:	Where?	Duration	Source of Funding
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/006/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 5 of 9
Selection of Independent Consultants	

Table of Contents

1. Purpose.....	6
2. Scope.....	6
3. Responsibility	6
4. Flow chart	6
5. Detailed instructions	7
5.1. Selection of Independent Consultant	7
5.2. Signing of COI and Confidentiality Agreement forms.....	7
5.3. Receive protocol and other relevant documents for reviewing.....	7
5.4. Review study protocol based on the assessment form.....	7
5.5. Communicate with secretariat office	8
5.6. Termination of the Services.....	8
6. Glossary	8
7. References.....	1
8. Annex.....	1



1. Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to provide procedures for engaging the expertise of a professional as a consultant to the IRB.

2. Scope

This SOP covers the procedures for selecting, appointing Independent Consultant and getting their expert opinion during the IRB review process. It also defines the responsibilities of Independent Consultant.

3. Responsibility

Upon the advice or recommendation of the secretariat or any IRB member, it is the responsibility of the Chairperson to nominate and approve the special consultants.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1	Selection of Independent Consultant	Chairperson
	↓	
2	Signing of COI and Confidentiality Agreement forms	Independent Consultant, Chairperson
	↓	
3	Receive protocol and other relevant documents for reviewing	Consultant
	↓	
4	Review study protocol based on the assessment form	Consultant
	↓	
5	Communicate with secretariat office	Consultant and IRB secretariat
	↓	
6	Termination of the services	Consultant /Chair person



5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Selection of Independent Consultant

- Identify the experts by the IRB member and Secretariat from the roster, or otherwise
- Make nomination based on expertise, availability and independence criteria
- Secretariat will issue an appointment letter to the independent consultant after confirming their willingness through telephonic/ electronic communication
- Get approval from the chairperson

5.2. Signing of COI and Confidentiality Agreement forms

- The independent consultant will sign and date the Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Agreement Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 06-004/02.1)
- The Secretariat will obtain the signed Confidentiality Agreement and Conflict of Interest Agreement and forward it to Chairperson
- The Chairperson will sign and date the Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Agreements
- The original copies of these agreements will be retained by the Secretariat and another copy will be sent to the independent consultant

5.3.Receive protocol and other relevant documents for reviewing

- The independent consultant will receive the protocol and other relevant documents from the IRB secretariat
- Check the received packages for completeness
- Sign and date an acknowledgement form upon receiving the packages.
- Return the receipt form back to the IRB secretariat

5.4.Review study protocol based on the assessment form

- The Secretariat will provide study protocol documents for Independent Consultant (s)
- The Independent Consultant will be requested to complete the Assessment Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-008/02.1) and his/her remarks using an assessment report form (AWHSC-IRB AF 02-008/02.1) and provide to the Secretariat within a stipulated period or by a stipulated date
- The assessment report provided by the Independent Consultant becomes a permanent part of the study file
- The assessment report will be reviewed by the secretary in the IRB meeting when the concerned study is being discussed

Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/006/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 8 of 9
Selection of Independent Consultants	

- If deemed necessary, the Chairperson or secretary may seek additional information or clarifications from the Independent Consultant in writing. Additional Information provided by the Independent Consultant will be considered as part of the Assessment Report (AWHSCIRB AF 02-008/02.1)

- If deemed necessary, the Chairperson or Member-secretary may invite the Independent Consultant to attend an IRB meeting for providing additional information or clarifications that may be sought by IRB members or Chairperson. However, the Independent Consultant will not participate in the decision-making process on the research study.

5.5.Communicate with secretariat office

- Consultant sends his/her comments made using the assessment form on the protocol to the secretariat
- Principal investigator/designee requested to provide clarifications or answer to unclear issues, if there is/are any, to the secretariat
- Secretariat sends protocol & other relevant documents to IRB members at least three days prior to the IRB meeting for their preparation to convened IRB meeting

5.6.Termination of the Services

- Consultation services may be terminated by either the consultants themselves or by IRB secretariat
- Upon termination of the consultant's services, a member of the secretariat, ensures that the reason for discontinuation of the services are filed with the administrative documents.

6. Glossary

Independent An expert who gives advice, comments and suggestion upon consultant review of the study protocols with no conflict of interest with the protocols.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/006/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 1 of 9
Selection of Independent Consultants	

7. References

1. FDRE Ministry of Science and Technology, National Research Ethics Review Guideline, 2014.
2. World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.

8. Annex

None



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 2 of 29
---	--

Table of Contents

1. Purpose.....	3
2. Scope.....	3
3. Responsibility	3
4. Flow chart	3
5. Detailed instructions	4
5.1. Receive submitted packages.....	4
5.1.1 Initial Review Application	4
5.1.2. Resubmission of Protocols with Corrections	4
5.1.3. Protocol Amendment.....	4
5.1.4. Continuing Review of Approved Protocols	4
5.1.5. Final Report Review	4
5.1.6. Protocol Termination.....	4
5.2. Check for submission items	4
5.2.1. Get relevant forms.....	4
5.2.2. Fill in the forms:.....	5
5.2.3. Verify Contents of Submitted Package	6
5.2.4. Verify electronic documents (where applicable)	8
5.2.5. Create a Protocol Specific File • Get the “Protocol Submission” file.....	9
5.3. Process submitted package.....	9
5.4. Documentation of received packages.....	10
6. Glossary	10
7. Reference	10
8. Annex.....	10
Annex 1: Contents of a Submitted Package (Checklist)	11
Annex 2: Memorandum of Understanding Template	13
Annex 3: Material Transfer Agreement Template (AWHSC-IRB AF 03-007/02.1)	22
Annex 4: Consent of DG/DDG/Directorate Director on protocols.....	27



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 3 of 29
---	--

Annex5: Document Receipt Form..... 28

1. Purpose

This standard operating procedure is designed to describe how the Secretariat of the Institutional Review Board (IRB) manages protocol submissions to the AWHSC-IRB.

2. Scope

Protocol submissions include:

- Submission for Initial Review
- Resubmission of Protocols with Corrections
- Protocol Amendment
- Continuing Review of Approved Protocols
- Final Report Review
- Protocol Termination

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the IRB secretariat to receive, record, distribute for review and get the submission packages approved by the IRB, as well as to deliver the review results to the protocol applicants.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1.	Receive Submitted Packages	IRB Secretariat
2.	Check for submission items and completeness	IRB Secretariat
3.	Process submitted package	IRB Secretariat
4.	Documentation	IRB Secretariat



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 4 of 29
---	--

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Receive submitted packages

5.1.1 Initial Review Application

- Go to 5.2.

5.1.2. Resubmission of Protocols with Corrections

- Retrieve the previous receipt form from the Secretariat's records, and
- Go to step 5.2.1.2

5.1.3. Protocol Amendment

- Retrieve the previous receipt form from the Secretariat's records, and
- Go to step 5.2.1.3

5.1.4. Continuing Review of Approved Protocols

- Retrieve the previous receipt form from the Secretariat's records, and
- Go to step 5.2.1.4

5.1.5. Final Report Review

- Retrieve the previous receipt form from the Secretariat's records, and
- Go to step 5.2.1.5

5.1.6. Protocol Termination

- Retrieve the previous receipt form from the Secretariat's records, and
- Go to step 5.2.1.6

5.2. Check for submission items

5.2.1. Get relevant forms

5.2.1.1. Initial Review Application

- A checklist for contents of a submitted package, form AWHSCIRB AF 01-007/02.1
- A document receipt form, AWHSC-IRB AF 05-007/02.1 and an application form for initial review, AWHSC-IRB AF01-011/02.1
- Go to step 5.2.2



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 5 of 29
---	--

- For **e-submission**, go to 5.2.3 (Filled AWHSC-IRB AF 01010/02.0 application form for initial review should be attached)

5.2.1.2 Resubmission of Protocols with corrections

- A checklist form (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-007/02.1)
- A document receipt form (AWHSC-IRB AF 05-007/02.1)
- A review of resubmitted protocol form (AWHSC-IRB AF 01013/02.1)
- Go to step 5.2.2

5.2.1.3. Protocol Amendments

- A checklist for contents of a submitted package, form AWHSCIRB AF 01-007/02.1
- A document receipt form, AWHSC-IRB AF 04-007/02.1
- Go to step 5.2.2

5.2.1.4 Continuing Reviews of Approved Protocols

- A checklist for contents of a submitted package, form AWHSCIRB AF 01-007/02.1
- A document receipt form, AWHSC-IRB AF 05-007/02.1
- A re-review report form, AWHSC-IRB AF 01-011/02.1
- Go to step 5.2.2

5.2.1.5. Final Report Review

- A checklist for contents of a submitted package, form AWHSCIRB AF 01-007/02.1
- A document receipt form, AWHSC-IRB AF 05-007/02.1
- Go to step 5.2.2

5.2.1.6. Protocol Termination

- A checklist for contents of a submitted package, form AWHSCIRB AF 01-007/02.1,
- A document receipt form, AWHSC-IRB AF 05-007/02.1, and
- Go to step 5.2.2

5.2.2. Fill in the forms:

- Give the form AWHSC-IRB AF 01-007/02.1, document receipt form AWHSC-IRB AF 05-007/02.1 and the form AWHSC-IRB AF 01-011/02.1 to the applicants to fill up the relevant information.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 6 of 29
---	--

5.2.3. Verify Contents of Submitted Package

- Use the checklist for contents of a submitted package, form AWHSC-IRB AF 01-007/02.1,
- Check the applicable documents to ensure that all required forms and materials are contained within the submitted package
- Verify contents of the protocol submitted package to include: - Original Application Form for Initial Review
- Summary Sheet or Memorandum of the study Protocol
- Study Protocol and Related Documents
- Supporting letterform AWHSC Directors, Deputy Director Generals, Director General and other institutes to AWHSC-IRB
- Memorandum of Understanding MoU) if project is to be executed by two or more institutions (Use SOP Template included under Annex AWHSC-IRB AF 02-007/02.1).
- Protocols submitted from Ministry of Health and its agencies as well as students are not subjected to be supported by MoU, rather, supporting letter from the respective office or university suffice to continue the review process
- Material Transfer Agreement (MTA) between provider and recipient institutions if any biological material is to be exported outside Ethiopia (Use Annex AWHSC-IRB AF 03007/02.1 as template) and analysed. Biological materials to be exported and analysed by project investigators in a laboratory abroad due to limited institutional capacity and/or improve efficiency without involving any other party or individual may however be exempted from MTA through decision to be made by full board meeting. Supporting relevant document(s)and commitment letter from the PI or designee for taking full accountability of ensuring the aforementioned process, highest possible measure to maintain confidentiality of data, standard disposal or returning of all leftover of exported biological samples or its product should however be attached given IRB permits export without MTA.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 7 of 29
---	--

- Receive Director General/Deputy Director General/Directorate Director supporting letter for submission of the protocol (AWHSC-IRB AF 04-007/02.1) for review and determination
- Check completeness of necessary information in the Application Form for Initial Review
- Check the Summary Sheet or Memorandum of the study protocol for inclusion of the followings:
 - Title of the Protocol
 - Principal Investigator
 - Sponsor
 - Summary
 - Type of Protocol (screening, survey, pre-clinical laboratory-based studies)
 - Objectives
 - Anticipated Outcome
 - Inclusion/Exclusion Criteria
 - Withdrawal or discontinuation Criteria
 - Modes of Treatment Studied
 - Methodology (synopsis of study design)
 - Analysis (methods)
 - Activity plan / Timeline
 - IND Number (if applicable)
 - Schedule and Duration of Treatment
 - Efficacy or Evaluation Criteria (Response/Outcome)
 - Safety Parameters Criteria (Toxicity)
 - Conflict of Interest Declaration
- Check the submitted **Protocol and Related Documents** for the following contents
 - Participants' information sheets



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 8 of 29
---	--

- Informed Consent Form
- Case Record Form (CRF) for clinical trial studies
- Study budget and budget justification
- Curriculum Vitae (CV) of investigators
- Other pertinent documents to the specific protocol as appropriate
- GCP training certificate and/or basic research ethics training certificate
- MoU, if the study is to be conducted with collaborating institutes

- See if changes made to the documents be underlined or highlighted

5.2.4. Verify electronic documents (where applicable)

- Place the electronic computer documents (protocol summary, protocol and protocol-related documents) on the IRB server or the Local Area Network at the time of submission for initial protocol review or protocol amendment packages in the following drive and folder: [C:\studies\protocols\new\](#) (short name of title)
- Verify that the electronic version and the contents of the documents match the copy submitted by comparing a hard copy of the electronic document with the submitted one
- Print out the protocol documents
- Verify the correctness of the documents
- Check that all pages of the documents have been included and that the submitted protocol and protocol-related documents do not have missing pages
- Certify the printed hard copy in the same manner as the submitted document(s) with the dated signature
- Stamp and assign a running number to the received protocols, applying the system of 7 letters and 7 digits indication institutional review board of AWHSC followed by hyphen then sequence of protocol number and year of submission. For example, **AWHSC-IRB-188-2022** means **AWHSC-IRB:** Institutional Review Board of Asrat



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 9 of 29
---	--

Woldeyes Health Science Campus ;**189**: protocol number, **2022**: year of submission that is submitted in 2022

- Count for correct numbers of copies
- Store the hard copy of the electronic document with the submitted documents
- Use the assigned running number of the protocol as the labelled name
- Identify clearly as the hard copy of the electronic document, and
- Return incomplete submission package to the protocol applicant with notification of missing items

5.2.5. Create a Protocol Specific File • Get the “Protocol Submission” file

- Record the name and the number of the submitted protocol
- Record the receiving date and the name of the receiver

5.3. Process submitted package

- Get the Form AWHSC-IRB AF 01-007/02.0, document receipt form AWHSC-IRB AF 05-007/02.0 and AWHSC-IRB AF 01-011/02.0 back from the applicants
- Check for completeness of information
- Notify the applicants if a package is incomplete
- State clearly the items missing in the package
- Fill up the related parts and the missing documents
- Stamp the receiving date on the letter and the first page of the documents
- Initial the receiver’s name on the receiving documents,
- Make a photocopy of the completed Form AWHSC-IRBAF 05-007/02.0
- Return the original copy of AWHSC-IRB AF 05-007/02.0 to the applicants for their records
- Attach the filled checklist (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-007/02.0), supporting letter from respective official (AWHSC-IRB AF 04-007/02.0) and form AWHSC-IRB AF 05007/02.0; as well as copy/copies of MoU (AWHSC-IRB AF 02-007/02.0.) and MTA (AWHSC-IRB AF 03 007/02.0.), if there is/are any with a staple
- Keep copy of the document receipt form in the “Protocol submission file”



- Attach an Initial Review Application Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-011/02.0) to the Research Protocol packages, and
- Keep the copy of the submitted documents with original signatures in the “Submission” file.

5.4. Documentation of received packages

- Bind the packages together appropriately, and
- The submitted hard copy protocols and related documents will be labelled and stored in the locked shelf of SERO in FIFO sequence.

6. Glossary	
FIFO	First in First Out sequence
GCP	Good Clinical Practice
MTA	Material Transfer Agreement
MoU	Memorandum of Understanding

7. Reference

1. World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 2016.
3. Associated SOPs: AWHSC-IRB SOP 008/02.0; AWHSC-IRB SOP 010/02.0 AWHSCIRB SOP 011/02.0; AWHSC-IRB SOP 013/02.0

8. Annex



Annex 1: Contents of a Submitted Package (Checklist)

(AWHSC-IRB AF 01-007/02.0) Protocol Number _____

☐ Initial Review Submitted Package

- ☐ Protocol Summary Sheet
- ☐ Original Initial Review Application Form
- ☐ Office memo or supporting letter
- ☐ Protocol and Protocol-Related Documents
- ☐ information for subject's ☐ informed consent form
- ☐ case report forms (CRF) ☐ study budget
- ☐ Curriculum vitae (CV) ☐ GCP or research ethics training certificates
- ☐ investigator's brochure ☐ MoU
- ☐ Others.....

☐ Resubmission for Re-review Submitted Package

- ☐ Resubmission or "Correction" Memorandum
- ☐ Revised Protocol Summary Sheet (if submitted initially)
- ☐ Original Initial Review Application Form
- ☐ Protocol and Protocol-Related Documents
- ☐ information for subjects ☐ informed consent form
- ☐ case report forms (CRF) ☐ study budget
- ☐ Curriculum vitae (CV) ☐ GCP or research ethics training certificates
- ☐ investigator's brochure ☐ MoU
- ☐ Others.....

Note: Changes made to the protocol and protocol-related documents should be clearly marked either with the underlining or highlighting feature of the document or the software package used to prepare the documents.



☐ **Protocol Amendment Submitted Package**

- ☐ Request for Amendment Memorandum
- ☐ Original Amendment Submission Form
- ☐ Protocol and Protocol-Related Documents

Note: Changes made to the protocol and protocol-related documents should be clearly marked either with the underlining or highlighting feature of the software package used to prepare the document.

☐ **Continuing Review Package**

- ☐ Request for Continuing Review Memorandum
- ☐ Original Continuing Review Application Form
- ☐ Current Informed Consent Document (last approved by the IRB)

☐ **Final Report Review**

- ☐ Request for Final Report Review
- ☐ Original Final Report Review Application Form

☐ **Protocol Termination Package**

- ☐ Request for Termination Memorandum
- ☐ Original Continuing Review Application Form (Termination Submissions are contained on this form).



Annex 2: Memorandum of Understanding Template

(AWHSC-IRB AF 02-007/02.0)

MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING

THIS AGREEMENT is made as of [INSERT DATE]

BY AND BETWEEN:

1. **The Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus**, Federal Government Organ, established under council of ministers regulations number _____ with office located at Debre Berhan Town, North Shewa Zone, Amhara Regional state, Ethiopia (“AWHSC”);

And

2. The [NAME OF ENTITY], [TYPE OF ENTITY] established under [CONSTITUTING DOCUMENT] with office located at [FULL ADDRESS], (“ACRONYM”).

RECITALS

- A. **Whereas**, AWHSC is engaged in Public Health research, Public Health emergency management and National Laboratory Quality system establishment and [NAME OF ENTITY] is engaged in [MAJOR LINES OF Engagement];
- B. **Whereas**, AWHSC and [NAME OF ENTITY] each desire to conduct the scientific research described in Annex A hereto; and
- C. **Whereas**, AWHSC and [NAME OF ENTITY] believe that collaborating with each other in the performance of such research will be of mutual benefit, will further strengthen the health and benefits of Ethiopian people and will foster the development of scientific knowledge;

NOW, THEREFORE, in consideration of the promises and mutual covenants set forth herein, AWHSC and [NAME OF ENTITY] agree as follows.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 14 of 29
---	---

1. Definitions

In this, agreement the following words shall have the following meanings:

“Agreement”	shall means this MOU agreement including all attachments and schedules referred to herein;
“Arising Intellectual property”	shall means individually and collectively, all intellectual property made, conceived or developed during the term of this agreement and directly resulting from the research project carried out hereunder;
“Background Intellectual Property”	shall means, individually and collectively, all intellectual property developed, produced or obtained by a Party outside the scope of the research Project;
“Completion Date”	shall means the last day of the term described in Section;
“Effective Date”	shall means the date on which AWHSC and [NAME OF ENTITY] signs this agreement;
“Intellectual property”	shall include without limitation any right, or associated rights to all copyrights, trademarks, services marks, database rights, design rights, trade secrets, and patents;
“Parties”	shall mean the AWHSC and [NAME OF ENTITY]; Party means either one of them.
“Project”	shall mean the activity described in Annex A;

2. Purpose of the agreement



This agreement between AWHSC and [NAME OF ENTITY] defines the terms and conditions under which the parties undertake the [BRIFE SENETENSE DISCRIBING THE PROJECT BRIFE SENETENSE DISCRIBING THE PROJECT] in accordance with the research protocol entitled [TITLE OF THE PROTOCOL]

3. Objective of the project

The general objective of this project is (briefly describe the goal and the method or what is to be done and how) and provide evidence-based information to the Federal Ministry of Health (stake holders, partners ... if any)

4. Obligations of AWHSC

AWHSC shall:

- 4.1 Lead the design, protocol development, and the implementation (data collection, analysis and reporting) of the project;
- 4.2 Establish partnership and provide leadership for the successful completion of the project in the specified timeframe;
- 4.3 Make all efforts to achieve the goals and objective of the project using commonly accepted professional standards of workmanship and effort;
- 4.4 Organize the national dissemination workshops;
- 4.5 [Any additional responsibility]
- 4.6 [Any additional responsibility]

The detail roles and responsibilities of the parties are described in Annex A of this agreement

5. Obligations of [NAME OF ENTITY]

[NAME OF ENTITY] shall:

- 5.1 Provide technical assistance to AWHSC in the design, implementation, data analysis and reporting of the project;
- 5.2 Build the capacity of AWHSC's workforce and infrastructure;
- 5.3 Provide financial resources to support the project;



5.4 Provide technical and logistics assistance;

5.5 [Any additional responsibility]

5.6 [Any additional responsibility]

6. Financial arrangement

6.1 In consideration of the project described in Annex A and subject to the terms and conditions of the agreement [NAME OF ENTITY] will pay AWHSC up to (total amount in USD) which shall be used exclusively for and in accordance with the project budget in Annex B.

6.2 [NAME OF ENTITY] shall pay the Grant Funds to AWHSC in accordance with the schedule of project milestones in Annex B. more specifically:

- A. First payment of _____% of total AWHSC budget will be made upon signing by both parties of this MOU.
- B. Second payment of ____% of total AWHSC budget will be made upon [Date]
- C. Final payment of % ____ of total AWHSC budget will be made upon [Date]

6.3 AWHSC will provide financial reports to _____. The report should show a clear accounting period for actual expenditures against the approved budget as and be set out using the financial report template appended in Attachment F. The financial report must be signed by AWHSC's representative and authorized financial officer.

6.4 AWHSC shall furnish, compile and make available at all reasonable times to [NAME OF ENTITY] any records, accounts financial statements or information, oral or written, which _____ may reasonably request in respect of the funds received by the AWHSC.

6.5 [NAME OF ENTITY] Reserves the right on its own or through an agent to conduct an audit of all books, records, documents, and computer records relating to the grant fund at the AWHSC premises.



- 6.6 AWHSC will complete the Bank Information Form in Attachment D and return it with the signed copy of this Agreement. This will facilitate electronic payment to AWHSC's account.

7. Report

Both parties shall collaborate to produce a report on the progress and the final result of the project.

8. Confidentiality

8.1 Each party undertakes in favour of the other that it will treat as confidential all results including any and all information whether of a technical, scientific and academic nature or otherwise relating in any manner to the business or affairs of the other party as may be communicated to it hereunder or otherwise in connection with this MOU and will not disclose such information to any person, any legal entity or to the media, and will not use such information other than for the purpose of this MOU, subject to any prior specific written authorization by the other party to such disclosure or use. The party receiving confidential information undertakes to treat all such information as secure and confidential and not to disclose the same to any unauthorized third party, without the disclosing party's prior written consent. The receiving party undertakes to likewise ensure that all of its employees, who are given access to such confidential information, are equally bound to this undertaking, during the term of this agreement and for a period of three years thereafter.

8.2 The obligations in clause 8.1 above shall not apply to data or information which the receiving party can clearly demonstrate:

- a) was known to the receiving party prior to disclosure; or
- b) was or becomes in the public domain through no fault of the receiving party; or
- c) becomes available to the receiving party by an unconnected third party with the lawful right to make such a disclosure; or
- d) has been independently developed or conceived by it; or
- e) It is required to disclose by order of a court of competent jurisdiction.



- f) Reporting to parliament or other governmental organs mandated by law to oversee the activities of the recipients.
- g) Is approved for release in writing by an authorized representative of the other party.

9. Project data

AWHSC remains a full owner of the project data (row data) and has the right to fully use the data for further analysis and publication. [NAME OF ENTITY] should request and get approval from AWHSC if it intends to do any further analysis and publication using the project data other than those contained in deliverables.

10. Publication

Both parties shall have the right to jointly and severally disseminate and/or publish the findings resulting from and specific to the work completed under this agreement, all publications arising from the research which one party intends to publish will be submitted in writing to the other party detailing any results and any background that the party intends to publish, at least thirty (30) days before the date of the proposed submission for publication. One party may, by giving written notice to the other party ("a confidentiality notice"): require that party to delay the proposed publication for a maximum of three (3) month(s) after receipt of the confidentiality notice if, in the party's reasonable opinion, delay is necessary in order to seek patent or similar protection for any of the party's background or any results that are to be published; or prevent the publication of any of the party's background that is confidential information. The confidentiality notice must be issued within thirty (30) days after the party receives details of the proposed publication. If a confidentiality notice is not received within that period, the party may proceed with the proposed publication. For the avoidance of doubt, the parties will discuss and agree authorship for any publication relating to the research.

11. Intellectual property

11.1 Nothing in this agreement shall affect the ownership of intellectual property rights existing prior to this Agreement or generated outside the Project which one Party agrees to make available to the other in the course of the project ("Background"). If one party makes any of its background available to the other party in the course of the research, the party receiving such background shall treat it as confidential information disclosed under clause 8 above, and shall not disclose it to a third party nor use it for any purposes other than that for which it was made available to that party. Each party hereby agrees to make any background which is relevant to the research available, to the extent which it is free to do so, to the other solely for the purposes of undertaking the research and the Project.



11.2 Any intellectual property creates, generated or developed from, the research within the project (the Arising IP “”) shall be owned jointly AWHSC and [NAME OF ENTITY]. Each party shall be free to use the Arising IP for any purpose.

11.3 The parties agree that the process of commercializing the Joint IP shall be their joint responsibility. The parties will enter into a revenue sharing agreement, where necessary to do so, to agree a fair and reasonable distribution of any exploitation income arising from the Joint IP (after deduction of direct costs and reasonable fees).

11.4 For the avoidance of doubt, the ownership of results as described above shall apply whether the results have been made by any one of AWHSC and [NAME OF ENTITY] or by the two Parties.

12. Duration

The term of this agreement will start on the effective date and will continue in effect until [ENDING PERIOD], unless terminated earlier in accordance with this agreement. The parties may, by written agreement, extend the term of the agreement.

13. Representatives and notice

Any notice or request required under the agreement shall be effective when delivered by hand, mail, email or facsimile to the attention of the designated representatives of the parties identified below. The parties shall notify one another of any change in their representatives.

For AWHSC

Name_____

Title_____

Email_____

Tel._____

P.O.Box_____

For [NAME OF ENTITY]

Name_____

Title_____

Email_____

Tel._____

P.O.Box_____

14. Termination

14.1 This agreement may be terminated by either party forthwith by giving written notice to the other party if the other party commits a material breach of any of the terms of this agreement and if the breach is capable of remedy, fails to remedy it within sixty days after being given a written notice containing full particulars of the breach and requiring it to be remedied



14.2 In case of termination AWHSC with in thirty days of the date of termination invoice AWHSC in respect of all payments due by AWHSC under this agreement and any non-cancellable costs and commitments relating to the research project which have been incurred as at the date of termination of this agreement

14.3 Termination or expiry of this agreement shall not affect the right of either party against the other party in respect of the period up to and including the date of termination or expiry

15. General

15.1 **Headings:** The headings in this agreement are for ease of reference only; they do not affect its construction or interpretation.

15.2 **Assignment:** both parties shall not assign, delegate, sub-contract, charge, mortgage or otherwise transfer any or all of its rights and obligations under this Agreement without the prior written consent of Imperial, which shall not unreasonably be withheld.

15.3 **Illegal/Unenforceable Provisions:** If any part or any provision of this agreement shall to any extent prove invalid or unenforceable in law, including the laws of the European Union, the remainder of such provision and all other provisions of this agreement shall remain valid and enforceable to the fullest extent permissible by law, and such provision shall be deemed to be omitted from this agreement to the extent of such invalidity or unenforceability. The remainder of this Agreement shall continue in full force and effect and the parties shall negotiate in good faith to replace the invalid or unenforceable provision with a valid, legal and enforceable provision which has an effect as close as possible to the provision or terms being replaced.

15.4 **Waiver of Rights:** No failure to exercise or delay in the exercise of any right or remedy which any party may have under this agreement or in connection with this agreement shall operate as a waiver thereof, and nor shall any single or partial exercise of any such right or remedy prevent any further or other exercise thereof or of any other such right or remedy.

15.5 **No agency:** This agreement is not intended to establish, and shall not be construed by the Parties in the future as having established any form of business partnership between themselves.

15.6 **Entire Agreement:** This agreement (including its Schedules) supersedes all other agreements and understandings, whether written or oral, between the parties about the research and constitutes the entire agreement between the parties concerning the research.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 21 of 29
---	---

15.7 **Third Parties:** Except as otherwise expressly provided for herein, nothing in this agreement shall confer or purport to confer on any third party any benefit or any right to enforce any term of this agreement.

15.8 **Amendments:** Any amendments to this agreement shall be agreed in writing by both parties.

15.9 **Governing Law:** this agreement is made and shall be interpreted in accordance with Ethiopian law and subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of the Ethiopian courts.

AGREED by the parties through their authorized signatories:

For and on behalf of
Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus

For and on behalf of
[NAME OF ENTITY]

Signed _____

Signed _____

Print name _____

Print name _____

Title _____

Title _____

Date _____

Date _____



Annex 3: Material Transfer Agreement Template (AWHSC-IRB AF 03-007/02.0)

MATERIAL TRANSFER AGREEMENT TEMPLATE

This Material Transfer Agreement (MTA) has been prepared for use by Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus (AWHSC) in all transfer of biological material (samples, Isolates, DNA/RNA, derivatives) abroad.

Provider: _____

Recipient: _____

1. Scope of application

1.1 The application of this material transfer agreement shall cover materials sent to the recipient for research purpose or for laboratory service.

1.2 Research purpose shall mean research conducted on the transferred material in connection with a research protocol developed and conducted by:

- a) Provider ☐
- b) Recipient ☐
- c) Collaboration between provider and recipient ☐

1.3 Laboratory service shall mean confirmatory test, referral, quality assurance etc. to be conducted by the recipient laboratory as per the request of the provider. ☐

2. Material

Provider agrees to transfer to recipient the Following biological materials/sample /provide detail description/-

3. Project description



3.1 In case of material transferred for research purpose, the research protocol under which the material is going to be used shall be described with specificity and as much as possible indicate the specific experimental test to be conducted on the material.

3.2 In case of material transfer for laboratory service, the purpose and laboratory procedures and analysis to be conducted on the material shall be described

4. Obligation of the recipient

4.1 The recipient agrees:

- A. that the material is to be used solely for the purpose outlined under 3.1 and 3.2 above as applicable.
- B. that the material will not be used for commercial purposes such as screening, production or sale for which a commercialization license may be required.
- C. not to use the material in humans, in clinical trials, or for diagnostic purposes involving humans without the written consent of the provider.
- D. to comply with all national and international guidelines rules and regulations applicable to the Research Project and the handling of the research material.
- E. to retain the material in a secure location on its premises and will not permit the material or any part of it to come into the possession or control of any other organization or any individual other than those employees who are involved in the project under direct supervision of the recipient.
- F. to ensure that suitable systems are in place for the tracking of material while in its possession.
- G. not to transfer the material in whole or in part to third parties without the relevant third party entering into a separate Material Transfer Agreement with the provider.



- H. that the material will not be used either alone or in conjunction with any other information, to establish the individual identities of any of the subject from whom material was obtained.

4.2 In addition to what has be set for the above, in case material are transferred for laboratory service the materials shall not be used for any other purpose including without limitation any treatment, diagnostic research or evaluation purpose including publication.

5. Ownership of material

5.1 The material remains the property of the provider. There is no transfer or license or implied transfer or license of rights in the material from the provider to the recipient including all intellectual property rights. This agreement does not restrict the rights of the provider to distribute the material to other institutions

6. Publication

For research protocol developed and conducted by the provider, the right for publication shall unilaterally resides on the provider. In case of a research protocol developed and conducted by the recipient, the recipient may publish, otherwise publicly disclose, or submit for publication an article, manuscript, abstract or other material that includes the results of the use the materials in research after securing the consent of the provider, such consent not to be an reasonably withheld. The recipient agrees to acknowledge the role of the provider in any publication arising out of the recipient use of the materials.

7. Intellectual property rights

7.1. For research protocol developed and conducted by the provider, the provider shall own all right, title and interest in and to any data, result know-how, any patentable invention and other intellectual property that are generated by or on behalf of the provider in connection with the use of the material in the research ("**know-how**") ("**invention** ").

7.2. For research protocol developed and conducted by the recipient, the recipient shall own all right, title and interest in and to any data, result know-how, any patentable invention and other intellectual property that are generated by or on behalf of the recipient in connection with the use of the material in the research ("**know-how**") ("**invention** "). Recipient hereby grants to the provider royalty fee, worldwide, nonexclusive license to make, have made, use, and otherwise practice the invention/know how owned by the recipient for the purpose of research and teaching including use by Ethiopian government in its health care system and for health policy formulation, programs and interventions benefiting the Ethiopian people.

7.3. In case of material transferred for laboratory service the provider shall have sole and exclusive right, title and interest in and to any result, evaluation, report, information, invention, improvement, writing, communications, underlying data, and other documentation prepared,



generated, or developed by and on behalf of the provider. Unless otherwise expressly agreed by the provider any and all intellectual property and publication right in connection with the evaluation or generated from the evaluation (laboratory service) shall be owned and held exclusively by the provider.

8. Collaborative activities

Materials transferred by the provider to the recipient as the result of research collaboration, the publication and property right shall be determined by the project protocol and the MOU signed by the recipient and the provider.

9. Disclosure

Recipient shall promptly be disclosed to provider any invention generated in the research. In addition, recipient shall provide the provider with written report summarizing the result of any use of the material in the research or any results obtained in any other use of the material every six month during the term of the agreement, including up on expiration or termination of this agreement. Such reports shall include a summary of all data, and all information, inventions, discoveries,” know how” or any other intellectual property made or generated by or on behalf of the recipient relating to the material. The recipient shall provide to the provider copy of all such data including accepted publications, articles, abstracts, presentations etc...

10. No Responsibility/Indemnity

10.1. The provider does not take any responsibility for loss, damage, wastage or spoilage of the research material during or after shipment to the address provided by the recipient under conditions agreed to in the protocol on shipment of the samples. This research material is provided as a service to the research community. **IT IS**

BEING SUPPLIED TO RECIPIANT WITH NO WARRANTIES, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING ANY WARRANTY OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE. Provider makes no representations that the use of the research material will not infringe any patent or proprietary right of third parties.

10.2. The provider will, not be liable to the recipient or the recipient scientist for any loss, claim or demand made by the recipient or made against the recipient by any other party due to or arising from the use, storage and disposal of the material by the recipient, except when cause by the gross negligence or wilful misconduct of provide.

11. Return of material

The Material (and any copies thereof made by or in possession of or under the control of the recipient) shall be and remain the property of the provider and shall be immediately returned or if the provider so requires, destroyed (i) on termination of this agreement, or (ii) if the recipient is in breach of any provision of this agreement, and (iii) at any other time on request of the provider. If



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 26 of 29
---	---

the recipient is required to destroy the materials, then it will ensure that this is done in compliance with all applicable laws and regulations and will confirm in writing to the provider that the materials have been destroyed.

12. Duration

This agreement commences on the last signature date of this agreement ("Effective Date") and ending __ Year/Month thereafter (the "**Term**") unless terminated earlier in accordance with this agreement. The term may be extended as mutually agreed in writing by the Parties.

13. Final provisions

13.1 The undersigned provider and recipient expressly certify and affirm that the contents of any statements made herein are truthful and accurate.

13.2 The provider will retain a copy (aliquot) of every sample sent abroad as much as possible for local research needs.

For Recipient:

Recipient's Investigator

Duly authorized

Signature

Signature

Date

Date

Mailing Address for Material:

Mailing Address for Notices

Tel: _____

Tel: _____

Email: _____

Email: _____

For provider:

Recipient's Investigator

Duly authorized

Signature

Signature

Date

Date

Mailing Address for Material:

Mailing Address for Notices:

Tel: __ Tel: __ Email: __ Email:



Annex 4: Consent of DG/DDG/Directorate Director on protocols

(AWHSC-IRB AF 04-007/02.0)

Date: DD/MM/YYYY

To: AWHSC-IRB

From: (Directorate Director)

Subject: Endorsement of submitted protocol

I have reviewed the project entitled “.....,” which is submitted by, Principal Investigator from my directorate. I endorse that the project is discussed and agreed by the responsible case team, and have no objection for submission for consideration to be approved by AWHSC-IRB. I concur with collaborating institution; the principal investigator and co-investigators included in the study and commit to shoulder directorate responsibility. I certify that the directorate will provide utmost support and closely monitor execution of the project. The directorate will also report any protocol deviation and adverse event on human study participants that may happen at any time of project implementation.

Name of DG/DDG/Directorate Director:

Signature: Date:

.....



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 28 of 29
---	---

Annex 5: Document Receipt Form

(AWHSC-IRB AF 05-007/02.0)

Protocol Number:		Submitted date:	
Type of Submission:	☐ Initial Review ☐ Resubmission for re-review ☐ Protocol Amendments	☐ Continuing Review of Approved Protocols ☐ Final Report Review ☐ Protocol Termination	
Protocol Title:			
Principal Investigator:			
Telephone number:		Fax:	
E-mail:		Preferred Contact	☐ Phone ☐ Fax e-mail
Institute:			
Delivery route:	☐ Post ☐ E-submission ☐ In Person		
For office use only			



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.1. Management of Protocol Submission	AWHSC-IRB SOP/007/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 29 of 29
---	---

Submitted Documents (Tick in the boxes)	☐ Protocol Summary sheet ☐ Filled application form ☐ Office memo or supporting letter ☐ Protocol and related documents ☐ Information for subjects ☐ Informed consent form ☐ Case report forms (CRF) ☐ Study budget ☐ Curriculum vitae (CV) ☐ GCP or research ethics training certificates ☐ Investigator's brochure ☐ MoU ☐ Others.....	
Documents submitted:	☐ Complete ☐ Incomplete The submission will not be accepted if the submitted package are incomplete	
Received by: (Name and signature)		
Date received:		

Note: Please bring this receipt with you when contacting AWHSC-IRB



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 1 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

Table of Con.....	1
1.Purpose.....	1
2. Scope.....	2
3. Responsibility.....	2
4. Flow chart.....	3
5. Detailed instructions.....	3
5.1. Summarize the protocol in an Application Assessment Form.....	3
5.2. Review the study protocol.....	4
5.3. Examine the qualification of investigators and of study sites.....	4
5.4. Review study participation.....	4
5.5. Examine community involvement and impact.....	5
5.6. The reviewer makes a decision.....	5
5.7. Gather the assessment reports.....	5
5.8. Record the IRB decision.....	6
5.9. Prepare decision report.....	6
5.9.1. Prepare certificate of approval.....	6
5.9.2. Prepare notification for disapproval.....	6
6. Glossary.....	7
7. References.....	7
Annex 1: Study Assessment Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-008/01.1).....	8
Annex 2: Assessment Report (AWHSC-IRB AF 02-008/01.1).....	12
Annex 3: AWHSC-IRB Decision Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 03-008/01.1).....	13
Annex 4: Notification Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 04-008/01.1).....	14
Annex 5: Certificate of Approval (AWHSC-IRB AF 05-008/01.1).....	15
Annex 6: Certificate of Disapproval (AWHSC-IRB AF 06-008/01.1).....	16
Annex 7: Disapproval Complaint application form (AWHSC-IRB AF 07-008/01.1).....	17
Annex 8: Final Document Submission Verification Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 08-008/01.1).....	18



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 2 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how the IRB members use the assessment forms when reviewing the study protocols initially submitted for approval. The Assessment Form (AWHSC-IRB AF01-008/01.1), IRB decision report and the action letter are designed to standardize the review process and to facilitate reporting, recommendation and comments given to each individual protocol.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to the review and assessment of all protocols submitted for initial review and approval from the IRB. The specific questions in the Assessment Form must be adequately addressed in the protocol itself and/or protocol-related documents under review. Relevant points made during discussion and deliberation about a specific protocol should be recorded on the appropriate form. The decision reached by the IRB and the reasons for its decision is recorded on the Application Assessment Form.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the reviewers to fill the assessment form along with decision and comments they might have after reviewing each study protocol. The IRB Secretariat is responsible for recording and filing the decision, relevant points and deliberation about a specific protocol, including the reasons for that decision. The Chairperson and Coordinator of IRB of the AWHSC must sign and date to approve the decision in the form.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 3 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1	Summarize the protocol in an Assessment Form ⇓	IRB Secretariat
2	Review the Study Protocol ⇓	IRB members / Reviewers
3	Examine qualification of Investigators and study sites ⇓	IRB members / Reviewers
4	Review study participation ⇓	IRB members / Reviewers
5	Examine community involvement and impact ⇓	IRB members / Reviewers
6	Make a decision ⇓	IRB Members/Reviewers
7	Gather Assessment Reports ⇓	IRB Secretariat
8	Record the IRB's Decision	IRB Secretariat

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Summarize the protocol in an Application Assessment Form

Record general information about the protocol in the form AWHSC-IRB AF 01-008/01.1 (Annex 1) such as:

- Title of the protocol
- Protocol number and date
- Principal Investigators, license & contact number



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 4 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

- Co-investigators & contact number
- Funding agency & contact number
- Study types
- Duration of the study
- Status of the protocol – New / Resubmitted / Amended
- Mode of review – Full Board / Expedited
- Reviewer's name
- Objective and description of the Study

5.2. Review the study protocol

- Need for human participants for study
- Objectives of the study
- Review of literature
- Sample size
- Methodology and data management
- Inclusion/exclusion criteria
- Control arms (placebo, if any)
- Withdrawal or discontinuation criteria

5.3. Examine the qualification of investigators and of study sites

- Consider whether study and training background of the participating investigators relate to the study.
- Examine disclosure or declaration of potential conflicts of interest
- Can facilities and infrastructure at study sites accommodate the study?
- Principal investigators (PI) should be advised by an expertise when necessary.

5.4. Review study participation

- Voluntary, non-coercive recruitment/participation
- Procedures for obtaining informed consent
- Contents of the patient information sheet
- Contents and language of the informed consent document
- Translation of the informed consent document in the local



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 5 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

- Language used – plain and easy to understand by general public
- Contact persons with address and phone numbers
- Privacy and confidentiality
- Risks – physical / mental / social
- Benefits – to participants and to others
- Compensation – Reasonable / unreasonable
- Involvement of vulnerable participants
- Provisions for medical/psychosocial support
- Treatment for study related injuries
- Use of biological materials

5.5. Examine community involvement and impact

- Community consultation
- Involvement of local researchers and institutions in the protocol design, analysis and publication of the results
- Contribution to development of local capacity for research and treatment
- Benefit to local communities
- Availability of study results

5.6. The reviewer makes a decision

- Get the assessment report form (AWHSC-IRB AF 02-008/01.0)
- Record the decision by marking in the desired block any of the following:
“Approved, approved with minor comments, Resubmitted, or Disapproved.”
- Include comments, suggestion and reason for disapproval.
- Check the completeness and correctness of the assessment form.
- Sign and date the decision form.
- Give or send the complete forms to the IRB Secretariat.

5.7. Gather the assessment reports

- Collect the assessment forms and the review result from each reviewer.
- Organize the forms in order



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 6 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

- Summarize the comments, suggestions, and opinions of each study in the meeting agenda
- Follow AWHSC-IRB SOP/022/01.1 Preparation of meeting agenda and minutes.

5.8. Record the IRB decision

- Get the IRB's decision form. (AWHSC-IRB AF 03-008/01.1), see Annex 3.
- Complete the information. (By the Secretariat)
- List participating members and their votes
- Summarize the guidance, advice and decision reached by the IRB members
- Sign and date the document. (By the Chairperson of the IRB and IRB coordinator)
- Make a copy of the completed decision form
- Keep the original copy in the file labelled "IRB's decision"
- Keep the copy of the decision form with the study protocol
- Return the file and the protocol to the appropriate shelves

5.9. Prepare decision report

5.9.1. Prepare certificate of approval

- Get the IRB decision report
- Complete the information (AWHSC-IRB AF 05-008/01.1).
- Submit full-fledged document including final protocol, ICF and other relevant documents to the chairperson for signature supporting with signed final document submission verification form (AWHSC-IRB AF 08-008/01.1)
- Sign and date the certificate of approval by the Chairperson of the IRB and IRB coordinator of AWHSC
- Assign the AWHSC-IRB protocol number by filling in the boxes with numbers in sequential order, "AWHSC-IRB-□□□-□□□□"
- Make a copy of the completed certificate of approval form
- Keep one copy in the file labelled "IRB certificate of approval"
- Keep one copy in the study protocol file



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 7 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

- Provide approval certificate to the PI or delegate of the project

5.9.2. Prepare notification for disapproval

- Get the IRB decision report
- Complete the information (AWHSC-IRB AF 06-008/01.1).
- Submit full-fledged document including final protocol, ICF and other relevant documents to the chairperson for signature supporting with signed final document submission verification form (AWHSC-IRB AF 08-008/01.1)
- Sign and date the notification for disapproval form by the chairperson of the IRB and IRB coordinator of AWHSC
- Make a copy of the notification for disapproval form
- Keep one copy in the file labelled “IRB notification for rejection”
- Provide notification for disapproval form to the PI or delegate of the project

6. Glossary

Study Assessment Form: An official record that documents the protocol review process.

Document: Document may be of any forms, e.g., Paper, electronic mail (e-mail), faxes, audio or video tape, etc.

Vulnerable participants study: A vulnerable category of study participant includes children, prisoners, pregnant women, handicapped or mentally disabled persons, refugees, displaced persons and economically or educationally disadvantaged persons, who are likely to be vulnerable to coercion or undue influence.

7. References

1. *World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.*
2. *International Council for Harmonization of Technical Requirements for Pharmaceuticals for Human Use Guidance for Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) E6 (R2), 2016.*
3. *Ethical Guidelines for Biomedical research on Human Subjects, 2000.*
4. *Associated SOP: AWHSC-IRB SOP/022/01.0*



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: 30/11/2025 Page 8 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

Annex 1: Study Assessment Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-008/01.1)

Protocol Number: AWHSC-IRB-_____		Date (DDMM/YYYY): _____	
Protocol Title: _____ _____			
Principal Investigator: _____		Tel. Address: _____ Email Address: _____	
Institute: _____		Tel. Address: _____ Email Address: _____	
Co – investigator(s): _____			
Total No. of Participants: _____		No. of study sites: _____	
Funding Agency: _____		Contact Address _____	
Duration of the Study: _____		Status: ☐ New ☐ Resubmitted ☐ Amended	
Type of the Study: _____		☐ Interventional ☐ Epidemiological ☐ Observational ☐ Others, specify.....	
Mode of Review: _____		☐ Exempted ☐ Expedited ☐ Full Board	

Mark and comment on whatever items applicable to the study.

A. Scientific Issues

S.No	Parameters	Comments
1.	Title of the protocol ☐ Clear ☐ Unclear	
2.	Summary ☐ Clear ☐ unclear	
3.	Background & justification ☐ Sufficient ☐ Insufficient	
4.	Availability of similar Study ☐ Yes ☐ No	
5.	Objectives of the Study ☐ Clear ☐ Unclear	
6.	Methodology: ☐ Clear ☐ Unclear	What should be improved?
7.	Study tools are annexed? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA	
8.	Study tools are translated to local language? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not required	
9.	Need for Human Study Participants ☐ Yes ☐ No	Comment:



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 9 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

10.	Does the study respects international accepted ethical guidelines for animals? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA	
11.	Use of Placebo/ less effective intervention ☐ Justified ☐ Not justified ☐ Not Applicable	Comment:
12.	Sufficient number of participants? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA	Comment:
13.	Inclusion criteria ☐ Appropriate ☐ Inappropriate ☐ NA	Comment:
14.	Exclusion criteria ☐ Appropriate ☐ Inappropriate ☐ NA	Comment:
15.	Benefits of the study ☐ Clear ☐ Unclear	Comment:

B. Ethical and Informed Consent Issues

16.	Ethical consideration well described in the protocol ☐ Yes ☐ No	Comment:
17.	Equitable/Justified selection of study participants ☐ Yes ☐ No	Comment:
18.	Equitable/Justified selection of study sites ☐ Yes ☐ No	Comment:
19.	Are procedures for obtaining Informed Consent appropriate? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA	Comment:
20.	Contents of the Informed Consent Document ☐ Relevant issues addressed ☐ Relevant issues not addressed ☐ NA	Comment:
21.	Assent and parental/guardian consent required and obtained? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA	Comment:
22.	Language of the Informed Consent Document ☐ Appropriate ☐ Not Appropriate ☐ NA	Comment:
23.	Provision for Compensation ☐ appropriate ☐ Inappropriate ☐ NA	Comment:
24.	Voluntary, no undue influence for Participation ☐ Likely ☐ Unlikely ☐ NA	Comment:
25.	Voluntary, non-coercive recruitment of participants ☐ No ☐ Yes ☐ NA	Comment:
26.	Withdrawal Criteria ☐ Described ☐ Not Described ☐ NA	Comment:
27.	Privacy & Confidentiality maintained ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA	Comment:
28.	Availability of Risks on participants ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA	Comment:



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 10 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

29.	Category of risk/benefit ☐ Minimal risk ☐ Greater than minimal risk but presenting the prospect of direct benefit to the individual study participant ☐ Greater than minimal risk and no direct benefit to the individual study participant but likely to yield generalizable knowledge about participant's disorder or condition ☐ Outside those mentioned above ☐ NA	Comment:
30.	Risks are minimized? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA	Comment:
31.	Provision for Medical / Psychosocial Support ☐ appropriate ☐ inappropriate ☐ N/A	Comment:
32.	Provision for Treatment of Study-Related Injuries ☐ appropriate ☐ inappropriate ☐ N/A	Comment:
33.	Is there benefit to the individual? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA	Comment:
34.	Benefit to local communities ☐ Yes ☐ No	Comment:
35.	Use of vulnerable participants ☐ Justified ☐ Not justified ☐ N/A	Comment:
36.	Measures to protect vulnerable participants ☐ Sufficient ☐ Not sufficient ☐ NA	Comment:
37.	Community Consultation ☐ Yes ☐ No	Comment:
38.	Contact Persons for Participants ☐ Yes ☐ No	Comment:

C. Enablers & other issues

39.	Are Qualification and experiences of the Participating Investigators appropriate? ☐ Yes ☐ No	Comment:
40.	Involvement of local researchers and institution in the protocol design, analysis and publication of results ☐ Yes ☐ No	Comment:
41.	Facilities and infrastructure of Participating Sites ☐ Appropriate ☐ Inappropriate	Comment:
42.	Contribution to Development of Local Capacity for Research and Treatment ☐ Yes ☐ No	Comment:



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 11 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

43.	If more than one institution executes the project, Memorandum of Understanding attached? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA	Comment:
44.	Are human blood/tissue or other biological materials exported abroad? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not applicable	Comment:
45.	If biological material exported abroad, Material Transfer Agreement attached? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA	Comment:
46.	Disclosure or Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest ☐ Declared ☐ Not Declared	Comment:
47.	Are there any issues that are not clear & need clarification from the principal investigator? ☐ Yes ☐ No	List issues that need more clarification:



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 12 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

Annex 2: Assessment Report (AWHSC-IRB AF 02-008/01.1)

Protocol number: AWHSC-IRB-_____ **Date:** (DD/MM/YYYY) _____

Protocol Title: _____		

Elements reviewed (AWHSC-IRB-AF01) :	☐ Attached	☐ Not Attached
Review of revised application ☐ Yes ☐ No	Date of previous review:	
Decision:	☐ Approved ☐ Approved with recommendation/s ☐ Resubmission ☐ Disapproved	
Comments:		
Name of IRB Reviewer	Signature	Date



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 13 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

Annex 3: AWHSC-IRB Decision Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 03-008/01.1)

Protocol number: AWHSC-IRB-_____ Review Date (DD/MM/YYYY) _____

Protocol Title: _____	
Principal Investigators:	_____
Department:	_____
Elements Reviewed (AWHSC-IRB- AF01-008/01.1):	☐ Attached ☐ Not attached
Review of Revised Application ☐ Yes ☐ No	Date of Previous review: _____
Mode of Review	☐ Exempted Review ☐ Expedited Review ☐ Full Board Review
Additional Remarks, if any	
Decision of the meeting:	☐ Approved ☐ Approved with Recommendation ☐ Resubmission ☐ Disapproved

Reviewer Name

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Institutional Review Board (IRB) officer

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 14 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

Annex 4: Notification Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 04-008/01.1)

Protocol number: AWHSC-IRB-_____ Date: (DD/MM/YYYY) _____

Protocol Title: _____ _____ _____	
Principal Investigators:	
Institute:	
Study site/s	
Points to be addressed for resubmission or approval with minor comments	
<u>Chairperson</u> Name: _____ Signature _____ Date: _____	<u>IRB Officer</u> Name: _____ Signature _____ Date: _____



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 15 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

Annex 5: Certificate of Approval (AWHSC-IRB AF 05-008/01.1)

Protocol number.....AWHSC-IRB-_____

Meeting No.: MMM-DD-MM-YYYY _____

Protocol Title:	
Investigators:	
Departments:	
Study site/s	
Elements Reviewed (AWHSC IRB AF 01/008/01)	☐ Attached ☐ Not attached
Mode of Review	☐ Exempted ☐ Expedited ☐ Full Board
Decision of the meeting	☐ Approved

I. Elements approved: 1. Protocol Version No.:

2. Protocol Version Date:

II. Obligations of the PI:

- a** Should comply with the standard international & national scientific and ethical guidelines
- b** All amendments and changes made in protocol and consent form needs IRB approval
- c** The PI should report SAE within 48 hours of the event
- d** This approval certificate is valid for only one year (specified below). The PI should submit continuation request before expire date of approval, if projects is to continue
- e** Final report/Thesis and Manuscripts should be submitted to the IRB Secretariat after completion of the study.

f Institutional Review Board Approval Date: _____

Approval Period: From _____ to _____ Follow up report
 expected in: **6 months** **9 months** **one year**

AWHSC-IRB Chairperson

AWHSC-IRB OFFICER

Name _____

Name _____

Signature _____

Signature _____

Date: _____

Date: _____



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 16 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

Annex 6: Certificate of Disapproval (AWHSC-IRB AF 06-008/01.1)

Protocol number-AWHSC-IRB-_____

Meeting No.: MMM-DD-MM-YYYY _____

Protocol Title:	
Principal Investigators:	
Institute:	
Study site/s	
Reasons for disapproval	
IRB Officer	Name _____ Signature _____ Date: _____



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 17 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

Annex 7: Disapproval Complaint application form (AWHSC-IRB AF 07-008/01.1)

Protocol number.....AWHSC-IRB-_____□□□□□□

Protocol Title:	
Principal Investigators:	
Institute:	
Study site/s	
Reasons for complaint	
Applicant	Name _____ Signature _____ Date: _____



3.2. Use of Assessment Form

Annex 8: Final Document Submission Verification Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 08-008/01.1)

Protocol Title: _____

Principal Investigator: _____

Protocol Number: _____

Meeting minutes in which protocol was discussed (cite all minutes if protocol continues to be discussed in more than one meeting): _____

I, secretary of AWHSC-IRB or Research directorate staff have audited the final submitted document of the aforementioned protocol; which is prepared as per full board or chairperson's recommendation, suggestion and decision; for signature on approval/disapproval certificate by the chairperson and coordinator of AWHSC-IRB. I certify that the following relevant issues are addressed; documents are submitted and properly documented:

1. Recommendations and suggestions made during the board meeting(s) on the protocol are fully addressed in the final submitted protocol and submitted

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐

2. Recommendations and suggestions made during the board meeting on the informed consent form, given study protocol involves human study participants and/or animals, are fully addressed in the final submitted protocol and submitted

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A

3. Informed consent form and study protocols that are prepared in English and translated to local languages by the investigators or based on IRB recommendations are submitted as part of the project document

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not relevant ☐

4. Completed assessment forms by reviewer/s, compiled comments to investigators, and point by point response of investigators to the comments are attached

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐

5. Information on the covering/first page of the protocol is complete and adheres with the latest protocol writing format of AWHSC-IRB

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/008/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 19 of 19
3.2. Use of Assessment Form	

6. Commencement for execution of the project (including training) is planned following approval of the protocol (check implementation plan; respective, IRB minutes or decision by chairperson for expedited review) ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐

7. Appropriate version number and date are specified as footnote in the protocol, ICF and data collection instruments
☐ Yes ☐ No ☐

8. The principal investigator and co-investigator(s)/Advisors have signed on their respective roles and responsibilities section of the protocol
☐ Yes ☐ No ☐

9. Separate letter(s) requesting waiver of informed consent and/or assent is/are attached, given that IRB accepts the request
☐ Yes ☐ No ☐

10. Complete curriculum vitae of the principal investigator and one page summary of all co-investigators is attached
☐ Yes ☐ No ☐

11. Research Ethics and/or good clinical practice (GCP) training certificate is attached
☐ Yes ☐ No ☐

AWHSC-IRB Chairperson

Name _____

Signature _____

Date: _____

AWHSC-IRB Officer

Name _____

Signature _____

Date: _____



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/009/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 1 of 10
3.3. Initial review of Application protocol	

Table of Contents

1.	Purpose.....	2
2.	Scope.....	2
3.	Responsibility	2
4.	Flow chart.....	3
5.	Detailed instructions.....	4
5.1	Receive the distributed protocol packages.....	4
5.2	Verify the contents of the package.....	4
5.3	. Review the protocol	4
5.3.1	Initial Review Application Form.....	4
5.3.2	Assessment Form.....	4
5.4	AWHSC-IRB meeting	5
5.5	Preliminary Communication of the Decision	6
5.5.1	Verbal Communication of the Decision	6
5.5.2	Written Communication of the Decision	6
5.6	Final Communication of the Decision	6
5.6.1	Signature of Approval	6
5.6.2	The Assessment Form	7
5.6.3	The Application Review Form	7
5.6.4	The Action Letter	7
5.7	Storage of the Documents	7
6.	Glossary	9
7.	ANNEX	9
8.	References.....	9



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/009/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 2 of 10
3.3. Initial review of Application protocol	

1. Purpose

This standard operating procedure describes how the Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) manages to review an initially submitted protocol

2. Scope

This SOP applies to the review process of the study protocol package submitted for the first time.

3. Responsibility

- It is the responsibility of the assigned reviewers to thoroughly review the study protocols delivered to them, give their decision, observation and comments to the AWHSC-IRB in the Assessment Form and return to the Secretariat Office on the date due.
- The AWHSC-IRB Secretariat is responsible for receiving, verifying and managing the contents of both the hard copies and the electronic version of the received packages.
- In addition, the Secretariat should create a protocol specific file, distribute the packages and get them reviewed by the AWHSC-IRB and deliver the review results to the applicants.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/009/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 3 of 10
3.3. Initial review of Application protocol	

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1	Receive the distributed protocol package ↓	AWHSC-IRB Members/Reviewer
2	Verify the contents of the package ↓	AWHSC-IRB Members/Reviewers
3	Review the protocol ↓	AWHSC-IRB Members / Reviewers
4	Discuss in AWHSC-IRB meeting ↓	AWHSC-IRB Members / Reviewers /Secretariat / Chairperson
5	Preliminary Communication of the Decision ↓	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat /Chairperson
6	Final Communication of the Decision ↓	AWHSC-IRB Members / Chairperson
7	Storage of the Documents	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat



5. Detailed instructions

5.1 Receive the distributed protocol packages

- Check the distributed packages.
- Sign and date an acknowledgement form upon receiving the packages.
- Return the receipt form back to the delivery person / AWHSC-IRB Secretariat.

5.2 Verify the contents of the package

- Look for an Assessment Form.
- Look for the due date for the review.
- Check the meeting date to see if the investigator is available to attend the meeting.
- Notify the AWHSC-IRB Secretariat if there are documents missing, or the specified date cannot be met

5.3 . Review the protocol

5.3.1 Initial Review Application Form

- Check the form for completeness of the information and signatures of the principal investigator, the protocol chairperson (if applicable), the AWHSC-IRB Chairperson and Secretariat.
- Check and attach the Initial Review Application Form (AWHSC 01-010 see ANNEX 1) to the Research Protocol

5.3.2 Assessment Form

- Use the Assessment Form (AWHSC 01-008 in SOP# AWHSC008) to guide the review and deliberation process.
- Note: The completed Assessment Form is the official record of the decision reached by the AWHSCIRB for the specific protocol.
 - Consider the following criteria when performing the review:
 - Minimize risks to participants;
 - Risks must be reasonable in relation to anticipated benefits;
 - Participants are selected equitably;
 - Informed consent is adequate, easy to understand and properly documented;
 - The research plan makes adequate provision for monitoring the data collected to ensure the safety of participants, where appropriate;
- There are adequate provisions to protect the privacy of participants and to maintain



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/009/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 5 of 10
3.3. Initial review of Application protocol	

the confidentiality of data, where appropriate; and

- appropriate safeguards are included to protect vulnerable participants.
 - ✓ Make comments where appropriate.
 - ✓ Sign and date the reviewer's name.

5.4 AWHSC-IRB meeting

- The primary reviewer presents a brief oral or written summary of the study design and his/her comments. When required, the AWHSC-IRB may invite investigators to explain protocols.
- The Chairperson or designee entertains discussion on each document under consideration (e.g., protocol, informed consent, investigators and site qualifications, advertisements).
- Recommendations for modifications to the protocol, consent form, and/or advertisements as requested by the IRB are noted in the meeting minutes as 'with modifications made by AWHSC-IRB and will be communicated to the investigator.
- The Chairperson or designee calls for a separate vote on each element in review. The IRB votes to either:
 - Approve the study to start as presented with no modifications
 - Approve the study to start with IRB approved modifications to the consent. = **Approved with recommendation**
 - Require modifications to items noted at the convened meeting and follow-up by the Chairperson, after receipt of the requested modifications. = Approved with recommendation
 - Require modifications to the items and full IRB review of the materials. = Approved with stipulation or Resubmission
 - Request further information regarding the item and full IRB rereview of the material. = Approved with stipulation or Resubmission for re-review
 - Not approve the study, stating the reason for disapproval = Disapproved When required, the AWHSC-IRB may invite investigators to explain protocols.
- When required, the AWHSC-IRB may invite investigators to explain protocols
- If the study is approved, the IRB determines the frequency of Continuing review from each investigator.
 - The Secretariat sends an action letter along with the approved documents to the investigator.



3.3. Initial review of Application protocol

- The letter contains, at a minimum, a listing of each document approved, the date set by the IRB for frequency of continuing review, and a review of other obligations and expectations from the investigator throughout the course of the study.
- An approval and expiration date are placed on every page of each consent form approved by the AWHSC-IRB. If the IRB votes not to approve the study, the Secretariat immediately notifies the investigator in writing about the decision and the reason for not approving the study.
- If the IRB votes not to approve the study, the Secretariat immediately notifies the investigator in writing about the decision and the reason for not approving the study.
 - If the investigator wishes to appeal to the decision, he/she may do so by contacting the AWHSC-IRB Secretariat. The appeal process is stated in the action letter to the investigator.
- If the IRB requires modifications to any of the documents, the Secretariat either generates the revisions to the documents, or sends a written request of the specific changes to the investigator asking him or her to make the necessary changes and resubmit the documents to the AWHSC-IRB.

5.5 Preliminary Communication of the Decision

5.5.1 Verbal Communication of the Decision

The Chairperson notifies the Director of AWHSC-IRB of the IRB decision and the reasons for the decision as soon as possible after the IRB meeting.

5.5.2 Written Communication of the Decision

- The Chairperson sends an electronic version of the completed Assessment Form to the Secretariat and to the Director of the institution within one working day whenever possible, but no later than 5 working days after the review has taken place.
- The Secretariat, in turn forwards the IRB decision to the principal investigator (e.g. via e-mail) and files “sent” or “received” email messages in the protocol file.

5.6 Final Communication of the Decision

5.6.1 Signature of Approval

- Obtain and complete the appropriate forms, after a decision has been reached by the AWHSC-IRB.
- Get signature from the Chairperson.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/009/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 7 of 10
3.3. Initial review of Application protocol	

- Date the form.

5.6.2 The Assessment Form

- Complete the Assessment Form.
- Get signature of the Chairperson.
- Maintain the completed Assessment Form and the minutes of the meeting relevant to the protocol review.
- Process the above tasks within 5 working days after the meeting.

5.6.3 The Application Review Form

- ✓ Get the Chairperson to sign and date the original version of this form within 5 working days and return this to the Secretariat.
- ✓ Assign the AWHSC-IRB number at the bottom boxes on the last page of the Form (AF 01-010) by filling in the boxes with numbers in sequential order, “□□□/□□-□□”; the approval sequence in the first three boxes, the current month after the slash and the current year after the dash sign.
 - □ Example: A protocol, submitted in November of the year 2002 and it is the 12th protocol approved by the AWHSC-IRB in that year, would be numbered as AWHSC-IRB 012/11-02.
- ✓ Sign and date the form by the Secretariat.

5.6.4 The Action Letter

- Prepare an Action Letter to inform the investigator or the project manager about the IRB’s decision (see SOP# AWHSC 021).
- State clearly the actions that need to be taken by the investigator.
- For the decision disapproval, a notifying letter to the investigator or the project manager should state the followings:
- “If you wish to appeal to this decision, please contact the AWHSC-IRB and submit your appeal in writing, addressed to the AWHSC-IRB Chairperson with justification as to why the appeal should be granted”
- Verify the correctness of the wordings and spelling.
- Send the action letter to the applicant within 7 working days.

5.7 Storage of the Documents

- Keep a copy of the Action Letter in the Correspondence file.



3.3. Initial review of Application protocol

- Place the original documents of the Application Review and the Assessment Forms in sequence of approval number in the Approved file.
- Store the file on an appropriate shelf in the designated cabinet.

6. Glossary

- **Initial Review:** The first-time review of a protocol made by two or three individual reviewers (AWHSC-IRB members or non-members) in advance of the full IRB meeting. Comments of the reviewers will be reported to the IRB meeting.
- **Phase I studies:** Initial introduction of an investigational new drug (IND) in humans, studies designed to determine the metabolism and pharmacological actions of drugs in humans, and studies designed to assess the side effects associated with increasing doses.
- **Phase II study:** A Study of drug metabolism, structure-activity relationships, and mechanism of action in humans, as well as studies in which investigational drugs are used as research tools to explore biological phenomena or disease processes.
- **Phase III study:** A Study expands controlled and uncontrolled trials performed after preliminary evidence suggesting effectiveness of the drug has been obtained. They are intended to gather the additional information about effectiveness and safety that is needed to evaluate the overall benefit-risk relationship of the drug and to provide an adequate basis for physician labelling.
- **Phase IV study:** A study that seeks to expand an approved medication's use into a new population, new indication, or new dose. Stipulation Specify as terms of or condition for an agreement, contract, etc. state, put forward for a necessary condition.

7. ANNEX

ANNEX 1 AF 01-010: Application Form for Initial Review (2 pages)

8. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics IRBs that Review Biomedical Research, 2000.
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. Related SOPs: SOP# AWHSC 010, AWHSC 021



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/009/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 2 of 10
3.3. Initial review of Application protocol	

E-mail:.....

ANNEX 1
Form AF 01-010
Page 2 of 2

Application Form for Initial Review

Participating Investigators:

First / Last Name	License No.	Institution	Telephone / Fax
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			
6.			

TYPE OF REVIEW:	
☐ Initial Review ☐ Resubmission Review ☐ Amendment Review ☐ Expedited Review	☐ Emergency Review ☐ Continuing Review ☐ Report Review ☐ Protocol Termination
SIGNATURES:	
Principal Investigators	Date:
Protocol Chairperson (if applicable)	Date:.....
COMPLETION	
Secretary, AWHSC-IRB;	Date:.....
APPLICATION NUMBER: □□□ / □□ - □□	



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/010/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 1 of 5
3.4. Expedited Review	

Table of Contents

Table of Contents

1. Purpose.....	2
2. Scope.....	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Detailed instructions	3
5.1. Receive the submitted documents	3
5.2. Determine protocols for expedited review.	3
5.2.1. Modification /amendment of protocol	3
5.3. Expedited Process.....	4
5.4. Communicate with the AWHSC-IRB and the investigator.....	4
6. Glossary	4
7. ANNEX: none.....	5
8. References.....	5



3.4. Expedited Review

1. Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to provide criteria for determination of which study protocols can be reviewed through expedited process as well as instructions on management, review and approval of the expedited review

2. Scope

This SOP applies to the review and approval of study proposals with minimum risk to participants, protocol amendments or informed consent changes of currently approved studies.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the AWHSC-IRB members to define of which study protocols should be reviewed and approved through expedited channel.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1	Receive the submitted documents. ↓	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat
2	Determine protocols for expedited review. ↓	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat/ Chairperson
3	Expedite process ↓	AWHSC-IRB Members / Chairperson
4	Communicate with the AWHSC-IRB and the Investigator.	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat Members



3.4. Expedited Review

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Receive the submitted documents

- Receive the application documents submitted by investigators.
- Get contents of submitted package (checklist) form, AF 01-007 (see Annex 1 of SOP# AWHSC 007), to check items received.
- Stamp the receiving date on the letter and the documents.
- Sign the receiver's name on the receiving documents.
- Hand the received documents to the AWHSC-IRB Secretariat.

5.2. Determine protocols for expedited review.

- AWHSC-IRB Secretariat determines whether a study is qualified for expedited review according to the following criteria:

5.2.1. Modification /amendment of protocol

- administrative revisions, such as correction of types
- addition or deletion of non-procedural items, such as the addition of study personnel names, laboratories, etc.
- non-significant risk research activity
- the research activity includes only minor changes from previously approved protocol.

5.2.2. Proposals involve interviewing of a non-confidential nature (not of a private eg. relate to sexual preference etc.), not likely to harm the status or interests of the individual and not likely to offend the sensibilities of the people involved.

5.2.3. Those that involve collection of biological specimens for research purposes by non-invasive means (e.g. collection of body fluids or excreta noninvasively, collection of hair or nail clippings in a non-disfiguring or nonthreatening manner).

5.2.4. Collection of data for research purposes through non-invasive procedures (not involving general anaesthesia or sedation) routinely employed in clinical practice and using medical devices which have been already approved for use. Examples of such procedures include collection of data through application of EEG or ECG electrodes, acoustic testing, tests using the Doppler principle, non-invasive blood pressure and other routine clinical measurements, exercise tolerance etc. However, procedures involving the use of x-rays or microwaves are NOT recommended for expedited review.



3.4. Expedited Review

5.2.5. Research involving data, documents or specimens that have been already collected or will be collected for ongoing medical treatment or diagnosis.

5.2.6. Continuing review of research previously approved with no modifications to the original protocol and studies have taken place and no additional risks have been identified.

- If the protocol satisfied any of the criteria for expedited review, the Secretariat will send the protocol to Chairperson.

5.3. Expedited Process

- Chairperson nominates 2 or more AWHSC-IRB members to review the revised protocol.
- The selected members are normally those who reviewed and recommended the previous version of that protocol, if it is not submitted for the first time.
- The Secretariat sends the revised protocol to the selected members.
- Carry out the expedited review on the complete proposal (study protocol with all the attached documents as mentioned in the guidelines for submission of proposals - see AWHSCIRB GL 02).
- The review may be made either by circulation of comments, telephone discussion or meeting.
- If consensus cannot be reached, the chairperson will refer the proposal back to the AWHSC-IRB for a full review
- The expedited review should not take longer than 2 weeks
- Inform the AWHSC-IRB of the proposals approved by expedited review at its regular meetings.
- If any IRB member raises concern about any of the proposals presented to it as expedited review, then that proposal shall undergo a regular review.

5.4. Communicate with the AWHSC-IRB and the investigator.

- The reviewers forward their comments to the Secretariat.
- Full Board notification of items approved through expedited review by the Chairperson or the designee is accomplished by providing notification and source documentation of the items in the meeting agenda / notes.
- The AWHSC-IRB Secretariat communicates the decision to the investigator.

6. Glossary

Administrative Documents:

Documents include official minutes of Board meetings as described in Standard Operating Procedures, both historical and Master Files as described in SOP# AWHSC 026

Expedited approval:



3.4. Expedited Review

An AWHSC-IRB approval granted only by the Chairman of the AWHSC-IRB or a designated AWHSC-IRB member (not the full IRB) for minor changes to current AWHSC-IRB approved research activities and for research which involves no more than minimal risk.

Expedited review:

A review process by only two or more designated AWHSC-IRB members who then report the decision to the full Board meeting. An expedited review is a speedy one for minor changes to the approved protocol and for research proposal with minimal risk in nature.

7. ANNEX: none

-

8. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics IRBs that Review Biomedical Research, 2000.
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. Code of Federal Regulation (CFR) 21, Volume 8, Part 812, April 2003, Food and Drug Administration, U.S. Government Printing Office via GPO Access
4. Related SOPs: # AWHSC 007 and AWHSC 027; AWHSCIRB GL 02



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.5. Review of Medical Device Study/Evaluation	AWHSC-IRB SOP/011/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 1 of 12
---	---

Table of Contents

1. Purpose	2
2. Scope	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Detailed instructions	3
5.1. Submission of documents	3
5.2. Before the Board Meeting	4
5.3. During the Board Meeting	5
5.4. After the Meeting	5
5.4.1. Prepare Meeting Minutes	5
5.4.2. Notify the Investigators	6
5.4.3. Storage of the Documents	6
6. Glossary	6
7. References.....	7
8. Annex.....	7
Annex 1: Non-Significant Risk Device Studies	8
Annex 2: Significant Risk Device Studies	9



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/011/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 2 of 12
3.5. Review of Medical Device Study/Evaluation	

1. Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to provide instructions for review and approval of medical device studies submitted to the IRB.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to the submission and the review processes of protocols involving the study of new medical devices (Not registered by responsible regulatory authority in Ethiopia) in human study participants.

3. Responsibility

During the review of medical device studies, the IRB may make some different decision than those made during the review of drug studies. The IRB must determine if the proposed investigation has *Significant Risk (SR)* or *Non-significant Risk (NSR)*, and then the IRB should decide if the investigation is approved or not. In determining *SR* or *NSR*, the IRB must review all information submitted by the sponsor.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1	Submission of documents ↓	Investigator/IRB Secretariat
2	Activities before a Board meeting ↓	IRB Secretariat / members / Reviewers
3	Activities during a Board meeting ↓	IRB members / Secretariat / Chairperson
4	Activities after the meeting ↓	IRB Secretariat
5	Notify the investigators ↓	IRB Secretariat
6	Storage of the documents	IRB Secretariat



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.5. Review of Medical Device Study/Evaluation	AWHSC-IRB SOP/011/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 3 of 12
---	---

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Submission of documents

- Receive a new medical device study protocol
- Check the submitted package for completeness
- Receive Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) among collaborating parties for projects to be executed by two or more institutions
- Receive Material Transfer Agreement (MTA) between provider and recipient institutions for any biological material to be exported outside Ethiopia
- Document the checking procedure by completing a checklist form (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-007/01.1, Contents of a submitted package).
- At a minimum, the IRB must receive the following documents prior to review/approval of a medical device study:
 - Proposed investigational plan
 - Informed consent form
 - Description of the device
 - Description of participant selection criteria
 - Monitoring procedures
 - Reports of prior investigations conducted with the device
 - Investigator's Curriculum Vitae
 - Investigator's professional license (s)
 - Risk assessment data / information
 - Statistics used in making the risk determination.
 - Application for Review (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-011/01.1)
 - Document Received Form (AWHSC-IRB AF 05-007/01.1)
 - Copies of all labeling for investigational use only
- The sponsor should inform the IRB whether other IRBs have reviewed the proposed study and what determination was made.
- The sponsor should inform the IRB of the Agency's assessment of the device's risk if such an assessment has been made.
- If the Sponsor believes the study is *NSR*, supporting information must be submitted.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/011/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 4 of 12
3.5. Review of Medical Device Study/Evaluation	

- Contact the applicant to submit additional information or documents, if the application is complete.

5.2. Before the Board Meeting

- Assign reviewers to review the study, according to the assessment form
- Prepare the documents for distribution to each IRB member
- Send the documents to each IRB member



- Place the new medical device study on the meeting agenda

5.3. During the Board Meeting

- Reviewers present a brief oral or written summary of the protocol, ICF and relevant issues
- The chairperson opens discussion about whether the study is Significant Risk (*SR*) or Non-Significant Risk Device (*NSR*) (see examples in Annex 1 and 2: AWHSC-IRB AF 01-012/01.1; AWHSC -IRB AF 02-012/01.1)
- The Chairperson leads discussion about each document under consideration (e.g. protocol, informed consent, investigators and site qualifications, advertisements).
- Decide the degree of risk.
- Consider whether or not the study should be approved.
- The Chairperson calls for a separate vote on each element in review. The IRB votes to either:
 - Approve the study to start as presented with no modifications
 - Approve the study to start with minor modifications to item(s) noted at the convened meeting and to be followed-up by the Secretariat and Chairperson, after receiving the requested modifications
 - Require major modifications and/or request further information to be resubmitted and subjected to review in the next full Board meeting.
 - Disapprove the study and state the reason.
- Record the vote of risk assessment in the decision form (AWHSC-IRB AF 03-008/01.1) and the meeting minutes (AWHSC-IRB AF 02- 022/01.1).
- Note the recommendations for changes to the protocol and/or informed consent recommended by IRB members in the minutes as ‘with modifications made by Debre Berhan University’ and will be communicated to the investigator.
- Determine the frequency of Continuing Review for the approved study.

5.4. After the Meeting

5.4.1. Prepare Meeting Minutes

- Follow the procedure in AWHSC-IRB SOP/022/01.



5.4.2. Notify the Investigators

- The Secretariat sends an action letter along with the approved documents to the investigator. The letter contains, at a minimum, a listing of each document approved, the date set by the IRB for frequency of continuing review, and a review of other obligations and expectations from the investigator throughout the course of the study.
- If the Board votes not to approve the study, the Chairperson or Secretariat immediately notifies the investigator in writing of the decision and the reason for disapproving the study. If the investigator wishes to appeal this decision, he or she may do so by contacting AWHSC-IRB. This process is stated in the action letter provided to the investigator.
- If the IRB votes to require modifications to any of the documents, the Secretariat either generates the revisions to the documents, or sends a written request of the specific changes to the investigator asking him or her to make the necessary changes and resubmit the documents to the AWHSC-IRB.

5.4.3. Storage of the Documents

- 5.4.3.1. Prepare an appropriate label.
- 5.4.3.2. Store the document packages in the shelf for active files.

6. Glossary

Investigational Medical Device	Any health care product that does not achieve any of its intended purposes by chemical action or by being metabolized and do not cause more than minimum risk/s. medical devices may include but not limited to items such as diagnostic test kits, electrodes, prescribed beds, Blood pressure apparatus, stethoscope, A medical device which is the object of clinical research to determine its safety or effective;ess.
Non-significant Risk Device (NSR)	An investigational device that does not pose more than minimum risk/s significant risk. A list of examples is found in Annex 1 (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-012/01.1)
Risk	The probability of harm or discomfort to study participants.



Acceptable risk differs depending on the conditions for which the product is being tested. A product for sore throat, for example, will be expected to have a low incidence of side effects. However, unpleasant side effects may be an acceptable risk when testing a promising treatment for a life-threatening illness.

**Significant Risk
Device (SR)**

An investigational device that:

- (1) is intended as an implant and presents a potential for serious risk to the health, safety, or welfare of the participant,
- (2) is purported or represented to be for a use in supporting or sustaining human life and presents a potential for serious risk to the health, safety, or welfare of the participant,
- (3) is for a use of substantial importance in diagnosing, curing, mitigating, or treating disease, or otherwise preventing impairment of human health and presents a potential for serious risk to the health, safety, or welfare of the participant, or
- (4) Otherwise presents a potential for serious risk to the health, safety, or welfare of the participant. A list of examples is found in Annex 2 (AWHSC-IRB AF 02- 012/01.1)

7. References

1. CFR – Code of Federal Regulation Title 21, Part 812, Food and Drug Administration, USA,
2018.<https://accessdata.fda.gov/scripts/cdrh/cfdocs/cfcfr/CFRSearch.cfm?CFRPart=812&showFR=1>, accessed July 28, 2019
2. Associated SOP: AWHSC-IRB SOP/007-010/01.0; AWHSC-IRB SOP/022/01.1

8. Annex

- ANNEX 1 Examples of Non-significant Risk Device Studies
ANNEX 2 Examples of Significant Risk Device Studies



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.5. Review of Medical Device Study/Evaluation	AWHSC-IRB SOP/011/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 8 of 12
---	---

Annex 1: Non-Significant Risk Device Studies

EXAMPLES:

- Point of care laboratory technologies and conventional methods
 - HIV early infant diagnosis
 - HIV viral load testing
 - TB diagnosis except radiation emitting equipment
 - Rapid diagnostic tests
 - Other disease specific diagnostic tests



Annex 2: Significant Risk Device Studies

EXAMPLES:

General Medical Use

Catheters:

- Cardiology – diagnostic, treatment, transluminal coronary angioplasty, intra-aortic balloon with control system
- Gastroenterology and Urology – biliary and urologic
- General Hospital – long-term percutaneous, implanted, subcutaneous and intravascular
- Neurology – cerebrovascular, occlusion balloon
- Collagen Implant Material for use in ear, nose and throat, orthopedics and plastic surgery
- Lasers for use in Ob/Gyn, cardiology, gastro-enterology, urology, pulmonary, ophthalmology and neurology
- Tissue Adhesives for use in neurology, gastro-enterology, ophthalmology, general and plastic surgery, and cardiology

Anesthesiology

- Respiratory Ventilators
- Electro-anesthesia Apparatus
- Gas Machines for Anesthesia or Analgesia
- High Frequency Jet Ventilators greater than 150 BPM

Cardiovascular

- Arterial Embolization Device
- Artificial Heart, permanent implant and short-term use
- Cardiac Bypass Systems: oxygenator, cardiopulmonary blood pump, ventricular assist devices
- Cardiac Pacemaker/Pulse Generator: implantable, external transcutaneous, ant tachycardia, esophageal
- Cardiovascular/Intravascular Filters



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.5. Review of Medical Device Study/Evaluation	AWHSC-IRB SOP/011/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 10 of 12
---	--

- Coronary Artery Retro Perfusion System
- DC-Defibrillators
- Implantable Cardioverters
- Laser Coronary Angioplasty Device
- Pacemaker Programmer
- Percutaneous Conduction Tissue Ablation Electrode
- Replacement Heart Valve
- Vascular and Arterial Graft Prostheses



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.5. Review of Medical Device Study/Evaluation	AWHSC-IRB SOP/011/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 11 of 12
---	--

DENTAL

- Endosseous Implant

Ear, Nose and Throat

- Cochlear Implant
- Total Ossicular Prosthesis Replacement
- Gastroenterology and Urology
- Anastomosis Device
- Endoscope and/or Accessories
- Extracorporeal Hyperthermia System
- Extracorporeal Photophoresis System
- Extracorporeal Shock-Wave Lithotripters
- Kidney Perfusion System
- Mechanical/Hydraulic Impotence and Incontinence Devices
- Implantable Penile Prosthesis
- Peritoneal Shunt

General and Plastic Surgery

- Absorbable Hemostatic Agents
- Artificial Skin
- Injectable Silicone
- Implantable Protheses: chin, nose, cheek, ear
- Sutures

General Hospital

- Infusion Pumps: Implantable and closed-loop, depending on infused drug



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 3.5. Review of Medical Device Study/Evaluation	AWHSC-IRB SOP/011/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 12 of 12
---	--

- Implantable Vascular Access Devices

Neurology

- Hydrocephalus Shunts
- Implanted Intracerebral/Subcortical Stimulator
- Implanted Intracranial Pressure Monitor
- Implanted Spinal Cord and Nerve Stimulators and Electrodes

Obstetrics and Gynecology

- Cervical Dilator
- Chorionic Villus Sampling Catheter, phase II (pregnancy continued to term)
- Contraceptive Devices: tubal occlusion, cervical cap, diaphragm, intrauterine device (IUD) and introducer, and sponge

Ophthalmic

- Extended Wear Contacts Lens
- Intraocular Lens (investigations subject to 21 CFR 813)
- Eye Valve Implant
- Retinal Reattachment Systems: sulfur hexafluoride, silicone oil, tacks, perfluoro propane

Orthopedics

- Implantable Prostheses: ligament, tendon, hip, knee, finger
- Bone Growth Stimulator
- Calcium Tri-Phosphate/Hydroxyapatite Ceramics
- Xenografts

Radiology

- Hyperthermia Systems and Applicators



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/012/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
4.1. Review of Protocol Amendments	Page 1 of 9



Table of Contents

1. Purpose..... 2

2. Scope..... 3

3. Responsibility 3

4. Flow chart 3

5. Detailed instructions 3

5.1. Manage the Amendment Package.3

5.2. Notify the IRB coordinator of the AWHSC-IRB.4

5.3. Determine whether expedited or full review.....4

5.4. Expedited Review5

5.5. Full Review by the AWHSC-IRB5

5.6. Protocol Amendment Review Process5

5.6.1 Review amended protocols5

5.6.2. Verbal Communication of the Decision6

5.6.3. Preliminary Written Communication of the Decision.....6

5.6.4. Completion of the Amendment Submission Form6

5.7. Notify the Principal Investigator.7

5.8. Store documents.....7

6. Glossary 7

7. ANNEX..... 8

8. References..... 8

Protocol Amendment Submission Form 8



1. Purpose

The purpose of this procedure is to describe how protocol amendments are managed and reviewed by the AWHSC-IRB.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to previously approved study protocols but later being amended and submitted for approval by the AWHSC-IRB. Amendments made to protocols may not be implemented until reviewed and approved by the AWHSC-IRB.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the AWHSC-IRB Secretariat to manage protocol amendments. Investigators may amend the contents of protocols from time to time. Protocol amendments may be submitted for either “expedited” review by the IRB coordinator / Secretariat/members / reviewers or full AWHSC-IRB review.

4. Flow chart

No	Activity	Responsibility
1.	Manage the Amendment Package ↓	AWHSC-IRB coordinator
2.	Notify the IRB coordinator of the AWHSC-IRB ↓	AWHSC-IRB coordinator
3.	Determine whether Expedited or Full Review ↓	IRB officer/chair person
4.	Expedited Review ↓	IRB officer/chair person
5.	Full Board Review ↓	IRB officer/chair person
6.	Amendment Review Process ↓	AWHSC-IRB members / IRB coordinator
7.	Notify the Principal Investigator	IRB officer

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Manage the Amendment Package.

- The amendment package is prepared by the PI.
- Upon receipt of the amendment package, the Secretariat of the AWHSC-IRB should follow the receiving procedure in SOP# AWHSC-IRB 007 (Management of Protocol Submission) and SOP# AWHSC-IRB 024 - Procedure for Maintaining Confidentiality of AWHSC-IRB Documents.



- **Request for Amendment Memorandum** of the Protocol by the Principal Investigator on an existing and previously approved protocol. The memorandum should:
 - ❖ State/describe the amendment
 - ❖ Provide the reason for the amendment
 - ❖ State any untoward effects with original protocol
 - ❖ State expected untoward effects because of the amendment
- ***Original Amendment Submission Form***
 - ❖ Check for completeness and for the presence of the required signatures (Principal Investigator or Medical Advisor of the Institute, if applicable). See ANNEX 1 on page 9.
- ***Protocol and Related Documents***
 - ❖ The amended version of the protocol and related documents should be provided.
 - ❖ The changes or modifications should be underlined or highlighted.

5.2. Notify the IRB coordinator of the AWHSC-IRB.

- ✚ Upon receipt of the amendment package, the Secretariat should inform the IRB coordinator of the AWHSC-IRB verbally or in writing.
- ✚ Keep “Sent” and “Received” mail related to the notification of the IRB coordinator in the protocol file under the Correspondence section.
- ✚ Send the request for amendment memorandum and the protocol and related documents to the IRB coordinator within one working day of receipt by the Secretariat.
- ✚ Follow AWHSC-IRB SOP# AWHSC-IRB 001 in preparing and distributing the documents.
- ✚ After review of the materials, the IRB coordinator will determine whether the protocol requires expedited or full review.

5.3. Determine whether expedited or full review.

- ❖ Refer to SOP# AWHSC-IRB 009 for Expedited Review
- Refer to SOP# AWHSC-IRB-010 for Full Review.
- Protocol amendment which increases risk to study participants, as judged by the IRB coordinator, such as a change in study design, which may include but is not limited to:
 - additional treatments or the deletion of treatments
 - any changes in inclusion/exclusion criteria
 - change in method of dosage formulation, such as, oral changed to intravenous



- significant change in the number of subjects (Increase: if there are <20 subjects enrolled, change of 5 is significant; if there are >20 subjects enrolled, a change of 20% is significant – Decrease: if the decrease in the number of subjects alters the fundamental characteristics of the study, it is significant)
- significant decrease or increase in dosage amount
- If the IRB coordinator decides the protocol requires full AWHSC-IRB approval, the IRB coordinator will indicate this decision on the Checklist, sign and date the form.
- The Secretariat places the protocol amendment request on the agenda for the next convened meeting.
- The following documents are distributed to each AWHSC-IRB member:
 - The amendment's revision documents to clearly identify each change.
 - Requested changes to the consent form, if applicable
- If an amendment is received just prior to the AWHSC-IRB meeting, the IRB coordinator may decide to review the amendment in full AWHSC-IRB, even though the amendment may be expedited.

5.4.Expedited Review

- ❖ Refer to SOP# 009 for expedited review procedure.

5.5.Full Review by the AWHSC-IRB

- ❖ Refer to SOP# 010 for full Board Review.

5.6.Protocol Amendment Review Process

5.6.1 Review amended protocols

- ❖ Use the process outlined in the Application Assessment Form (see AWHSC-IRB SOP# 008) to review amended protocols and protocol-related documents.
- ✚ Note recommendations for changes to the protocol and/or informed consent requested by AWHSC-IRB Members in the minutes as “with modifications made by the AWHSC-IRB and will be communicated to the clinical trial office or investigator.
- ✚ The IRB coordinator or designee calls for a vote on the proposed amendment to:
 - Approve the protocol amendment as is with no modification of the informed consent
 - Require a modification to the proposed amendment or informed consent documents, stating the reason and action required to sustain the study with follow-up by the IRB coordinator
 - Require a modification to the proposed amendment or informed consent documents, stating the reason and action required to sustain the study with follow-up by the IRB coordinator



- Require a modification to the proposed amendment or informed consent documents, stating the reason and action required to sustain the study with a follow-up full AWHSC-IRB review
 - Suspend the study, until further information is obtained
 - Not suspend the study as currently approved, but request further information regarding the amendment and the effects of the amendments on the approved study
 - Not approve the amendment request, stating the reason – but allow the study to continue as previously approved
- ✚ If the AWHSC-IRB approves the protocol amendment, the Secretariat staff communicates this decision to the investigator.
- ✚ If the AWHSC-IRB does not approve the protocol amendment, the IRB coordinator immediately notifies the investigator in writing of the decision and the reason for not approving the amendment.
- ✚ If the AWHSC-IRB votes to require modifications to any of the documents, or the protocol amendment, the Secretariat sends a written request about the specific changes to the investigator asking him or her to make the necessary changes and resubmit the documents to the AWHSC-IRB
- ✚ The IRB coordinator completes a decision form (AWHSC-IRB- 02-008) after the AWHSC-IRB has reached its decision.
- ✚ Keep the forms, minutes of the meeting relevant to the discussion and the decision reached by the AWHSC-IRB as the official records of the amendment review process.

5.6.2. Verbal Communication of the Decision

The IRB coordinator notifies the Principal Investigator verbally after the AWHSC-IRB meeting and in writing as soon as possible, but no later than 7 working days following the review.

5.6.3. Preliminary Written Communication of the Decision

The IRB coordinator must send an electronic version or fax a copy of the Amendment Submission Form with his/her signature and date of approval to the Secretariat in three working days or whenever possible, but no later than seven working days after the review has taken place.

5.6.4. Completion of the Amendment Submission Form

- ✓ The IRB coordinator must sign and date the original version of this form and return this to the Secretariat no later than 5 working days after the review.
- ✓ Addition of Amendment to the Protocol Number
 - The Secretariat assigns a letter to the protocol number that corresponds to the number of the amendment. For example:
 - The third amendment to the AWHSC-IRB would be formatted as: AWHSC-IRB 015/01-03



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/012/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
4.1. Review of Protocol Amendments	Page 7 of 9

- ✓ Record the amended protocol number on the form.
- ✓ The Secretariat signs and dates the original version of the form.

5.7. Notify the Principal Investigator.

- ❖ Send a signed and dated Amendment Submission Form to the Principal Investigator (P.I.) for their records no later than 7 working days.
- ❖ The Clinical Trials Office or the P.I. should then provide a “clean” copy (*underlining and highlighting removed*) of the protocol and related documents as well as the “clean” electronic version (where applicable) to the Secretariat of the AWHSC-IRB.

5.8. Store documents.

- ❖ Place the original completed documents, the “clean” version of the protocol and related documents in the protocol file with the other documents pertaining to the amendment.

6. Glossary

Amendment protocol package	A package of the amended parts and related documents of the protocol, previously approved by the AWHSC-IRB. In the Course of the study, the PI may decide to make changes in the protocol.
Clinical trial office	an institute or an office where the study takes place and where the principal investigator and/or his/her staff may be reached.
Expedited approval	AWHSC-IRB approval granted only by the IRB coordinator of the AWHSC-IRB or a designated AWHSC-IRB member (not the full AWHSC-IRB) for minor changes to current AWHSC-IRB approved research activities and for research which involves no more than minimal risk, as stated in the SOP# AWHSC-IRB- 009.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/012/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
4.1. Review of Protocol Amendments	Page 8 of 9

7. ANNEX

ANNEX 1 AWHSC-IRB- 01-012 Protocol Amendment Submission Form

8. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committees that Review Biomedical Research, 2000
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. Code of Federal Regulation (CFR) 21, Volume 8, Part 812, April 2003, Food and Drug Administration, U.S. Government Printing Office GPO
4. Access Relevant SOPs: SOP# AWHSC-IRB 007, 008, 009, 010 and 024
5. National Health Research Ethics Review Guideline. Addis Ababa, Ethiopia. 4th edition revised in June 20



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/012/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
4.1. Review of Protocol Amendments	Page 9 of 9

ANNEX 1

Form AF 01-012

Protocol Amendment Submission Form

PROTOCOL NUMBER:	SUBMITTED DATE:
PROTOCOL TITLE:	
PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:	
Department:	Telephone:
APPROVED DATE:	NO. OF AMENDMENT:
REASON FOR THE AMENDMENT:	
TYPE OF AMENDMENT REQUESTED: a. EXPEDITED (Minor changes) b. FULL REVIEW BY AWHSC-IRB (More than minor changes or that amendment “materially affects risks to subjects”) SIGNATURES: _____Date: Principal Investigator	
COMMENTS: ☐ EXPEDITED (Minor changes) ☐ FULL REVIEWED APPROVALS _____Date: Chairperson, AWHSC-IRB COMPLETION _____Date: Coordinator, AWHSC-IRB	
PROTOCOL NUMBER: AWHSC-IRB _____ ☐ ☐ ☐	



Table of Contents

1. <u>Purpose</u>	11
2. <u>Scope</u>	11
3. <u>Responsibility</u>	11
4. <u>Flow chart</u>	11
5. <u>Detailed instructions</u>	11
5.1. <u>Receive protocol resubmitted package</u>	11
5.2. <u>Review the revised protocol</u>	11
☐ <u>Refer to the meeting minutes as guidance for the review</u>	11
☐ <u>Consider whether the recommendation of the AWHSC-IRB has been followed</u>	11
☐ <u>Make further comments where appropriate</u>	11
☐ <u>Sign and date the reviewer's name</u>	12
☐ <u>Notify the AWHSC-IRB IRB Coordinator</u>	12
5.3. <u>AWHSC-IRB meeting</u>	12
5.4. <u>Document the AWHSC-IRB decision</u>	12
5.5. <u>Communicate the decision</u>	12
5.5.1. <u>Written Communication of the Decision</u>	12
<u>Glossary</u>	13
6. <u>ANNEX</u>	13
7. <u>References</u>	13
<u>Review of Resubmitted Protocol Checklist</u>	14



1. Purpose

This procedure describes how resubmitted study protocols are managed, re-reviewed and approved by the AWHSC-IRB.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to study protocols that have been reviewed earlier with recommendations from AWHSC-IRB for some corrections in the initial review process.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the AWHSC-IRB IRB Coordinator to ensure the completeness of the resubmitted documents and to notify the IRB Coordinator that a protocol previously approved with conditions for revision has been resubmitted to the AWHSC-IRB for reconsideration.

A re-submitted protocol may be reviewed and approved by either the IRB Coordinator or some AWHSC-IRB members/reviewers, or full AWHSC-IRB. How the protocol will be reviewed should have been determined by the AWHSC-IRB at the time of the initial review. This information can be found on the Decision Section of the Assessment Form.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1.	Receive protocol resubmitted package ↓	AWHSC-IRB IRB officer
2.	Review the revised protocol ↓	AWHSC-IRB IRB officer/ members
3.	Document the AWHSC-IRB decision ↓	AWHSC-IRB IRB officer
4.	Communicate the decision	AWHSC-IRB IRB officer

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Receive protocol resubmitted package.

☐ Check the distributed packages for:

- Memorandum addressing the corrections,
- Initial Review Application Form (AA 01-010, see ANNEX 1 of SOP# AA 010)
- Revised version of protocol and related documents such as the informed consent document, data collection or case report forms, diary sheets, etc are included as part of the package.
- Changes made to the documents should be underlined or highlighted.



☐ Sign and date an acknowledgement form upon receiving the packages.

5.2. Review the revised protocol.

- Refer to the meeting minutes as guidance for the review.
- Consider whether the recommendation of the AWHSC-IRB has been followed.
- Make further comments where appropriate.



- Sign and date the reviewer's name.
- Notify the AWHSC-IRB IRB Coordinator.

5.3. AWHSC-IRB meeting

- ❖ The IRB Coordinator receives the review report and informs the IRB Coordinator.
- ❖ If no AWHSC-IRB meeting is necessary, then go to step 5.4.
- ❖ If the AWHSC-IRB previously decided to see the new revision, then proceed with the following steps:
 - ❖ The primary reviewer presents a brief oral or written summary of the study design and his/her comments to the AWHSC-IRB members.
 - ❖ The IRB Coordinator entertains discussion on the protocol revision.
 - ❖ Further recommendations for modifications to the protocol, consent form, and/or advertisements as requested by the Committee are noted in the meeting minutes as 'with modifications made by AWHSC-IRB and will be communicated to the investigator.
 - ❖ The IRB Coordinator calls for a vote on the revision to either:
 - Approve the study to start as presented with no modifications = ***Approved***
 - Approve the study to start with Committee approved modifications to the consent = ***Approved with minor modification***

Require modifications to items noted at the convened meeting and follow-up by the IRB Coordinator,

after receipt of the requested modifications = ***Approved with major modification***

- ***Disapproved***

5.4. Document the AWHSC-IRB decision.

- Place the original completed documents along with the completed re-review report, the Assessment Form and the Initial Review Application Form as well as the others in the protocol package.
- Prepare an approval letter.
- Send an approval letter to the principal investigator.
- Get the IRB Coordinator's signature.

5.5. Communicate the decision.

5.5.1. Written Communication of the Decision

- The IRB Coordinator notifies the principal investigator about the decision of the AWHSC-IRB through an e-mail, memo or telephone and files the "sent" and "received" e-mail messages in the protocol file.



- The IRB Coordinator then prepares the Approval/Action Letter and gets the IRB Coordinator's signature.
- ❖ If the study is approved, the Committee determines the frequency of Continuing Review for each study site.
 - ✓ The IRB Coordinator sends an Action Letter to the investigator notifying the AWHSC-IRB decision and schedule of continuing review.
 - ✓ The letter contains, at a minimum, a listing of each document approved, the date set by the Committee for frequency of continuing review, and a review of other obligations and expectations from the investigator throughout the course of the study.
 - ✓ A computer-generated approval and expiration date is placed on every page of each consent form approved by the AWHSC-IRB.
- ❖ If the Committee requires modifications to any of the documents, the IRB Coordinator either generates the revisions to the documents, or sends written request of the specific changes to the investigator to make the necessary changes and resubmit the documents to the AWHSC-IRB.

Glossary

Document: All kinds of evidence to include paper documents, electronic mail (e-mail), fax, audio or videotape

Completed Assessment Form: An official record of the review decision along with comments and dated signature of the reviewer.

6. ANNEX

ANNEX 1 AF 01-013 Re-review Report Form

7. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committees that Review Biomedical Research, 2000 www.who.int/tdr/publications/publications/.
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. Related SOPs: SOP# AA 010.



Review of Resubmitted Protocol Checklist

Protocol No.: AWHSC-IRB ____		Application No.: ____ / ____ - ____	
Protocol Title:			
Total Participants:		☐ 2 nd Review ☐ 3 rd Review ☐ 4 th Review	
Principal Investigator:			Tel.:
Initial Review Date:		Last Review Date:	
AWHSC-IRB Decision recorded in the meeting minute:		☐ Approved with minor changes or recommendation ☐ Major changes or recommendation need to be reconsidered	
Opinion of the reviewer: ➤ Revision or Modification according to the recommendation ➤ ☐ What need to be further revised:		☐ Yes ☐ ☐ No: Explain: _____	
SIGNATURES: _____ Date: _____ Protocol Reviewer			
APPROVAL: _____ Date: _____ IRB Coordinator, AWHSC-IRB			



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/014/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 1 of 9
4.3. Management of Protocol Continuing Reviews	

Table of Contents

Table of Contents	1
1. Purpose.....	2
2. Scope.....	2
3. Responsibility.....	2
4. Flow chart	3
5. Detailed instructions	3
5.1. Determine the date of continuing review.....	3
5.2. Notify the principal investigator or the study team.....	3
5.3. Manage continuing review package upon receipt.....	3
5.3.1. Initial and date the submission package	4
5.3.2. Verify the contents of the package.	4
5.3.3. Photocopy the package.	4
5.3.4. Store the continuing review package.	4
5.4. Notify the Members of the AWHSC-IRB.....	4
5.5. Prepare meeting agenda	4
5.6. Protocol Review Process.....	5
5.6.1 Continuing Review Application Form	5
5.6.2 Final Documentation and Communication of the Decision	6
5.7. Store original documents.	6
5.8. Distribute documents to the Study Team.	6
6. Glossary	6
7. ANNEX.....	7
8. References.....	7
Continuing Review Application Form	8



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/014/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 2 of 9
4.3. Management of Protocol Continuing Reviews	

1. Purpose

This procedure describes how the Ethics Committee manages continuing reviews of previously approved protocols.

The purpose of the continuing review is to monitor the progress of the entire study, not just the changes in it, to ensure continuous protection of the rights and welfare of research participants. Continuing review of the study may not be conducted through an expedited review procedure, unless 1) the study was eligible for, and initially reviewed by, an expedited review procedure; or 2) the study has changed such that the only activities remaining are eligible for expedited review.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to conducting any continuing review of study protocols involving human subjects at intervals appropriate to the degree of risk but not less than once a year. Depending upon the degree of risk to the participants, the nature of the studies, and the vulnerability of the study participants and duration of the study, they may choose to review or monitor the protocols more frequently.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the IRB Coordinator to remind the AWHSC-IRB and the principal investigators regarding study protocols that should be continuously reviewed. The Chairperson, in consultation with AWHSC-IRB, is responsible for determining the date of continuing review.

The AWHSC-IRB is responsible for reviewing the progress made in the protocol, the occurrence of unexpected events or problems, and the rate of accrual of participants. The protocol informed consent documents and assent documents are examined to ensure that the information remains accurate.

The AWHSC-IRB has the same options for decision making on a continuing review package as for an initial review package. The decision is made as approval; approval with recommendations; approval with stipulations, pending, or disapproval



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/014/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 3 of 9
4.3. Management of Protocol Continuing Reviews	

4. Flow chart

<u>S No</u>	<u>Activities</u>	<u>Responsi bility</u>
1.	Determine the date of continuing review	IRB Officer
2.	Notify the study	IRB Officer
3.	Manage continuing review package upon receipt	IRB Officer
4.	Notify the members of the AWHSC-IRB	IRB Officer
5.	Prepare meeting agenda	IRB Officer
6.	Protocol review process	IRB Officer, IRB members
7.	Store original documents	IRB Officer
8.	Distribute documents to the study team	IRB Officer

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. *Determine the date of continuing review*

- Look through the document archives for the due date of continuing reviews.
- Plan for continuing review meeting at least two months ahead and as close as possible to the due date or the anniversary of the effectivity date. (Date of original approval) of the protocol.
- Consult the Chairperson for scheduling the Board meeting date.

5.2. **Notify the principal investigator or the study team**

- ✚ Inform the Study Team at least **two months in advance** of the due date for the continuing review by fax, post, e-mail or other appropriate means.
- ✚ Fax, mail or e-mail also a Continuing Review Application Form (AWHSC-IRB 01-014, see ANNEX 1) to the Study Team to fill up.
- ✚ Keep the informed notice in the correspondence file.
- ✚ Allow the Study Team sufficient time to collate the information and to prepare a report package required for the continuing review

5.3. **Manage continuing review package upon receipt.**

Receive a package of continuing review for each protocol prepared and submitted by the Study Team.

Upon receipt of the package, the Secretariat of the AWHSC-IRB should perform the following:



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/014/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 4 of 9
4.3. Management of Protocol Continuing Reviews	

5.3.1. Initial and date the submission package

- See SOP# AWHSC-IRB 007 for procedures on receipt of submitted packages.

5.3.2. Verify the contents of the package.

- Make sure that the contents of the package include:
 - **Continuing Review Application Form**
 - ✓ Check for complete information and for the presence of the required signatures
 - ✓ See ANNEX 1 for the Continuing Review Application Form (AWHSC-IRB 01-013).
 - **Continuing Review Memorandum** with progress report
 - ✓ Summarize the progress of the protocol since the time of the last review.
 - ✓ Include information about the number of participants enrolled to date and since the time of the last review, an explanation for any “yes” answers on the application form and a discussion of scientific development, either through the conduct of this study or similar research that may alter risks to research participants.
 - **Current Informed Consent Document**
 - ✓ Both printed and electronic copies in the Local Area Network (where applicable) in the following drive:
 - ✓ C:\AWHSC-IRBdoc\informconsent\continuereview\file name
 - Verify electronic Informed Consent Document (where applicable).
 - ❖ Check if the electronic copy for matches the hard copy submitted by the study team.
 - ❖ Store the hard copy with the submitted documents.
 - ❖ Clearly identify the document as the hard copy of the electronic informed consent document.
 - ❖ Ensure that the version of the informed consent document is the most recently approved informed consent document.

5.3.3. Photocopy the package.

- Make sufficient copies (for both members and reviewers) of the original continuing review package in accordance with AWHSC-IRB 026 – Procedures for Maintaining Confidentiality of AWHSC-IRB Documents.

5.3.4. Store the continuing review package.

- Store the original package in the protocol specific file.

5.4. Notify the Members of the AWHSC-IRB

- Distribute the protocol progress report and the informed consent document to the AWHSC-IRB.

5.5. Prepare meeting agenda

- See SOP# AWHSC-IRB 021 for procedures on the preparation of meeting agenda.
- Place the review on the agenda for the meeting of the AWHSC-IRB which coincides with the anniversary of the protocol effective date (original approval date).
- Distribute the materials to the AWHSC-IRB members by electronic mail (e-mail), fax or by post, according to SOP# AWHSC-IRB 026 (Procedures for Maintaining Confidentiality of AWHSC-IRB Documents) at least one and a half to two weeks in advance of the scheduled meeting.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/014/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 5 of 9
4.3. Management of Protocol Continuing Reviews	

- Keep copies of “sent” e-mail, fax cover memos and/or letter accompanying posted materials in the Correspondence Section of the protocol specific file.
- Record and keep the AWHSC-IRB members’ response upon receipt of the agenda in the member correspondence file.

5.6. Protocol Review Process

5.6.1 Continuing Review Application Form

- Use the Continuing Review Application Form (AWHSC-IRB 01-014, see ANNEX 1) to guide the review and deliberation process.
- Sign and date the Continuing Review Application Form by the Chairperson of the AWHSC-IRB after a decision has been reached.
 - The completed Continuing Review Applications Form is the official record of the decision reached by the AWHSC-IRB for the protocol.
- Maintain and keep the form and minutes of the meeting relevant to the continuing review as part of the official record of the review process.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/014/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 6 of 9
4.3. Management of Protocol Continuing Reviews	

5.6.2. Final Documentation and Communication of the Decision

- ✚ Complete the printed version of the Continuing Review Application/ Assessment Form by the Chairperson of the AWHSC-IRB:
 - Sign and date the printed version of the form containing the decision and return this to the Secretariat.
 - Complete the process within 7 working days of the AWHSC-IRB meeting.
- ✚ Complete the original version of the Continuing Review Application Form by the Chairperson:
 - ✓ Sign and date the original version of the form.
 - ✓ The Secretariat must sign and date the form.

5.7. Store original documents.

- Place the original completed documents with the other documents in the Continuing Review Package in the protocol file.

5.8. Distribute documents to the Study Team.

- Distribute copy version of the completed Continuing Review Application/Assessment Form to the Principal Investigator within 7 working days

6. Glossary

Approved Protocols:

- Protocols that have been *approved without stipulations* or *approved with recommendations* by the AWHSC-IRB may proceed.
- Protocols that have been *approved with stipulations* by the AWHSC-IRB may not proceed until the conditions set by the AWHSC-IRB in the decision have been met. Protocols should be amended and submitted to the AWHSC-IRB within *one* month for re-review.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/014/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 7 of 9
4.3. Management of Protocol Continuing Reviews	

7. ANNEX

ANNEX 1 AF 01-014: Continuing Review Application Form (2 pages)

8. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committees that Review Biomedical Research, 2000
www.who.int/tdr/publications/publications/
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. Related SOPs # AWHSC-IRB 007, 026, and 021



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/014/01.1 Effective Date: 30/11/2025 Page 8 of 9
4.3. Management of Protocol Continuing Reviews	

ANNEX 1: Form AF 01-01
Page 1 of 2

Continuing Review Application Form

Protocol no.: _____	Assigned no.: _____
Protocol title: _____	
Institute medical advisor: _____	
Action requested: Renew - new participant accrual to Continue renew - enrolled participant Follow up only terminate - protocol discontinued Have there been any amendments since the last review? ☐ No ☐ Yes (describe briefly in attached narrative) Summary of protocol participants: _____ Accrual Ceiling Set By AWHSC-IRB _____ New Participants Accrued Since Last Review _____ Total Participants Accrued Since Protocol began Accrual exclusions None _____ Male _____ female _____ Other (specify: _____) Impaired participants None _____ physically _____ cognitively _____ both _____ Have there been any changes in the participant population, recruitment or selection criteria since the last review? ☐ No ☐ Yes (explain changes in attached narrative)	Has any information appeared in the literature, or evolved from this or similar research that might affect the IEC/IRB's evaluation of the risk/benefit analysis of human subjects involved in this protocol? ☐ No ☐ Yes (discuss in the attached narrative) Have any unexpected complications or side effects been noted since last review? ☐ No ☐ Yes (discuss in the attached narrative) Have any participants withdrawn from this study since the last IEC/IRB approval? ☐ No ☐ Yes (discuss in the attached narrative) Investigational new drug/device ☐ None ☐ IND ☐ IDE DACA No. Name: Sponsor: Holder: Ionizing radiation use (x-rays, radioisotopes, etc) ☐ None ☐ Medically indicated only Have any participating investigators been added or deleted since last review? ☐ No ☐ Yes (identify all changes in the attached narrative)



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/014/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 9 of 9
4.3. Management of Protocol Continuing Reviews	

Page 2 of 2

Have there been any changes in the informed consent process or documentation since the last review? ☐ No ☐ Yes (explain changes in attached narrative) Change In Medical Advisor / Investigator? ☐ NONE: _____ ☐ DELETE: _____ ☐ ADD: _____	Have any new collaborating sites (institutions) been added or deleted since the last review? ☐ No ☐ Yes (identify all changes and provide an explanation of changes in the attached narrative) Have any investigators developed an equity or consultative relationship with a source related to this protocol which might be considered a conflict of interest? ☐ NO ☐ YES (Append a statement of disclosure)
--	--

SIGNATURES:

AWHSC-IRB Comment/ Decision: COMPLETION

_____ Date: _____

AWHSC-IRB Reviewer

APPROVALS

_____ Date: _____

Coordinator, AWHSC-IRB



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 4.4. Review of Final Report	AWHSC-IRB SOP/015/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 10 of 13
--	---

Table of Contents

1.	Purpose.....	11
2.	Scope.....	11
3.	Responsibility	11
4.	Flow chart	11
5.	Detailed instructions	11
5.1.	Before each Committee meeting	11
5.2.	During the Committee meeting.....	12
5.3.	After the Committee meeting.....	12
6.	Glossary	12
7.	ANNEX.....	12
8.	References.....	12
	Study Report Form	13



1. Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to provide instructions on the review and follow-up, if appropriate, of Final Reports for any study previously approved by the AWHSC-IRB.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to the review and follow-up of the Final Report which is an obligatory review of each investigator's activities presented as a written report of studies completed to the AWHSC-IRB.

Although the AWHSC-IRB provides a Study Report Form (AWHSC-IRB SOP 01-015, see ANNEX 1) to the investigator, any mechanism (letter format, form provided by the Sponsor, etc.) may be used, provided that the information submitted is sufficient.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the AWHSC-IRB SOP/IRB secretariat to review the report for completeness before making copies for the committee meeting.

4. Flow chart

<u>No.</u>	<u>Activity</u>	<u>Responsibility</u>
1.	Receive and check report package	AWHSC-IRB officer
2.	Brief chairperson	AWHSC-IRB officer
3.	Review submitted protocol	AWHSC-IRB officer/members
4.	Communicate decision	AWHSC-IRB officer
5.	Archive the study protocol and report	AWHSC-IRB officer

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Before each Committee meeting

- ❖ ☐ See AWHSC-IRB SOP 007 (Management of Protocol Submission) for receiving and checking the report packages
- ❖ The Secretariat reviews the submitted report and briefs to the Chairperson. 1
- ❖ Make a sufficient number of copies.



5.2. During the Committee meeting

- Each Committee member reviews a copy of the Final Report.
- The Chairman or designee entertains any discussion of the study.
- If appropriate to the discussions, an AWHSC-IRB member may call for consensus on whether to request further information or to take other action with the investigator.
- Summarize what action should be taken: accept as submitted, accept with revision or not approve.

5.3. After the Committee meeting

- ❖ Notify the investigator of the decision.
- ❖ Accept and file the Final Report, if no action is taken.
- ❖ Note the decision in the meeting minutes
- ❖ Consider the study as closed.
- ❖ Get a copy of the final report signed by the Chairperson or the designee.
- ❖ Send an acknowledged letter to the investigator.
- ❖ Archive the entire study protocol and the report.

6. Glossary

7. ANNEX

ANNEX 1 AF 01-015 Study Report Form

8. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committees that Review Biomedical Research, 2000.
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. Related AWHSC-IRB SOP 007



ANNEX 1: Form AF 01-0 Study Report Form

Protocol No.: _____		Assigned No.: _____	
Protocol Title:			
Principal Investigator:			
Phone number:		E-mail address:	
Sponsor's Name			
Address:			
Phone:		E-mail:	
Study site(s):			
Total Number of study participants:		No. of Study Arms:	
Number of participants who received the test articles:			
Study materials:			
Treatment form:			
Study dose(s):			
Duration of the study			
Objectives:			
Results: (Use extra blank paper, if more space is required.)			
Signature of PI:			Date:



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 5.1. Intervention in Protocol Deviation / Non-compliance / Violation	AWHSC-IRB SOP/016/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page - 1 - of 5
---	---

Table of Contents

1. Purpose.....	2
2. Scope.....	2
3. Responsibility	2
5. Detailed instructions	3
5.1 Whenever protocol deviation / non-compliance / violation has been observed:	3
5.2 The AWHSC-IRB Decision	3
5.3 Notify the investigator	3
5.4 Keep records and follow up.....	3
6. Glossary	4
7. ANNEX.....	4
8. References.....	4
ANNEX 1.....	5
Deviation / Non-Compliance / Violation Record.....	5



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/016/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 2 of 5
5.1. Intervention in Protocol Deviation / Non-compliance / Violation	

1. Purpose

To provide instructions for taking action and maintaining records that identify investigators/institutes who fail to follow the procedures written in the approved protocol or to comply with national / international guidelines for the conduct of human research, including those who fail to respond to the AWHSC-IRB requests.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all AWHSC-IRB approved research protocols involving human subjects.

3. Responsibility

The Secretariat is responsible for collecting and recording the non-compliance list (AWHSC-IRB SOP #01-021).

4. Flow chart

<u>No.</u>	<u>Activity</u>	<u>Responsibility</u>
1.	Noting protocol deviation / non- compliance / violation ↓	AWHSC-IRB members and Chairperson
2.	AWHSC-IRB discussion and decision ↓	AWHSC-IRB members and Chairperson
3.	Notify the investigator ↓	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat
4.	Keep records and follow up	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/016/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 3 of 5
5.1. Intervention in Protocol Deviation / Non-compliance / Violation	

5. Detailed instructions

5.1 Whenever protocol deviation / non-compliance / violation has been observed:

- Ensure that the issues as well as the details of non-compliance involving research investigators are included in the agenda of the subsequent AWHSC-IRB meeting.
- Maintain a file that identifies investigators who are found to be non-compliant with national/international regulations or who fail to follow protocol approval stipulations or fail to respond to the AWHSC-IRB request for information/action.
- **Note:** The Board may elect to suspend or terminate approval of current studies or refuse subsequent applications from the investigators cited. Such decisions are recorded in the minutes.

5.2 The AWHSC-IRB Decision

- The chairperson notifies the investigator of the AWHSC-IRB action in writing, when the Committee
 - suspends or
 - terminates approval of a current study or
 - refuses subsequent applications from an investigator cited for non-compliance.

5.3 Notify the investigator

- The AWHSC-IRB Secretariat members record the AWHSC-IRB decision.
- Draft and type a notification letter.
- Get the Chairperson to sign and date the letter.
- Make four copies of the notification letter.
- Send the original copy of the notification to the investigator within the next 7 days.
- Send a copy of the notification to the relevant national authorities and institutes.
- Send the third copy to the sponsor or the sponsor's representative of the study.

5.4 Keep records and follow up

- Keep the last copy of the notification letter in the “non-compliance” file.
- Store the file in the shelf with an appropriate label.
- Follow up the action after a reasonable time.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/016/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 4 of 5
5.1. Intervention in Protocol Deviation / Non-compliance / Violation	

6. Glossary

Deviation	Departure from the approved protocol, ICH GCP guidelines, Ethiopian National Health Research Ethics Review guidelines/ regulations, and/or the AWHSC-IRB recommendations.
Non-compliance	Failure or refusal to comply with the approved protocol, ICH GCP guidelines, National Ethiopian Health Research Ethics Review guideline regulations, and/or the AWHSC-IRB requests.
Violation	A breach, infringement, or transgression of the guidelines and/or instructions in the approved protocol, ICH GCP guidelines, Ethiopian National Health Research Ethics Review guidelines/ regulations, and/or the AWHSC-IRB recommendations.

7. ANNEX

ANNEX 1 AWHSC-IRB 01-016 Deviation/Non-Compliance/Violation Record

8. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committees that Review Biomedical Research, 2000.
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. National Health Research Ethics Review Guideline. Addis Ababa, Ethiopia. 4thd edition revised in June 200



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/016/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 5 of 5
5.1. Intervention in Protocol Deviation / Non-compliance / Violation	

ANNEX 1: Form AF 01-016

Deviation / Non-Compliance / Violation Record

Application Number: / - _____		Date:	
Study Title:			
Investigator		Contact No.:	
Institution:		Contact No.:	
Sponsor:		Contact No.:	
Deviation from protocol Major Minor		Non-Compliance Violation	
Description:			
AWHSC-IRB Decision:			
Actions taken:		Outcome:	
Found by.....		Reported by.....	
Date.....		Date.....	



Table of Contents

1. Purpose.....	2
2. Scope.....	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Detailed instructions	3
5.1 Receive the request.....	3
5.2 Take Action	3
5.3 File the request document	3
6. Glossary	4
7. Annex	4
8. References	4
ANNEX 1	5
Request Record Form.....	5



1. Purpose

Since the AWHSC-IRB considers protection of the rights and welfare of the human subjects participating in clinical investigation/research approved by the AWHSC-IRB as its primary responsibility, informed consent documents reviewed by the AWHSC-IRB may routinely contain the statement, "Questions regarding the rights of a participant/patient may be addressed to the AWHSC-IRB Chairperson with the AWHSC-IRB address and/or phone number. On some occasions the first contact a participant/patient may have would be the AWHSC-IRB Secretariat. This procedure provides guidelines for dealing with and accommodating requests by participants/patients regarding their rights as a participant in any approved research study.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all requests concerning the rights safety and wellbeing of the research participants participating in studies approved by the AWHSC-IRB.

3. Responsibility

The Institute's policy designates the chairperson of the AWHSC-IRB as the person responsible for communicating with participants/patients regarding their rights as study participants. Delegation of this responsibility to another AWHSC-IRB member is acceptable as long as the delegation is documented (in writing). Delegation to non-AWHSC-IRB members is not permitted.

It is the responsibility of all Staff and AWHSC-IRB members acting on behalf of the AWHSC-IRB to facilitate participant/patient requests within the scope of their responsibilities.

4. Flow chart

<u>No.</u>	<u>Activity</u>	<u>Responsibility</u>
1.	Receive the request ↓	AWHSC-IRB Members and Secretariat
2.	Take action ↓	AWHSC-IRB Members and Chairperson
3.	Communicate with PI ↓	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat
4.	File the request document	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/017/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
5.2. Response to Research Participants' Requests	Page 3 of 5

5. Detailed instructions

5.1 *Receive the request*

- The AWHSC-IRB staff or member receives the inquiry or requests from research participants/patients.
- Record the request and information in the request record form (Form AF 01-017 see ANNEX 1)
- Communicate with the AWHSC-IRB about study participant rights for instruction.
- Refer the inquiry to the AWHSC-IRB Chairperson in writing.
- AWHSC staff may provide assistance in contacting the chairperson but will not provide comments/opinions about the inquiry.
- The Chairperson shall
 - ✓ document the communication for the AWHSC-IRB study file,
 - ✓ request follow-up information,
 - ✓ provide advice as required,
 - ✓ inform the other AWHSC-IRB members about the inquiry,
 - ✓ follow-up at the next AWHSC-IRB meeting or
 - ✓ delegate these tasks to AWHSC-IRB Secretariat or members.

5.2 *Take Action*

- Investigate the fact.
- Record information and any action or follow-up taken in the form AF 01-017.
- Sign and date the form.
- Report to the AWHSC-IRB about the action taken and the outcomes.

5.3 *File the request document*

- Keep the record form in the “response” file.
- Keep a copy in the study file.
- Store the file in the appropriately labeled shelf.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/017/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
5.2. Response to Research Participants' Requests	Page 4 of 5

6. Glossary

Participants' rights Recognition of the inherent dignity and of the equal and inalienable rights of all members of the human family is the foundation of freedom, justice, and peace in the world. It is essential that Human Rights should be protected by the rule of law.

7. Annex

ANNEX 1 AF 01-017 Request Record Form

8. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committees that Review Biomedical Research, 2000. www.who.int/tdr/publications/publications/
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. National Health Research Ethics Review Guideline. Addis Ababa, Ethiopia.
4th edition revised in June 2005



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/017/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
5.2. Response to Research Participants' Requests	Page 5 of 5

ANNEX 1
Form AF 01-017

Request Record Form

Date Received:	
Received by:	
Request from:	Telephone call No..... Fax No..... Mailed letter / Date..... E-mail / Date..... Walk-in / Date / Time..... Other, specify
Participant's Name:	
Contact Address:	
Phone:	
Title of the Participating Study	
Starting date of participation:	
What is requested?	
Action taken:	
Outcome:	



Table of Contents

Table of Contents.....	1
1. Purpose.....	2
2. Scope	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Detailed instructions	3
5.1 Receive recommendation for study termination.	3
5.2 Review and discuss the Termination Package.	3
5.3. Notify the Principal Investigator.	4
5.4 Store the protocol documents.	4
5.5 Inactivate the protocol documents.	4
6. Glossary.....	4
7. ANNEX	4
8. References.....	4
ANNEX 1	5
Study Termination Memorandum	5

1. Purpose

This procedure describes how an AWHSC-IRB proceeds and manages the termination of a research study. Protocols are usually terminated at the recommendation of the AWHSC-IRB, Data Safety Monitoring Board (DSMB), Scientific Director, sponsor or other authorized bodies when subject enrollment and subject follow-up are discontinued before the scheduled end of the study.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to any study approved by the AWHSC-IRB that is being recommended for termination before its scheduled completion.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the AWHSC-IRB Chairperson upon the recommendation of the committee to terminate any study that the AWHSC-IRB has previously approved when the safety or benefit of the study participants is doubtful or at risk. The Secretariat is responsible for management of the termination process.

4. Flow chart

<u>No.</u>	<u>Activity</u>	<u>Responsibility</u>
1	Receive recommendation for study termination ↓	Investigator and AWHSC-IRB Secretariat
2	Review and Discuss the Termination Package ↓	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat and Chairperson
3	Notify the Principal Investigator ↓	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat
4	Store the Protocol Documents ↓	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat
5	Inactivate the Protocol Document	AWHSC-IRB Secretariat

5. Detailed instructions

5.1 Receive recommendation for study termination.

- Receive recommendation and comments from DSMB, AWHSC-IRB members, Scientific Director, Sponsor or other authorized bodies for study protocol termination.
- Inform the principal investigator or the study office to prepare and submit a protocol termination package.
- Receive the study protocol termination package prepared and submitted by the principal investigator or the study office.
- Verify the contents of the package for inclusion of:
 - ✓ Request for Termination Memorandum (AWHSC-IRB- 01-018, see ANNEX 1 of this SOP.)
 - ❖ The request for termination memorandum should contain a brief written summary of the protocol, its results, and accrual data.
 - ✓ Original Continuing Review Application Form (AWHSC-IRB- 01-014), see ANNEX 1 of SOP# AWHSC-IRB- 014)
 - ✓ Termination is indicated under “Action Request”.
 - ✓ Completeness of the information, including accrual data since the time of the last continuing review.
 - ✓ Presence of the required signatures (Principal Investigator).
 - Initial and date the package upon receipt.

5.2 Review and discuss the Termination Package.

- Notify the chairperson regarding the recommendation for study protocol termination.
- Send a copy of the termination package to the Chairperson within five working days upon receipt.
- The Chairperson reviews the results, reasons and accrual data.
- The Chairperson calls for an emergency meeting of the AWHSC-IRB to discuss the recommendation.
- The committee approves/or recommends changes to the termination package
- The Chairperson signs and dates the Continuing Review Application Form in acknowledgment and approval of the termination.
- The chairperson returns the form back to the Secretariat within 5 working days of receipt of the package.
- The secretariat reviews, signs, and dates the continuing Review Application Form indicating that the termination process is complete.



5.3. *Notify the Principal Investigator.*

- Make a copy of the completed Continuing Review Application Form
- Send the copy to the principal investigator for their records within 7 working days.

5.4 *Store the protocol documents.*

- Keep the original version of the request memorandum for termination and the original version of the Continuing Review Application Form in the Protocol file.
- Send the file to archive.
- Store the protocol documents indefinitely.

5.5 *Inactivate the protocol documents.*

- Place the study protocol into the ***inactive*** protocol folder in the computer records under the following directory: \study files\inactive protocols

6. Glossary

Study Termination: Permanent cessation of all research activities.

Suspension: Temporary cessation of some or all research activities.

7. ANNEX

ANNEX 1 AF 01-018 Termination Memorandum

8. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committees that Review Biomedical Research, 2000.
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. Related SOP: SOP# AWHSC-IRB- 014, AWHSC-IRB- 018.
4. National Health Research Ethics Review Guideline. Addis Ababa, Ethiopia. 4th edition revised in June 2005. (www.estc.gov.et/Ethics%20Guideline.pdf)



Study Termination Memorandum

PROTOCOL NUMBER:		ASSIGNED No.: / -	
PROTOCOL TITLE:			
PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:			
PHONE:		E-MAIL:	
INSTITUTE:			
SPONSOR:			
AWHSC-IRB APPROVAL DATE:		DATE OF LAST REPORT	
STARTING DATE:		TERMINATION DATE:	
NO. OF PARTICIPANTS:		NO. ENROLLED:	
SUMMARY OF RESULTS			
ACCRUAL DATA:			
P.I. SIGNATURE:			DATE:



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/19/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 1 of 8
6.1. Review of Serious Adverse Event (SAE) Reports	

Table of Contents

1. Purpose	2
2. Scope.....	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow Chart	2
5. Detailed Instructions	3
5.1. Before Each IRB Meeting	3
5.1.1 Review And Determine the Review Channel.....	3
5.1.2 Criteria For the Review	3
5.2. During The IRB Meeting.....	3
5.2.1 Review And Discuss.....	3
5.2.2 Decide What Action Should Be Taken.....	3
5.2.3 Inform Investigator or Clinical Trial Office	4
6. Glossary	4
7. References.....	6
8. Annex.....	6
Annex 1: Serious Adverse Event Report.....	7
Annex 2: Unexpected Adverse Event Summary Report.....	8



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/19/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 2 of 8
6.1. Review of Serious Adverse Event (SAE) Reports	

1. Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to describe the procedures for the review of initial and follow-up reports of serious adverse events and unexpected events for any active study reported to IRB for any study approved by the IRB.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to the review of SAE and unexpected events reports submitted by investigators, Data Safety Monitoring Board (DSMB), sponsor, local safety monitor, IRB members or other concerned parties.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the IRB to review all SAEs and unexpected event reported to the IRB in a timely manner.

4. Flow Chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
	Before an IRB meeting	
1	SAE related activities ↓	IRB/Secretariat Office/SERO
2	Review and determine the review channel ↓	IRB/Secretariat Office/SERO
3	CRITERIA FOR THE REVIEW ↓	IRB/Secretariat Office/SERO
4	During the IRB meeting ↓	IRB members
5	Review and discuss ↓	IRB / Chairperson
6	Decide what action should be taken. ↓	IRB /Chairperson
7	Inform investigator or clinical trial office	SERO/Chairperson



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/19/01.1 Effective Date: 30/11/2025 Page 3 of 8
6.1. Review of Serious Adverse Event (SAE) Reports	

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Before each IRB meeting

5.1.1 Review and determine the review channel

- IRB Secretariat or members review the reporter's assessment to determine whether the report requires review by full Board or; expedited by the chairperson or other qualified IRB member(s) or reviewer

5.1.2 Criteria for the review

- The **review criteria** are as follows:
 - Assessment of adverse experience is unknown or unlikely
 - Report is forwarded to the Chairperson for review and determination if report should be reviewed at the convened meeting by full Board
- Assessment of adverse experience is possibly caused by, or probably caused by the investigational product
 - The report is added to the agenda for review at a convened meeting by full Board
- An adverse experience/IND Safety Report has been previously seen by full Board but being resubmitted by another investigator participating in the multi-study site (as part of a multi-center/site study), or is offsite
 - This notification does not require full Board review
 - Reviewed by the Chairperson or other qualified IRB members and secretariat

5.2. During the IRB meeting

5.2.1 Review and discuss

- After reading and reviewing the report, the Chairperson or designee entertains discussion on the study and similar adverse experiences or advisories.
- If appropriate to the discussions, the Chairperson or another Board member may call for a consensus on whether to:
 - No Further Action Required,
 - Request Information,
 - Recommend Further Action

5.2.2 Decide what action should be taken.

- If any of the above actions are taken, the IRB Secretariat or designee notifies the investigator of the action taken.



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/19/01.1 Effective Date: 30/11/2025 Page 4 of 8
6.1. Review of Serious Adverse Event (SAE) Reports	

- If the IRB *takes no action*, a notation is made in the minutes and the study is allowed to continue.

5.2.3 Inform investigator or clinical trial office

- The IRB secretariat member drafts a formal letter to the investigators or the clinical trial office to notify them of the action they should take according to the IRB decision.
- Get the Chairperson to approve, sign and date the letter.
- Send the letter and record the delivery date.

6. Glossary

Adverse Drug Reaction

In the pre-clinical experience with a new medicinal product or its new uses, particularly as the therapeutic dose(s) may not be established all noxious or unintended responses to the product related to any dose should be considered adverse drug reactions. The phrase “responses to a medicinal product” means that a causal relationship between the product and the adverse event is at least a reasonable possibility, i.e., the relationship cannot be ruled out.

Regarding marketed products, a response to a product which is noxious and unintended and which occurs at doses normally used in man for prophylaxis, diagnosis or therapy of diseases or for modification of physiological function.

Adverse Event

Any untoward medical occurrence in a patient or clinical investigation participant administered an investigational product and which does not necessarily have a causal relationship with this treatment. The adverse event can therefore be any unfavorable or unintended sign or experience associated with the use of the investigational product, whether or not related to the product.

IND

Investigational New Drugs means substances with potential therapeutic actions during the process of scientific studies in human in order to verify their potential effects and safety for human use and to get approval for marketing.

SAE (SERIOUS ADVERSE)

The adverse event is **SERIOUS** and should be reported when the patient outcome is:

Death - Report if the patient's death is suspected as being a



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/19/01.1 Effective Date: 30/11/2025 Page 5 of 8
6.1. Review of Serious Adverse Event (SAE) Reports	

EVENT)

direct outcome of the adverse event.

Life-Threatening: Report if the patient was at substantial risk of dying at the time of the adverse event or it is suspected that the use or continued use of the product would result in the patient's death.

Examples: Pacemaker failure; gastrointestinal hemorrhage; bone marrow suppression; infusion pump failure which permits uncontrolled free flow resulting in excessive drug dosing.

Hospitalization (initial or prolonged): Report if admission to the hospital or prolongation of a hospital stay results because of the adverse event.

Examples: Anaphylaxis; pseudomembranous colitis; or bleeding causing or prolonging hospitalization.

Disability: Report if the adverse event resulted in a significant, persistent, or permanent change, impairment, damage or disruption in the patient's body function/structure, physical activities or quality of life.

Examples: Cerebrovascular accident due to drug-induced hypercoagulability; toxicity; peripheral neuropathy.

Congenital Anomaly: Report if there are suspicions that exposure to a medical product prior to conception or during pregnancy resulted in an adverse outcome in the child.

Examples: Vaginal cancer in female offspring from diethylstilbestrol during pregnancy; malformation in the offspring caused by thalidomide.

Requires Intervention to Prevent Permanent Impairment or Damage: Report if suspect that the use of a medical product may result in a condition which required medical or surgical intervention to preclude permanent impairment or damage to a patient.

Examples: Acetaminophen overdose-induced hepatotoxicity requiring treatment with acetylcysteine to prevent permanent damage; burns from radiation equipment requiring drug therapy; breakage of a screw requiring replacement of hardware to prevent malunion of a fractured long bone.



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/19/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 6 of 8
6.1. Review of Serious Adverse Event (SAE) Reports	

Unexpected ADR Unexpected Adverse Drug Reaction is an adverse reaction, the nature or severity of which is not consistent with the informed consent / information sheets or the applicable product information (e.g., investigator's brochure for the unapproved investigational product or package insert / summary of product characteristics for an approved product.

7. References

1. World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.
2. International Council for Harmonization of Technical Requirements for Pharmaceuticals for Human Use Guidance for Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) E6(R2), 2016.

8. Annex



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/19/01.1 Effective Date: 30/11/2025 Page 7 of 8
6.1. Review of Serious Adverse Event (SAE) Reports	

Annex 1: Serious Adverse Event Report(AWHSC-IRB AF 01-020/01.0)

Principal Investigator.....

Study

Title

Protocol No.: AWHSC -IRB.....□□□

Name of the study medicine/device.....

.....

Sponsor/Host institution:

.....

Report Date:
☐ initial ☐ follow-up
 Onset date.....
 Date of first use:

Study participant's initial/number:	Age:	☐ Male ☐ Female
-------------------------------------	------	---

Study participant's history:	Laboratory findings:
------------------------------	----------------------

SAE:	Treatment:
	Outcome: ☐ resolved ☐ on-going

Seriousness: ☐ Death ☐ LIFE THREATENING ☐ Hospitalization – ☐ initial ☐ prolong ☐ Disability / Incapacity ☐ Congenital Anomaly ☐ Other.....	Relation to ☐ Drug ☐ Device ☐ study ☐ Not related ☐ Possibly ☐ Probably ☐ Definitely related ☐ Unknown
--	---

Changes to the protocol recommended?	☐ No ☐ Yes, attach proposal
Changes to the informed consent form recommended?	☐ No ☐ Yes, attach proposal

Decision	☐ No Further Action Required
	☐ Request Information
	☐ Recommend Further Action

Reviewed by.....	Date.....
Comment.....	Action.....



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus

Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)

6.1. Review of Serious Adverse Event (SAE) Reports

AWHSC-IRB SOP/19/01.1

Effective Date: 30/11/2025

Page 8 of 8

Annex 2: Unexpected Adverse Event Summary Report

AWHSC -IRB AF 02-019/01.0

Principal Investigator.....

Study Title.....

Protocol No: AWHSC -IRB-□□□-□□□□

Name of the studied medicine/device.....

This report covers the period.....To.....

Sponsor.....

#	Description of Unexpected Adverse Events	Date of Event (D/M/Y)	Date start and end of Tx (D/M/Y)	F or M	Initial	Age (Y)	Serious		Related to Study		Concomitant medication	Intervention
							Yes	No	Yes	No		
							☐	☐	☐	☐		
							☐	☐	☐	☐		

Comment: _____

Reviewed by _____ Date (D/M/Y) _____



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/ 020/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
7.1. Site Monitoring Visits	Page 1 of 6

Table of Contents

Table of Contents.....	Error! Bookmark not defined.
1. Purpose	2
2. Scope	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Detailed instructions	2
5.1. Selection of study sites	2
5.2. Before the visit	3
5.3. During the visit.....	3
5.4. After the visit.....	3
5.5. Present the inspection results to the Full Board	4
5.6. Type of decision	4
6. Glossary.....	4
7. References	4
8. Annex.....	4
Annex 1: Checklist of a Monitoring Visit	5



7.1. Site Monitoring Visits

1. Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to provide procedures as to when and how a study site should be visited and monitored of its performance or compliance to the scientific and ethical standards specified in the approved protocol.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to any visit and/or monitoring of any study sites as stated in the IRB approved study protocols that identify the place(s) where the study and/or laboratory procedures are being carried out or performed.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the IRB to perform or designate some qualified agents to perform on its behalf on-site inspection of the research projects it has approved.

The IRB members or Secretariat in consultation with the Chairperson may initiate an on-site evaluation of a study site for cause or for a routine audit.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1	Selection of study sites ↓	IRB members and Chairperson
2	Procedures before the visit ↓	IRB members and/or representative
3	Procedures during the visit ↓	IRB members and/or representative
4	Procedures after the visit ↓	IRB members and/or representative
5	Present the findings to the Full Board	IRB members and/or representative

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Selection of study sites

- ☐ Review periodically the database files of the submitted/approved study protocols.
- ☐ Select study sites needed to be monitored based on the following criteria:
 - New study sites



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/ 020/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
7.1. Site Monitoring Visits	Page 3 of 6

- Reports of remarkable serious adverse events
- Number of studies carried out at the study sites.
- Frequency of protocol submission for IRB review
- Non-compliance or suspicious conduct
- Frequently fail to submit final reports

5.2. Before the visit

The IRB representatives will:

- ☐ Contact the site to notify them that they will be visiting them. At that time, the investigator/monitor and the site will coordinate a time for the site evaluation visit,
- ☐ Make the appropriate travel arrangements,
- ☐ Review the IRB files for the study and site,
- ☐ Make appropriate notes, and/or
- ☐ Copy some parts of the files for comparison with the site files.

5.3. During the visit

- ☐ Get a checklist (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-021/02.0)
- ☐ The IRB representatives will
 - Review the informed consent document to make sure that the site is using the most recent version,
 - Review randomly the subject files to ensure that subjects are signing the correct informed consent,
 - Observe the informed consent process, if possible,
 - Observe laboratory and other facilities necessary for the study at the site,
 - Review the IRB files for the study to ensure that documentation is filed appropriately,
 - Collect views of the study participants,
 - Debrief the visit report/comments, and
 - Get immediate feedback.

5.4. After the visit

The IRB representative will:

- ☐ Write a report/comment (use the form AWHSC-IRB AF 01-021/02.0) within 2 weeks describing the findings during the audit,
- ☐ Forward a copy of the site visit report to the 'site monitoring' file for Full Board review,
- ☐ Send a copy of the report to the site for their files, and
- ☐ Place the report in the correct site files.



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/ 020/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
7.1. Site Monitoring Visits	Page 4 of 6

5.5. Present the inspection results to the Full Board

- ☐ Consult with the IRB secretariat,
- ☐ Schedule the presentation in the meeting agenda, and
- ☐ Present the results of on-site inspections to the Full Board.

5.6. Type of decision

- ☐ No further action
- ☐ Request Information
- ☐ Recommend further action

6. Glossary

IRB representatives	Many IRB rarely find time to perform monitoring visit themselves. They may ask outside experts or the staff of SERO to perform the tasks on their behalf and later report their findings to IRB.
Monitoring visit	An action that IRB or its representatives visit study sites to assess how well the selected investigators and the institutes are conducting researches, taking care of subjects, recording data and reporting their observations, especially serious adverse events found during the studies. Normally monitoring visit will be arranged in advance with the principal investigators.

7. References

1. World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.
2. International Council for Harmonization of Technical Requirements for Pharmaceuticals for Human Use Guidance for Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) E6(R2), 2016.

8. Annex



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)		AWHSC-IRB SOP/ 020/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
7.1. Site Monitoring Visits		Page 5 of 6

Annex 1: Checklist of a Monitoring Visit
(AWHSC-IRB F 01-021/02.0)

Protocol No.: AWHSC-IRB-□□□-□□□□		Date of the Visit:	
Study Title:			
Principal Investigators:			Phone:
Institute:		Address:	
Sponsor:		Address:	
Total number of expected subjects:		Total subjects enrolled:	
Are site facilities appropriate? ☐ Yes ☐ No		Comment:	
Are Informed Consents recent? ☐ Yes ☐ No		Comment:	
Any adverse events found? ☐ Yes ☐ No		Comment:	
Any protocol non-compliance /violation? ☐ Yes ☐ No		Comment:	
Are all Case Record Forms up to date? ☐ Yes ☐ No		Comment:	
Are storage of data and investigating products locked? ☐ Yes ☐ No		Comment:	
How well are participants protected? ☐ Good ☐ Fair ☐ Not good		Comment:	
Any outstanding tasks or results of visit? ☐ Yes ☐ No		Give details:	
Duration of visit: hours		Starting from: Finish:	
Decision ☐ No further action required ☐ Request information ☐ Recommend further action		Comment:	



Asrat Weldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/ 020/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
7.1. Site Monitoring Visits	Page 6 of 6

Name of surveyors (IRB member/ representatives and companion) and signature	1. Name: Signature Date: 2. Name Signature Date:
Completed by: Name: Signature:	Date:



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 1 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

Table of Contents

	<u>Page</u>
1. Purpose.....	2
2. Scope.....	2
3. Responsibility.....	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Detailed directions	3
5.1. Ahead of each IRB meeting	3
5.1.1. Consider the appropriate review channel of each protocol.....	3
5.1.2. Verify that all forms have been filled out completely.	3
5.1.3. Assign protocol reviewers.....	3
5.1.4. Prepare meeting agenda	3
5.1.5. Distribution of Protocol to the IRB before the meeting.....	4
5.1.6. Prepare for the meeting	4
5.2. During the meeting	4
5.3. Voting	5
5.4. After the meeting.....	6
5.5. Preparing the minutes and the decision forms.....	6
5.5.1. Assembling the meeting minutes and the decision form	6
5.5.2. Contents of the IRB Meeting Minutes	6
5.5.3. Approval of the minutes and the decision.....	7
5.5.4. Filing the minutes.....	8
5.5.5. Distributing the minutes and the decision.....	8
6. Glossary	8
7. References.....	9
8. Annex.....	10
Annex 1: Meeting Agenda Format of ASWHSC-IRB (ASWHSC-IRB AF 01/022/01).....	10
Annex 2: Meeting Minutes of ASWHSC-IRB (ASWHSC-IRB AF 02-022/01.0)	12
Annex 3: Conflict of interest form to be signed by IRB member before IRB meeting (ASWHSC-IRB AF 03-022/01.0).....	28



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 2 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

1. Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) is used to identify the administrative process and provide instructions for the preparation, review, approval and distribution of meeting agenda, minutes and action, invitation, and notification letters of Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus (ASWHSC) Institutional Review Board (IRB) meetings.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to administrative processes concerning the preparation of the agenda and recording minutes of all IRB meetings.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the Secretariat of IRB to prepare the agenda for the meeting and to ensure the quality and validity of the minutes after the meeting is over. The secretary will present the agendas to the board and will record the minute of the meeting. The Chairperson should review and approve the agenda and the minutes. In addition, the chairperson leads the IRB meeting.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1	Agenda setting ⇓	IRB Secretariat/IRB
2	Conducting meeting and minute taking ⇓	Chairperson/IRB Secretariat/IRB
3	Voting ⇓	IRB Members without conflict of interest/ Chairperson
4	Circulate for a minute ⇓	IRB Secretariat / Chairperson
5	Approval of the minute and communication	IRB Secretariat/IRB/Chairperson



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 3 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

5. Detailed directions

5.1. Ahead of each IRB meeting

5.1.1. Consider the appropriate review channel of each protocol

When choosing the review channel, follow the guidelines and practices outlined in the respective SOPs: -

- SOP for Expedited Review
- SOP for Initial Review of Submitted Protocols
- The protocol will be examined by the secretariat and Member Secretary using the appropriate checklist to determine whether the research/project will be considered for Review of Resubmitted Protocols, Review of Protocol Amendments, Continuing Review of Study Protocols, Review of Final Reports, and Management of Study Termination.
- In the covering letter, the principal investigator will specify the kind of review that will be conducted, and the papers will be submitted appropriately.
- The IRB secretary will appoint at reviewers to conduct a preliminary examination of each protocol that is submitted.

5.1.2. Verify that all forms have been filled out completely.

The IRB secretary: -

- Checks the new application's completion.
- Documents the review by completing the appropriate Checklist.
- If the application package is incomplete, the IRB Secretary tries to get in touch with the applicant to get any missing information.

5.1.3. Assign protocol reviewers

- The review meeting should be planned as soon as feasible after receipt, either during the following scheduled meeting or within two weeks after submission.
- The technical reviewer drafts a succinct protocol summary that includes an explanation of the protocol's objectives, criteria for evaluation, methodology and the like.
- The consent form is evaluated by an ethical reviewer for accuracy of information and respect for human and or animal participants.

5.1.4. Prepare meeting agenda



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 4 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

- Schedule the review meeting as soon as possible after the receipt of either at the time of the next scheduled meeting or within 2 weeks after submission
- To set the date of the meeting, consult the chairperson.
- Prepare the meeting agenda in the manner described in Annex 1 (ASWHSC-IRB AF 01-022/01). the format may be conditionally modified.
- A first-come, first-served approach should be used to schedule protocols in the agenda.
- For confirmation purposes, inform the IRB members about the meeting.
- Prepare letters, emails, phone calls, and oral communications inviting the reviewers and IRB members.
- Give the evaluation process a minimum of three weeks.
- Set a deadline for the comments' return.
- Ensure that the relevant database or review assignment file has the names of the appointed reviewers.

5.1.5. **Distribution of Protocol to the IRB before the meeting**

- Keep in mind Procedure for Maintaining Confidentiality of IRB documents when preparing and distributing.
- Two weeks before to the planned meeting, send copies of the protocol submission packages to the IRB members and designated reviewers through email (if the protocols are for electronic submission).
- Keep copies of "sent" emails, cover letters, and/or memoranda that were sent along with posted information in the Correspondence section of the relevant protocol file.
- Confirm with the participants (orally, through email, or by mail) that the protocol packages have been received.

5.1.6. **Prepare for the meeting**

- Make a reservation for a room for the scheduled meeting day and time.
- To meet the honorarium of outside experts and refreshments for the IRB members, submit an advance form to the administrative division.
- Templates for the minutes must be prepared in accordance with the agenda and with reference to previous minutes.
- Ensure that the venue, amenities, and equipment are ready for the meeting day and in working order.

5.2. **During the meeting**



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 5 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

- The IRB may allow investigators, clinical collaborators, guest attendees etc., to attend the portion of the EC meeting related to their studies.
- The Chairman may let observers (such as prospective clients, students, etc.) to watch the Board meetings.
- Guest attendees must complete a confidentiality agreement form.
- The Secretariat provides the agenda for discussion and gives a report on the previous meeting's minutes.
- The chairperson ensures that the quorum is complete before initiation of the meeting.
- The Secretary keeps a record of the decisions and conversations that take place during meetings.
- The Chairperson may inform members and attendees of the rules being followed during meetings.
- The sequence listed on the agenda is followed, however the chairperson may permit some swapping depending on the circumstances.
- Before start of the approval process, ask any member with conflict of interest to leave and join once decision is taken.
- When one of the reviewers offers a brief overview of the study and presents his or her views and suggestions, the approval procedure officially begins.
- If the reviewer is unable to attend the meeting, a Secretariat or IRB member may provide a briefing on the study by reading the reviewers' comments and assessments.
- Following the presentation, a discussion on the study is had with input from the other members.
- Investigators may be permitted to briefly describe their work and answer any queries the IRB members may have.
- The other members give their comments right after the presentation and the discussion about the study takes place.
- Investigators may be allowed to present their projects in brief and clarify any questions the IEC members may have.

5.3. Voting

- Voting will be held only in cases where there is a lack of consensus on an issue/protocol.
- Only IRB members who are separate from the investigator and the trial sponsor will cast votes on research-related issues in order to avoid conflicts of interest.



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 6 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

- A majority of members must vote in favor of an action for that category of action to be accepted by the IRB. Majority is defined as more than half of the total number of IRB members attending the meeting at which the vote takes place.
- All votes must be counted and recorded, and this is the responsibility of the IRB Secretary and administrator.

5.4. After the meeting

- A copy of the minutes is given to a senior administrative staff member as soon as feasible following each meeting for quality assurance and review.
- By signing and dating the minutes, the senior administrative staff member signifies review.
- The minutes are provided to the Chairperson or designee for review and approval after staff review.
- The Chairperson indicates approval by signing and dating the minutes
- As per the archiving procedures, the Secretariat keeps the official copies of the minutes.

5.5. Preparing the minutes and the decision forms

5.5.1. Assembling the meeting minutes and the decision form

- Use the format as shown in Annex 2 (ASWHSC-IRB AF 02-022/01.1) to write a minute
- Write each meeting's discussion and decision summary in a clear, readable manner.
- Be careful to include all of the information in each category.
- Check the printed minutes' context, spelling, and punctuation.
- Within a week of the meeting, complete the minutes.

5.5.2. Contents of the IRB Meeting Minutes

The official minutes of the Board meeting consist of, but are not limited to, the following:

- Name of person preparing the minutes
- Location where the meeting was held
- Meeting date
- Attending board members and guests
- Agenda items
- Individual serving as Chairperson of the meeting
- Determination of a duly constituted quorum by the Chairperson to proceed with the meeting



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 7 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

✚ Requirements for each study or activity requesting Approval:

- Principal Investigator’s Name
- Protocol number/date/version of protocol, when available
- Name of reviewers for each protocol
- Protocol number/date/version of protocol, when available.
- Number of members voting ‘yes’, ‘no’, or ‘abstention’ only wherever applicable
- Discussion as deemed appropriate by the Chairperson
- Number of members voting ‘yes’, ‘no’, or ‘abstention’
- Number of abstentions and the reason for the abstention
- Reference to the investigator approval letter that lists all changes requested by the IRB board
- Determination of the next requested continuing review

✚ Requirements for each study or activity requesting Expedited Review:

- Principal Investigator’s Name
- Protocol number, if applicable
- Justification by Principal Investigator for consideration of expedited review

✚ Required for each Continuing Review Report:

- Principal Investigator’s name;
- Protocol number, if applicable
- Approval letter for the project
- Lists of recommendations or actions to be taken up with the investigator, if applicable

✚ Required for each Adverse Event notification and Final Report:

- Sponsor’s name
- Protocol number, if applicable
- Investigator’s name
- Measures determined to be suitable after a Board review

✚ Required for Termination of Approval:

- Sponsor name’s
- Protocol number, if applicable
- Investigator’s name
- Reason for termination

5.5.3. Approval of the minutes and the decision



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 8 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

- Verify that the minutes are accurate and full.
- Get the IRB Chairperson to sign and date the pertinent portions of the decision form and the minutes of the IRB meeting.

5.5.4. Filing the minutes

- Put the original copy of the minutes and the signed decision form in the protocol's IRB files.
- File all communication in the relevant folder.
- To advise the Board Members of the expedited approval, include a copy of the approval letter in the "minutes" file.
- The meeting minutes should include a record of the appeal requests.

5.5.5. Distributing the minutes and the decision

- Send a copy of the pertinent portions of the minutes and the decision form to the applicants through mail or other methods for their records.
- Send the approved minutes to the IRB members
- Send the decision of the IRB for an appeal request to the person concerned in writing
- The recipients and the delivery date should be noted.

6. Glossary

Agenda	A list of things to be done; a program of business at a meeting
Minutes	An official record of the business discussed and transacted at a meeting, conference, etc.
Quorum	More than half of the regular voting members.
Majority vote	A motion is carried out if one half plus one member of the required quorum votes in its favor.



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 9 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

7. References

1. World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.
2. International Council for Harmonization of Technical Requirements for Pharmaceuticals for Human Use Guidance for Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) E6(R2),2016.



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 10 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

8. Annex

Annex 1: Meeting Agenda Format of ASWHSC-IRB (ASWHSC-IRB AF 01/022/01)

Meeting no.	
Meeting date:	
Type of meeting	☐ Ordinary ☐ Emergency
Location where the meeting is held	Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus, Debre Berhan, Ethiopia
Agenda items:	Attached
Starting time:	
Adjourned time:	

Attending IRB members and guests:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.
- 7.
- 8.



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 11 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

Individual serving as Chairman of the meeting: _____

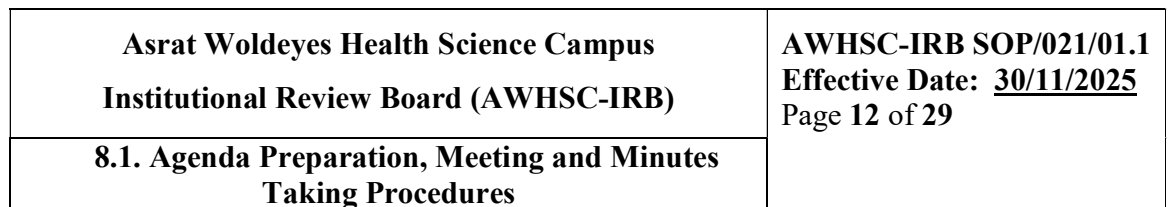
Determination of a dully constituted quorum by the Chairperson to proceed with the meeting.

Prepared by_____ IRB secretary_____ IRB chair person _____

Signature_____ Signature_____ Signature_____

Date_____ Date_____ Date_____

- Agenda of the IRB Ordinary Meeting
- 1. Adoption of the Agenda
 - 2. Announcement of Conflict of Interest (COI)
 - 3. Approval of the last meeting: IRB Minutes No. _____
 - 4. Matters arising from the minutes of the last meeting
 - 5. Protocol Presentations, Review, Discussion and Voting
 - 5.1. The Initial Review Protocol
 - 5.2. Resubmitted Protocol
 - 5.3. Amendment Protocol
 - 5.4. Pending Protocols
 - 5.5. SAE Report
 - 5.6. Expedited review
 - 6. Issues that members need to be educated about
 - 7. Reportable issues for consideration
 - 8. Other issues of interest to the member

[illegible]



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 13 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

1. Call to Order

<Title, First Name, Surname>, Chair, called this meeting to order at <time>.

2. Determination of Quorum

According to the Member Secretary, Title, Name, Surname>, quorum was established with the presence of a certain number of members, including a certain number of non-institutional, non-medical , and female members.

3. Disclosure of Conflict of Interest

In the Protocols slated for discussion in the meeting, the Title, Surname of Chair> demanded that disclosure of Conflict of Interest (COI) be made. The following individual(s) were prevented from taking part in the discussion during the full board meeting for the following reasons: The study's protocol number is ----- and its principal investigator is Title, Name, Surname>.

4. Approval of the Agenda

<Title, Surname of Chair> presided over the discussion of the agenda of the meeting for <dd/mm/yyyy> (Date of current meeting). The agenda was corrected during the discussion and approved as amended.

5. Approval of the Minutes of the Last Meeting

5.1. Corrections to the Minutes of the Meeting

5.2. Approval of the Minutes of the Meeting

5.3. Issues arising from the previous meeting's minutes that need to be resolved

6. Protocol Review

6.1. Full board review of protocols

6.1.1. Protocols for initial review (Full Board Review)



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 14 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

Protocol Code	
Protocol submission date (dd/mm/yyyy)	
Protocol title	
Principal investigator	
Primary reviewers	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of Interest	



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 15 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

Assessment of scientific issues	1. Rationale and literature review 2. Objectives/Expected output 3. Research/Study design 4. Sampling design and sample size 5. Control arms (placebo or less effective intervention, if any) 6. Inclusion criteria 7. Exclusion criteria 8. Withdrawal criteria 9. Statistical and data analysis plan 10. PI qualification and COI 11. Suitability and choice of site 12. Research instruments and tools
Assessment of ethical issues	1. Vulnerability 2. Risks and benefits 3. Compensation and reimbursement 4. Privacy and confidentiality 5. Informed consent process 6. Completeness of patient information sheet (PIS) and informed consent form (ICF) 7. Language and translation of PIS and ICF 8. Voluntariness 9. Parental consent
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (Approve <date of continuing review>; Minor Modification, which can be expedited at the level of the Member Secretary; Major Modification, which requires resubmission and full



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 16 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

	board review; Disapprove)
Frequency of continuing review (in case of approval)	
Other comments if applicable	

6.1.2. Protocols for modification or resubmissions (Full Board Review)

Protocol code	
Protocol resubmission date	
Protocol title	
Principal investigator	
Primary reviewer	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of interest	
Assessment of PI response to initial review	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action take	Decision (Approve <date of continuing review>; Minor Modification, which can be expedited at the level of the Member Secretary; Major Modification, which requires resubmission and full board review; Disapprove)
Frequency of continuing review (in case of	



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 17 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

approval)
Other comments if applicable

6.1.3. Amendments (Full Board Review)

Protocol code	
Protocol approval date (dd/mm/yyyy)	
Amendment of submission date (dd/mm/yy)	
Protocol title	
Principal investigator	
Primary reviewer	
Spencer	
Quorum status	
Assessment of amendment	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action takes	Decision (Approve; Minor modification to the amend reasons for action, subject to expedited review at the level of Member Secretary; Major modification to the amendment reasons for action, subject to full board review; Disapproved
Other comments if applicable	



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 18 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

6.1.4. Protocol non-compliance (Deviation or Violation) reports (Full Board Review)

Protocol code	
Protocol approval date	
Report date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol Approval Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol title	
Principal investigator	
Primary reviewer	
Spencer	
Quorum status	
Conflict of interest	
Assessment of protocol non-compliance report	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (No further action required; Request information Recommend further action)
Other comments if applicable	

6.1.5. SAE reports (Full Board Review)

Protocol Code		
Protocol Approval Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>	
Report Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>	
Protocol Title		
Principal Investigator		
Primary Reviewers		



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 19 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

Sponsor		
Quorum Status		
Conflict of Interest		
Assessment of SAE Report		
SAE Details	Submission date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
	Date of SAE	<dd/mm/yyyy>
	Onsite or offsite	
	Related or Non-Related to the Study	
	Nature of SAE	
	Status	
Conclusion and Recommendations		
Action Taken	Decision (No further action required; Request information; Recommend further action)	
Other Comments (if applicable)		

6.1.6. Requests, queries, and complaints (Full Board Review)

Protocol code	
Protocol approval date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Application date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol title	
Principal investigator	
Primary reviewer	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 20 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

Conflict of interest

Assessment of request query or compliant

Conclusion and recommendations

Action taken

Other comments if applicable

6.1.7. Site visit reports (Full Board Review)

Protocol code	
Protocol approval date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Site visit date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol title	
Principal investigator	
Primary reviewer	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of interest	
Assessment of site visit report	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (No further action required; Request information; Recommend further action)
Other comments if applicable	

6.1.8. Study termination (Full Board Review)

Protocol code	
Protocol approval date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Application date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol title	



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 21 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

Principal investigator	
Primary reviewer	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of interest	
Assessment of risks from study termination	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (Approve; Request information; Recommend action)
Other comments if applicable	

6.1.9. Continuing and progress reports (Full Board Review)

Protocol code	
Protocol approval date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Application date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol title	
Principal investigator	
Primary reviewer	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of interest	
Assessment of continuing and progress report	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (Approve; Request information; Recommend further action)
Other comments if applicable	



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 22 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

6.1.10. Final reports (Full Board Review)

Protocol Code	
Protocol Approval Date	dd/mm/yyy
Report Date	dd/mm/yyy
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	
Quorum Status	
Conflict of Interest	
Assessment of Final Report	
Conclusion and Recommendations	
Action Taken	
Other Comments (if applicable)	

6.2. Report of accelerated review protocols, updated protocols, and post-approval reports filed for expedited review, as well as procedures exempt from review and expedited review protocols

6.2.1. Protocols exempt from review

Protocol Code	
Protocol Submission Date	dd/mm/yyyy
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	
Protocol Approval Date	dd/mm/yyy



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 23 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

6.2.2. Protocols for initial review (Expedited Review)

Protocol Code	
Protocol Submission Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	
Action Taken	Decision (Approve <date of continuing review>; Minor Modification, which can be expedited at the level of the Member Secretary; Major Modification, which requires resubmission and full board review; Disapprove)

6.2.3. Protocols for modification or resubmissions (Expedited Review)

Protocol Code	
Protocol Submission Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Approve <date of continuing review>; Minor Modification, which can be expedited



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 24 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

	at the level of the Member Secretary; Major Modification, which requires resubmission and full board review; Disapprove)

6.2.4. Amendments (Expedited Review)

Protocol Code	
Protocol Approval Date	
Date of Amendment Submission	
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	
Action Taken	Decision • Approve; • Minor modification • Major modification • Disapprove

6.2.5. Protocol non-compliance (Deviation or Violation) Reports (Expedited Review)

Protocol Code	
Protocol Approval Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Report Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 25 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

Action Taken	Decision (No further action required; Request information, Recommend further action)
---------------------	---

6.2.6. SAE reports (Expedited Review)

Protocol Code	
Protocol Approval Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Report Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (No further action required; Request information, Recommend further action)

6.2.7. Requests, queries, and complaints (Expedited Review)

Protocol Code	
Protocol Approval Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Application Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	
Action Taken	Decision (No further action required; Request information Recommend further action)



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 26 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

6.2.8. Site visit reports (Expedited Review)

Protocol Code	
Protocol Approval Date	dd/mm/yyyy
Site Visit Date	dd/mm/yyyy
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (No further action required; Request information Recommend further action)

6.2.9. Study termination (Expedited Review)

Protocol Code	
Protocol Approval Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Application Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	
Action Taken	Decision (Approve; Request information; Recommend action)



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 27 of 29
8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes Taking Procedures	

6.2.10. Continuing and progress reports (Expedited Review)

Protocol Code	
Protocol Approval Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Date of Report	
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	
Action Taken	Decision (Approve; Request information; Recommend f action)

6.2.11. Final reports (Expedited Review)

Protocol Code	
Protocol Approval Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Date of Report	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Protocol Title	
Principal Investigator	
Primary Reviewers	
Sponsor	
Action Taken	Decision (Approve; Request information; Recommend f action)



**Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)**

AWHSC-IRB SOP/021/01.1
Effective Date: 30/11/2025
Page 28 of 29

**8.1. Agenda Preparation, Meeting and Minutes
Taking Procedures**

**Annex 3: Conflict of interest form to be signed by IRB member before IRB meeting
(ASWHSC-IRB AF 03-022/01.1)**

Date (dd/mm/yyyy)

To -----

The Chairperson, IRB

I hereby declare the conflict of interest for the protocol no. -----

entitled, _____

As:

1. I am the investigator / co-investigator/Author/study team

2. I have financial interest

3. _____

4. _____

in the project which will be discussed in today's meeting i.e. dd day of <dd/mm/yyyy>.

MR/MRS/MS/Dr. _____

Member, IRB

Chairperson, IRB



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/022/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
8.2. Emergency Meeting	Page 1 of 4

Table of Contents

1. Purpose	2
2. Scope	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Detailed instructions	2
5.1. Preparation for the meeting	2
5.2. During the meeting	3
5.3. After the meeting	3
6. Glossary	4
7. Annex	4
8. References	4



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/022/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
8.2. Emergency Meeting	Page 2 of 4

1. Purpose

With the help of this SOP, study activities will be reviewed and approved utilizing the Emergency Meeting Procedure. The administrative process for doing so will be identified.

2. Scope

This SOP is applicable to ASWHSC-IRB emergency meetings. To assess or approve safety- or life-threatening issues, new studies, additional investigators, ongoing review, protocol revisions, and other study activities requiring full Board review, emergency sessions may be organized.

3. Responsibility

If necessary, the ASWHSC IRB Chairperson may hold an emergency meeting. The secretary or any member of this IRB may ask the chairperson to conduct an emergency meeting.

4. Flow chart

S/N	Activity	Responsibility
1.	Preparation for the emergency IRB meeting ↓	IRB Secretariat
2.	Emergency IRB meeting ↓	IRB Members and Chairperson
3.	Action taken after the meeting	IRB Secretariat

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Preparation for the meeting

- ❖ Decide to call an emergency meeting based on the following criteria:
 - Urgent issues (if delay will affect or have impact to the public benefit, national economics, etc.)
 - Occurrence of unexpected serious adverse events.



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/022/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
8.2. Emergency Meeting	Page 3 of 4

- A matter of life and death.
- Other appropriate reasons.
- ❖ Contact and inform ASWHSC IRB members, including the invited persons about the meeting.
 - At least one scientific member
 - A non-scientific member
 - A member with expertise on the item to discussed
 - For routine medical research studies, a physician may be invited.
 - For certain dental studies, a dentist may be invited.
- ❖ Invite at least one expert to look at the document, as appropriate.
- ❖ Prepare packets for distribution to the members.
- ❖ Attach a separate sheet with information about meeting date, time, phone numbers, the meeting ID number and an attendant confirmation form to the packets.

5.2. During the meeting

- ❖ Determine if there is a quorum.
- ❖ Adhere to the relevant SOPs.
 - SOP 03 – Constituting an Ethics Committee
 - SOP 07 – Management of Protocol Submission
 - SOP 08 – Use of Assessment Form
 - SOP 09 – Expedited Review
 - SOP 10 – Initial Review of Application Protocol
 - SOP 12 – Review of Protocol Amendments
 - SOP 14 – Continuing Review
 - SOP 21 – Preparation of Meeting, Agenda, Minutes and action letters

5.3. After the meeting

- For the preparation and documentation of the minutes, the secretariat shall adhere to the pertinent SOPs in #22
- All actions deemed necessary throughout the meeting will be taken by the secretary



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/022/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
8.2. Emergency Meeting	Page 4 of 4

- This may entail letting the researcher, principal investigator, sponsor, and others know of the AWHSC IRB's choice and suggestions.

6. Glossary

Emergency meeting	An IRB meeting that is called aside from one that is regularly planned to discuss study activities that need thorough assessment and approval. A quorum must be present for the duration of all discussions and voting in order to convene an emergency meeting.
-------------------	--

7. Annex

8. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committees that Review Biomedical Research, 2000.
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. Standard Operating Procedure. The AHRI Alert Ethics Review Committee. Second edition. May, 2009.



**Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)**

AWHSC-IRB SOP/023/01.1

Effective Date: 30/11/2025

8.3. Communication records

Page 1 of 5

Table of Contents

1. Purpose	2
2. Scope	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Directions	3
5.1. Communication recording mechanism	3
5.2. Contents of a written record	3
5.3. Distribution of the record	3
6. Glossary	3
7. Reference	4
8. Annex.....	4
Annex 1: Communication Record Form (ASWHSC-IRB AF 01-024/01.0)	5



**Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)**

AWHSC-IRB SOP/023/01.1

Effective Date: 30/11/2025

8.3. Communication records

Page 2 of 5

1. Purpose

This SOP is intended to guarantee that written correspondence and other study-related or process-related material exchanged with researchers, sponsors, volunteer subjects, institutes, and/or other government bodies is properly completed, distributed, and filed (FMHACA, National Research Ethics Review Board, etc.).

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all communication activities related to the studies under the approval of the ASWHSC-IRB.

3. Responsibility

All IRB administrative personnel, Board members, the secretariat, and the chairperson who are involved in ASWHSC-IRB activities are required to complete written communication records for all telephone or in-person conversations regarding past, present, and/or future studies and/or processes involving the IRB.

4. Flow chart

S/N	Activity	Responsibility
4.	Written by hand, typed, or produced by computer ↓	IRB Administrative Staff/Secretariat/ Members / Chairperson
5.	Recording all textual materials and data ↓	IRB secretariat/ Chairperson
	Distribution of all the records	IRB secretariat / Chairperson



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/023/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
8.3. Communication records	Page 3 of 5

5. Directions

5.1. Communication recording mechanism

Different communication tools, such as handwritten, typed, or computer-generated records, may be used by people.

5.2. Contents of a written record

The record should include, but is not limited to, the following details:

- Date of communication
- Study information, i.e., sponsor, protocol number, investigator, etc.
- Name of person contacted
- Contact address, telephone number, and e-mail
- Summary of the communication made
- Notation of any follow-up necessary
- Signature of individual completing record

5.3. Distribution of the record

The individual distributes copies of the records to:

- The study files
- Others, as appropriate
- Secretariat or administrative staff for filing

6. Glossary

Communication:	Methods for communicating in writing and exchanging additional study-related or process-related information with researchers, sponsors, volunteers, institutes, and/or pertinent government organizations (FMHACA, National research ethics review board, etc.).
Records	evidence pertaining to a research, protocol, investigators, sponsors, volunteers, and institutes.



**Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)**

AWHSC-IRB SOP/023/01.1

Effective Date: 30/11/2025

8.3. Communication records

Page 4 of 5

7. Reference

1. World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.
2. International Council for Harmonization of Technical Requirements for Pharmaceuticals for Human Use Guidance for Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) E6(R2), 2016.

8. Annex



Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/023/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
8.3. Communication records	Page 5 of 5

Annex 1: Communication Record Form (ASWHSC-IRB AF 01-024/01.0)

Date		
Means of contact	☐ Telephone ☐ Fax ☐ e-mail ☐ In Person	
Status of Contact	☐ Incoming Call ☐ Outgoing Call	
Person contacted:	☐ Reviewer ☐ IRB Member ☐ Chairperson ☐ Secretariat ☐ Sponsor ☐ Investigator ☐ Media ☐ Subject ☐ Institute ☐ Regulatory	
Name		
Telephone No.		
E-mail		
Protocol No.		
Title:		
Communication Issues / Reason for making contact:		
Follow-up Action:	☐ Return call ☐ will call again ☐ None ☐ See notes ☐ Circulation ☐ Confidential	
Summary of Communication:		
Recorded by:		



**Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)**

9.1. Maintenance of Active Study Files

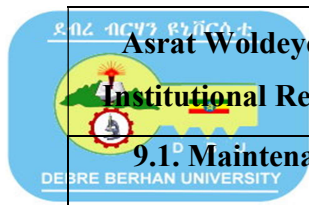
AWHSC-IRB SOP/024/01.1

Effective Date: 30/11/2025

Page 1 of 5

Table of Contents

1. Purpose	2
2. Scope	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Detailed instructions	2
5.1. Organize the content of the active study files	2
5.2. Maintain the active study files	3
6. Glossary	4
7. Annex.....	5
8. References	5



1. Purpose

This SOP provides directions on the preparation, circulation and maintenance of documentation active study files and other relevant documents approved by the AWHSC IRB.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all active study files and related documents maintained at the AWHSC IRB office.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the AWHSC IRB Secretary to ensure that all study files are created, maintained, distributed and kept secure for the specified period under an appropriate system that ensures confidentiality and facilitates retrieval at any time.

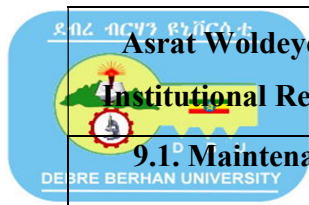
4. Flow chart

S/N	Activity	Responsibility
1.	Organize the content of active study files ⇓	AWHSC IRB Secretariat
2.	Maintain the active study files	AWHSC IRB Secretariat

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Organize the content of the active study files

- ❖ Obtain the master copy of the study files.
- ❖ Collect, classify and combine all related documents.
- ❖ Verify that a study file contains at least the following documents:
 - ✚ Original applications and any updates received during the study
 - ✚ Investigator brochures or similar documents
 - ✚ Letters of approval and other correspondence sent to the investigator.



**Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus
Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)**

9.1. Maintenance of Active Study Files

AWHSC-IRB SOP/024/01.1

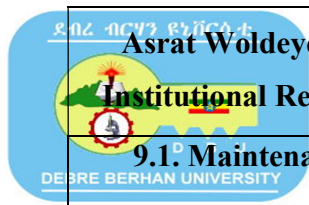
Effective Date: 30/11/2025

Page 3 of 5

- ✚ Approved documents (minutes, amendments, consent forms, promotional materials, etc.)
- ✚ Unsolicited testimonials or IND safety reports received
- ✚ Ongoing review reports
- ❖ Use a folder with the following information on the envelope:
 - ✚ Sponsor's name
 - ✚ Protocol number
 - ✚ The number assigned by the AWHSC IRB Secretariat
 - ✚ Place the following information in each folder with the following information:
 - Sponsor with address and contact phone/email ID of contact, protocol number, investigator name (with address, email, phone and fax) and title
 - AWHSC IRB protocol application form, case report form, investigator brochure, consent forms with translations into the relevant languages, promotional materials and recruitment procedures, investigator bio data, any other materials submitted by the investigator
 - Correspondence
 - Initial approval with final version of all above documents
 - Revisions/amendments
 - Adverse events
 - Ongoing review
 - If applicable final report

5.2. Maintain the active study files

- ❖ Assign unique identifiers to the approved study files, created by a member of the AWHSC-IRB Secretariat
- ❖ Combine the related documents of the approved study files appropriately
- ❖ Attach an identity label to the package



- ❖ Keep all active and potential study packages in a secure archive
- ❖ Keep the study files in an easily accessible and secure place until the final report has been reviewed and accepted by the AWHSC IRB
- ❖ Send all closed study files for archiving
- ❖ Keep the closed study files for at least 5 years after completion of the study.

Note: For multi-site trials, a member secretariat should maintain the files to allow cross-referencing without unnecessary duplication.

6. Glossary

ACTIVE STUDY FILES All approved protocols, supporting documents, records with notices, and reports corresponding to each currently approved study.

CRF

Case record form or case report form is a printed, visual, or electronic document used to record all protocol-required information to be reported to the sponsor about each study subject.

IND

investigational new drug is a drug that has never been seen on the market as it is being studied for its efficacy and safety and has not yet been approved for marketing by local authorities. The drug is therefore only approved for certain study centers.

ICD

Informed consent document is a written, signed, and dated paper confirming the participants' willingness to voluntarily participate in a particular study after being informed of all aspects of the study relevant to the participants' decision to participate.

MASTER FILE

a file used to store the original signed and dated documents

 Asrat Woldeyes Health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/024/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u>
9.1. Maintenance of Active Study Files	Page 5 of 5

7. Annex

8. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committees that Review Biomedical Research, 2000.
2. Standard Operating Procedure. The AHRI Alert Ethics Review Committee. Second edition. May, 2009.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/025/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 1 of 9
9.2. Archive and Retrieval of Documents	

Table of Contents

Contents

1. Purpose	2
2. Scope	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Detailed instructions	3
5.1. Administrative Records Maintenance of the IRB	3
5.2. Maintenance of Closed and Inactive Files	4
5.2.1. Closed files.....	4
5.2.2. Inactive files.....	4
5.3. Accessibility / Retrieval	4
5.4. Disposal of Closed Files & Copies of Protocols and Documents Submitted for IRB Review.....	5
6. Glossary	6
7. References	6
8. Annex.....	6
Annex 1: Document Request Form.....	7
Annex 2: Log of Requested AWHSC -IRB Documents	8
Annex 3: Log for Disposal of Study Documents	9



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/025/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 2 of 9
9.2. Archive and Retrieval of Documents	

1. Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to provide instructions for preparation and maintenance of IRB administrative documents, archival of closed and inactive files and retrieval of documents.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to archiving the study files and administrative documents that are retained for at least five years (or more for some particular cases) after completion of the research so that the records are accessible for auditors and inspectors. Copying files and documents for or by authorized representatives of the national authority is allowed when required.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of IRB secretariat to ensure that study files and IRB records are prepared, maintained, circulated and kept securely.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1	Maintenance of IRB Administrative Records ⇓	IRB secretariat
2	Maintenance of closed and inactive files ⇓	IRB secretariat
3	Accessibility/ Retrieval ⇓	IRB secretariat
4	Disposal of Closed Files and Copies of Protocols and Documents Submitted for IRB Review	IRB secretariat



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/025/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 3 of 9
9.2. Archive and Retrieval of Documents	

5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Administrative Records Maintenance of the IRB

The IRB records will include the following:

- IRB members' records
 - ✓ Appointment letter with TOR and acceptance letters of each member
 - ✓ Signed and dated confidentiality agreements and COI agreements
 - ✓ Updated Curriculum vitae (hard copy or soft copy)
 - ✓ Training records for each IRB member (GCP, SOP)
 - ✓ Documentation of resignations / terminations
- IRB membership roster - An IRB roster will be maintained which will contain:
 - ✓ Names of IRB members
 - ✓ Age
 - ✓ Gender
 - ✓ Evidence of qualifications
 - ✓ Role on the IRB
 - ✓ Status of affiliation to institution (e.g., unaffiliated or affiliated)
 - ✓ Regular/ Alternate member to the IRB
- IRB TOR
- Correspondence on changes of membership in IRB with DG or any other concerned authority
- IRB attendance roster
- Agenda and Minutes of IRB meetings
- Standard operating procedures (SOPs)
- Annual reports of SERO and AWHSC-IRB
- Documents related to Workshops & conferences organized by IRB
(Continuing education for members & staff)
- SOP training and distribution logs



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/025/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 4 of 9
9.2. Archive and Retrieval of Documents	

5.2. Maintenance of Closed and Inactive Files

5.2.1. Closed files

- All closed study files will be archived for a period of five years from the date of closure of the study: discussion and approval of the final report or premature termination of the project
- Log book for archival of study documents will be maintained. The files can be retrieved as needed.

5.2.2. Inactive files

- Sponsors will be communicated by the secretariat to update status of the project, and reflect their opinions or provide recommendations to the IRB
- Final decision on the fate of the inactive study files will be provided by the IRB
- Inactive study files will be archived for a minimum of five years following determination of the IRB
- Log book for archival of study documents will also be maintained and retrieved when required

5.3. Accessibility / Retrieval

Study files and administrative records will be made available for audit, making photocopies (if requested by investigator) or any other purpose (e.g., research on SAEs) on request if authorized by Secretary/Chairperson.

- Retrieval of documents can only be done with a request form (AF/01-025/01.0, see ANNEX 1) signed and dated by the AWHSC-IRB Chairperson or the Secretariat.
- The requestor must also sign and date the log of request (AF/02-025/01.0, see ANNEX 2)
- The Secretariat retrieves archived documents in compliance with the procedures of the AWHSC Archives department
- Return the file back to its place.
- Record, sign and date when the document has been returned and kept



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/025/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 5 of 9
9.2. Archive and Retrieval of Documents	

5.4. Disposal of Closed Files & Copies of Protocols and Documents Submitted for IRB Review

- Extra copies of protocols and other documents submitted for IRB review will be shredded and disposed by secretary after the IRB decides on the protocol without any notification to PI
- At the end of the archival period, closed and inactive files will be shredded and disposed of by secretary
- Formal disposal log will be maintained for closed and inactive files, providing details of documents that will be disposed (AWHSC-IRB AF 03-025/01.0).



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/025/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 6 of 9
9.2. Archive and Retrieval of Documents	

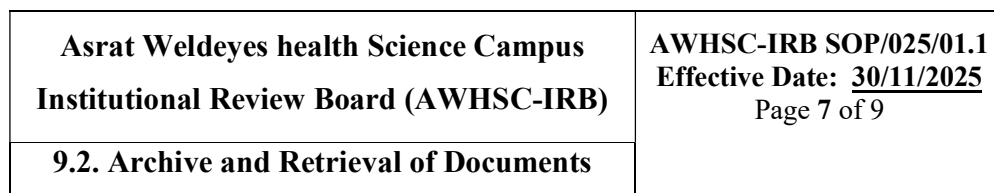
6. Glossary

Administrative file	Documents related with the IRB function and member's record.
Closed file	Supporting and approved documents (protocols, protocol amendments, informed consents, announcements, investigator and site information), records containing communication and correspondence with the investigator, and reports (including but not limited to progress reports, IND Safety Reports, reports of injuries to subjects, scientific evaluations) that correspond to each study approved by the AWHSC - IRB for which final report has been reviewed and accepted.
Inactive file	Study protocols declared “Inactive” by AWHSC -IRB after six months period of no communication following expire date of approval.

7. References

1. World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.
2. International Council for Harmonization of Technical Requirements for Pharmaceuticals for Human Use Guidance for Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) E6 (R2), 2016.

8. Annex



Name of Document requested:	Code:
Requested by	Date:
☐ Chairperson ☐ Secretariat ☐ AAERC Member	
☐ Secretariat staff ☐ Authority ☐ Others.....	
Purpose of the request:	
Retrieved by:	Date:
Approved by:	Date:
Returned by:	Date:
Archived by:	Date:



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/025/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 8 of 9
9.2. Archive and Retrieval of Documents	

Annex 2: Log of Requested AWHSC -IRB Documents
 (AWHSC -IRB AF 02-025/01.0)

#	Document	Requester	Requested Date	Retrieved by	Archived by	Returned Date



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/025/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 9 of 9
9.2. Archive and Retrieval of Documents	

Annex 3: Log for Disposal of Study Documents

(AWHSC -IRB AF 03-025/01.0)

Project No	Project Title	Name of PI	No of files	Date of IRB Approval	Date of Study Commencement	Date of Study Closure	Date of Disposal	Disposed by (Name & Signature)



Table of Contents

Contents

1. Purpose.....	2
2. Scope.....	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Detailed instructions	3
5.1. Access to IRB Documents.....	3
5.1.1. Members/alternate members of the IRB.....	3
5.1.2. Secretariat of the IRB	3
5.2. Classify confidential documents	3
5.3. Copy confidential documents.....	4
5.3.1. Copy Authorization.....	4
5.3.2. Log of Copies.....	4
5.4. File Log of Copies.....	5
6. Glossary.....	5
7. References.....	6
8. Annex.....	6
Annex 1: Log of Requests for Copies of IRB's Documents	7
Annex 2: Log of Copies of Original Documents	8
Annex 3: Form for requesting copies of original document.....	9



1. Purpose

The sources of violation of confidentiality are usually found in the day-to-day use of copies of original documents. This SOP therefore describes how to handle original documents and copies of documents in order to protect confidentiality of documents.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all kinds of handling, distribution and storage of submitted study protocols, IRB documents, and correspondence with experts, auditors and the general public.

3. Responsibility

Confidentiality of study protocols, IRB documents, and correspondence with experts and auditors is mandatory. IRB members and staff have signed confidentiality agreements with the institute that enforces confidentiality.

If non-members of the IRB need copies of documents, it is the responsibility of the IRB member/staff requesting a copy on behalf of the non-members to maintain confidentiality of documents

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1	Access to IRB documents ⇓	IRB members and Secretariat
2	Classify confidential documents ⇓	IRB members and Secretariat
3	Copy confidential documents ⇓	IRB secretariat
4	File Log of Copies	IRB secretariat



5. Detailed instructions

5.1. Access to IRB Documents

The IRB members and the staff of the Secretariat of the IRB, who must read, understand and agree to the following:

5.1.1. Members/alternate members of the IRB

- Sign a confidentiality agreement (AWHSC-IRB AF 01-004/01.1) with AWHSC before the start of any activity for the IRB
- Shall have access to all IRB documents
- Are free to request and to use original documents or copies of original documents

5.1.2. Secretariat of the IRB

- The secretary of the IRB is a staff member of the AWHSC
- Sign a confidentiality agreement with AWHSC
- Have access to any document issued by or to the AWHSC-IRB, according to SOP/026/01.0 (Maintaining Confidentiality of AWHSC-IRB Documents).

5.2. Classify confidential documents

➤ Types of documents

The types of documents reviewed by AWHSC-IRB members include:

- Study protocols and related documents (case report forms, informed consent documents, diary forms, scientific documents, expert opinions or reviews)
- AWHSC-IRB documents (meeting minutes, advice and decisions)
- Correspondence (experts, auditors, study participants, etc.)

Note: Copies of all versions of documents, including draft and sequential definitive versions, are to be kept private and confidential with the exception of those made according to the following section.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/026/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 4 of 9
9.3. Maintaining Confidentiality of IRB Documents	

5.3. Copy confidential documents

- Copies of documents, including draft and sequential versions, are considered to be confidential and are not permitted to be brought out except when a document is needed for day-to-day operations

5.3.1. Copy Authorization

- Only members of the IRB are allowed to ask for copies.
- Only staff members of the Secretariat of the IRB are allowed to make such copies
- The Secretary of the IRB may ask for help, but he is responsible for maintaining confidentiality of all documents.

5.3.2. Log of Copies

- A Log of Copies (see Annex 1: AWHSC-IRB SOP/026/01.0) must be kept by the Secretariat.
- The log should include: the name and signature of the individual receiving the copy; the initial of the IRB Secretary who made the copy; the number of copies made and the date that the copies were made

5.3.3. Copies requested by non-members of the IRB.

- Copies of IRB documents requested by non-members of the IRB (including the Secretary) can only be given after the permission from the Chairperson of the IRB and the person requesting for the document signs a confidentiality agreement form (AWHSC-IRB 03-004).
- Copies made for non-members of the IRB must be recorded in both the Log of Requests for Copies of IRB documents (AWHSC -IRB AF 01-026/01.0) and the log of Copies of the Original Documents (AWHSC -IRB AF 02-026/01.0).



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/026/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 5 of 9
9.3. Maintaining Confidentiality of IRB Documents	

5.4. File Log of Copies

- The Log of Copies of Original Documents must be stored with the original documents.
- The Log of Copies of Original Documents is not a confidential document and can be reviewed upon request.
- A Log of Copies of Original Documents must be maintained.

6. Glossary

Document	Documents mean the followings:
	• Study Protocols and related documents (such as case report forms, informed consents, diary forms, scientific documents, reports, records, expert opinions or reviews) • IRB documents (SOPs, meeting minutes, advice and decisions) • Correspondence (experts, auditors, study participants, etc.) of any forms, such as printed or written papers, hard copies, electronic mails (e-mail), faxes, audio or video tapes, etc.
Non-members of the IRB	• Any relevant person/persons who presently is/are not a member of the IRB such as authorities, monitors, reviewers, auditors, subjects, etc.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/026/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 6 of 9
9.3. Maintaining Confidentiality of IRB Documents	

7. References

3. World Health Organization, Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participant, 2011.
4. International Council for Harmonization of Technical Requirements for Pharmaceuticals for Human Use Guidance for Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) E6 (R2), 2016.

8. Annex



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/026/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 7 of 9
9.3. Maintaining Confidentiality of IRB Documents	

Annex 1: Log of Requests for Copies of IRB's Documents

(AWHSC -IRB AF 01-026/01.0)

#	Documents requested	# of Copies	Name of Recipient	Signature of Recipient	Secretariat Initials	Date



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/026/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 8 of 9
9.3. Maintaining Confidentiality of IRB Documents	

Annex 2: Log of Copies of Original Documents

(AWHSC -IRB AF 02-026/01.1)

Title of the Document:

.....

#	Documents requested	# of Copies	Name of Recipient	Signature of Recipient	Secretariat Initials	Date

Note: This log should be attached to the original documents.



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/026/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 9 of 9
9.3. Maintaining Confidentiality of IRB Documents	

Annex 3: Form for requesting copies of original document

AWHSC -IRB AF 03-026/01.1

Title of the document.....
.....

Protocol No.

Name of the person requesting the copies

I the undersigned person would like to request the copy (ies) of the above entitled
document in ----- copies for the purposes of -----

:.....
.....
:.....
.....

I shall maintain the confidentiality of the documents as per the requirements of AWHSC-IRB
SOP/026/01.0

Signature Date

Comments of the IRB chairperson

.....
:.....
.....

Approved ----- Disapproved -----

Signature Date



Table of Contents

1. Purpose	2
2. Scope	2
3. Responsibility	2
4. Flow chart	2
5. Detailed instructions	3
5.1. Call for an Audit/Inspection	3
5.2. Prepare for the visit	3
5.3. Welcome Auditor/Inspector	4
5.4. Correct the mistakes	4
5.5. Record the Audit/Inspection Event	4
6. Glossary	5
7. References	5
8. Annex	5
Annex 1: Audit and Inspection Checklist	6



1. Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to guide how to prepare for an audit or inspection of the IRB processes.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to every unit of the AWHSC-IRB.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the Secretariat/SERO, the Members, and the Chairperson of the IRB to perform all tasks according to the SOPs and to be well-prepared and available to answer questions during evaluation, audit or inspection visits of authorities and guests.

4. Flow chart

No.	Activity	Responsibility
1	Call for an Audit / Inspection ↓	IRB Chairperson / Director of the Institution
2	Prepare for the visit ↓	IRB Secretariat / Members and Chairperson
3	Welcome Auditor / Inspector ↓	IRB Secretariat / Members and Chairperson
4	Correct the mistakes ↓	IRB Secretariat / Members and Chairperson
5	Record the Event	IRB Secretariat

	Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB) 10.1. Auditing and Inspection of AWHSC-IRB	AWHSC-IRB SOP/027/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 3 of 6
--	---	---

5. Detailed instructions

1. Call for an Audit/Inspection

- Receive a notice of inspection visit
- The Chairperson informs the Secretariat / Director or Head of Institution
- The Chairperson alerts every unit to get ready

2. Prepare for the visit

- Get a checklist EPHI-IRB AF 01-028/02.0 (see Annex 1)
- Go through all steps on the list
- Note and comment on each part
- Emphasize on the studies with problems
- Check if all documents are labeled and kept in the right order for easy and quick search
- Check for any missing or disorganized records
 - ✓ Background and training records of IRB members
 - ✓ Application Submission Records
 - ✓ Protocol Assessment Records
 - ✓ Communication Records
 - ✓ Amendment Approval
 - ✓ Meeting Agenda, Minutes, Action letters
 - ✓ Active files
 - ✓ Continuing and Final reports
- Reserve a meeting room and all necessary facilities
- Review the IRB SOPs
- Make sure that no omission or deviation exists
- Make sure to have good reasons for any omission or deviation
- Inform IRB members about the inspection date if they are able to attend the audit/inspection meeting.



3. Welcome Auditor/Inspector

- The Chairperson or the Secretariat welcomes and accompanies the auditors/inspectors to the reserved meeting room
- Members and some key staff must also be present in the meeting room
- The conversation starts with the auditor/inspector stating the purpose of the visit and what kind of information and data are needed
- Answer questions of the auditors/inspectors clearly, politely and truthfully with confidence and straight to the point
- Find and get all information and files requested by the auditors/inspectors
- Take note of the comments, recommendation of them auditors/inspectors

4. Correct the mistakes

- Review comments and recommendations of the auditors/inspectors
- Write a report and have it approved by the Chairperson
- The Chairperson calls for the correction
- Allow appropriate time for correction and improvement process
- Carry an internal follow-up audit
- Evaluate the outcome
- Report the outcome to the Chair

5. Record the Audit/Inspection Event

- Keep record of the report on the audit/inspection meeting in the audit/inspection file
- Record also the findings from the internal follow-up audit in the internal audit file



6. Glossary

Audit	A systematic and independent examination of research approval activities and documents to determine whether the review and approval activities were conducted and data were recorded and accurately reported according to the SOPs, National Research Ethics guideline, GCP, Declaration of Helsinki and applicable regulatory requirements
Inspection	The act by a regulatory authority of conducting an official review of documents, facilities, records, and any other resources that are deemed by the authorities to be related to the clinical researches and that may be located at the research site, at the sponsor's and/or contract research organization's (CRO) facilities, Office of Ethics Committees, or at other establishments deemed appropriate by the regulatory authorities

7. References

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committees that Review Biomedical Research, 2000.
2. International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. World Health Organization, Surveying and Evaluating Ethical Review Practices, Feb. 2002

8. Annex



Annex 1: Audit and Inspection Checklist

(AWHSC -IRB AF 01-027/01.1)

☐ Internal Audit	☐ External Audit	☐ Inspection	Date
The date(s) which the audit/inspection has been agreed for:			
Will an interpreter be required? If yes, what arrangement has been made?			☐ Yes ☐ No
Review the SOPs and note details of any omissions or deviations, with reasons			
Check the files for the presence of all signed documents. Note any that are missing and actions taken. ➤ Background and training records of IRB members ➤ Application Submission Records ➤ Protocol Assessment Records ➤ Communication Records ➤ Amendment Approval ➤ Meeting Agenda, Minutes, Action letters ➤ Active files ➤ Continuing and Final reports			
Are any documents known to be missing from the study master file?			
Which personnel and members will be available? Give details of times and dates			
What arrangements are there in the event the auditor/inspector needs to make copies of documents?			
Completed by			Date.....



11. Glossary of Terms and Definitions

Table of Contents

1.	Purpose.....	2
2.	Scope.....	2
3.	Responsibility.....	2
4.	Flow chart.....	2
5.	Detailed instructions.....	3
5.1	Description of individual roles.....	3
5.2	Definition of Terms.....	5
5.3	Addition / Correction of terms.....	8
5.4	Approval of the addendum.....	8
6.	Glossary.....	8
7.	Annex	8
8.	Reference.....	8



11. Glossary of Terms and Definitions

1. Purpose

This SOP provides guidance regarding definition of terms, abbreviations and titles used by the AWHSC Institutional board (AWHSC-IRB) and its administrators to facilitate use and understanding of the AWHSC-IRB Standard Operating Procedures and activities

The definitions are divided into two sections:

- Description/definition of individual roles as used in the AWHSC-IRB SOPs
- Description/definition of terms and abbreviation used in the AWHSC-IRB SOPs

2. Scope

This section applies to all AWHSC-IRB SOPs and activities in addition to persons preparing and/or using the SOPs.

3. Responsibility

It is the responsibility of the AWHSC-IRB members to define or determine and approve the appropriateness of the description.

4. Flow chart

<u>No.</u>	<u>Activity</u>	<u>Responsibility</u>
1.	Description of individual titles and roles ↓	AWHSC-IRB members and Secretariat
2.	Definition of terms ↓	AWHSC-IRB members and Secretariat
3.	Addition / Correction of new titles and terms ↓	AWHSC-IRB members and Secretariat
4.	Approval of the new addendum	AWHSC-IRB members / Chairperson

5. Detailed instructions

5.1 Description of individual roles



11. Glossary of Terms and Definitions

Chairperson:

A member of the AWHSC-IRB who presides over a board meeting. Is responsible for expedited approvals on behalf of the Board.

Coordinator (Site):

The person at the study site who is responsible for managing the study. The Principal Investigator can also be the site coordinator and manager.

AWHSC-IRB

The AWHSC-IRB is a body established to review and monitor biomedical research involving human subjects. The primary purpose of such a review is the protection of the rights and welfare of the human subjects. In accordance with applicable national/international regulations, the AWHSC-IRB has the authority to approve, require modifications to, or disapprove research.

The AWHSC-IRB consists of a review board with at least seven regular members in addition to alternate members. Alternates are categorized and given equal status as regular members within the board (i.e., non-scientific or M.D, etc.). The composition of the membership must reflect a diversity of backgrounds sufficient to assure:

- expertise and experience to provide adequate review of research activities
- consideration of race, gender, and cultural backgrounds
- sensitivity to attitudes and concerns of the community and the patient population
- knowledge of applicable regulation, laws and standards of professional conduct and practice
- no member participates in the review process of any study project in which he/she has a conflicting interest
- no gender discrimination



11. Glossary of Terms and Definitions

AWHSC-IRB Members

- Non-employee individuals serving as regular and alternate members on AWHSC ERC (i.e., the AWHSC-IRB membership). Employees of AWHSC may serve as members of the AWHSC-IRB in their capacity as experts with the primary purpose of their membership in the AWHSC-IRB being human participant protection. The Director of AWHSC will be a member of the AWHSC-IRB. He/She will take responsibility to ensure that the administrative requirements for the services of the AWHSC-IRB are handled by the Institute.
- The AWHSC-IRB is constituted in accordance with the AWHSC-IRB membership requirements, and individuals are qualified to vote at a duly convened AWHSC-IRB meeting.

Investigational New Drug (IND)

Investigational new drug means a new substance, antibiotic drug, or biological product that is used in a clinical investigation. The term also includes a biological product that is used in vitro for diagnostic purposes. The terms “investigational drug” and “investigational new drug” are deemed to be synonymous for purposes of this part.

Non-Local AWHSC-IRB Review

Under certain circumstances, local review by an Institutional Review Board may not be available, e.g., research conducted by investigators affiliated with an institution without an IEC/ERC. Local regulatory agencies such as Drug Administration and Control Authority (DACA) may allow review of research by the AWHSC-IRB in locations other than where the research is to be performed. Therefore, the AWHSC-IRB may review studies that are not performed on-site as long as the requirements are met.

Principal Investigator

Individual responsible for implementing and coordinating an investigational Study.

Secretariat

The AWHSC-IRB staff who are responsible for the day-to-day administrative functions and duties which support the activities and responsibilities of the ERC members.

SOP Team

A selected group of the AWHSC-IRB members and administrative staff who oversee the preparation, review and periodic revision of the AWHSC-IRB SOPs

Vice Chairperson

A member of the AWHSC-IRB who assists the Chairperson as needed in conducting meetings and expedited review

Vulnerable subjects

A category of research participants that includes children, prisoners, pregnant women, handicapped or mentally disabled persons and economically or



11. Glossary of Terms and Definitions

educationally disadvantaged persons who are likely inclined to coercion or undue influence

5.2 Definition of Terms

Active study files

Supporting and approved documents, records containing communications, and reports that correspond to each active (current) study approved by the AWHSC-IRB

Administrative documents

Documents include official minutes of Board meetings as described in SOP, The AWHSC-IRB meeting minutes and voting records and the standard operating procedures, both historical files and Master Files as described in the SOP, SOP distribution, implementation and file maintenance.

Deviation

Any instance in which the current approved AWHSC-IRB SOP cannot be or has not been followed.

DSMB

For human intervention studies, a Data Safety Monitoring Board (DSMB) will be established according to WHO/TDR guidelines for DSMBs.

Expedited approval

An AWHSC-IRB approval granted only by the Chairperson of the AWHSC-IRB or a designated AWHSC-IRB member (not the full Board) for “minor” changes to current AWHSC-IRB-approved research activities and for research which involves no more than minimal risk

Final report

An obligatory review of study activities presented as a written report to the AWHSC-IRB after the last subject has completed all visits and all adverse experiences have been brought to appropriate resolution.

Complete, comprehensive written description of a completed trial that describes the experimental materials and statistical design, presentation and evaluation of the trial results and statistical analyses

Historical file

A document file which was effectively used in the past and presently became obsolete or expired, but still had to be kept in a file for reference purposes.

Inactive study files

Supporting and approved documents (protocols, protocol amendments, informed consents, advertisements, investigator and site information), records containing communication and correspondence with the investigator, and reports (including but not limited to progress reports, IND Safety Reports, reports of



Asrat Weldeyes health Science Campus Institutional Review Board (AWHSC-IRB)	AWHSC-IRB SOP/028/01.1 Effective Date: <u>30/11/2025</u> Page 6 of 8
11. Glossary of Terms and Definitions	

injuries to subjects, scientific evaluations) that correspond to each study approved by the AWHSC-IRB for which a final report has been reviewed and accepted in active study files are archived for a minimum of three years following the completion of the study. These files can be retrieved as needed.

Investigational medical device

A medical device which is the object of clinical research to determine its safety or effectiveness

Master files

Original copies of documents such as SOPs, guidelines, instruction, manual with real signatures of preparers, reviewers and authorized persons are systematically stored in secured cabinets with limited access.

Medical Device

A medical device is any health care product that does not achieve any of its intended purposes by chemical action or by being metabolized. Medical devices include items such as diagnostic test kits, crutches, electrodes, prescribed beds, pacemakers, arterial grafts, intra-ocular lenses, and orthopedic pins. Medical devices also include diagnostic aids such as reagents and test kits for *in vitro* diagnosis of disease and other conditions, (for example, pregnancy).

Minutes

The official record of events, activities, and actions taken on agenda items presented to a duly constituted (quorum present) independent board review meeting. The minutes identify fully each protocol and/ or activity and record the outcomes of each voting action. The board votes separately on each collective set or each item submitted for review: protocol, consent form, investigator, and advertisement(s). The record notes the number for, number against, the number of abstaining votes, and the reason for the abstention(s), without identifying the individual member's names.



11. Glossary of Terms and Definitions

New Study

A study protocol including the informed consent, investigator's qualifications, information on the drug or device and advertisements (if applicable) presented to the AWHSC-IRB for approval for the first time and not previously approved by the Committee. This includes re-application for those studies denied approval by the AWHSC-IRB

Non-compliance record

A list containing the identity of investigators who are considered by the AWHSC-IRB to be non-compliant with national/international regulations or who fail to respond to the AWHSC-IRB's requests, and the incident(s) justifying the reason for the determination of non-compliance

Non-significant Risk Device (NSR)

A non-significant risk device is an investigational device that does not pose a significant risk.

Progress Report

An ongoing review of each investigator's study activities presented as a written report to obtain extended approval for the study from the AWHSC-IRB. Generally, these reports are due annually with the AWHSC-IRB sending a written notification reminding the investigator of this obligation. More frequent reports may be requested at the discretion of the AWHSC-IRB.

Protocol Amendment

A change to the study protocol during the planning or course of the trial
The amendment is a foreseen change to the study plan that requires formal approval by the sponsor.

Quorum

Attendance required to arrive at a decision at any convened meeting of the ERC. If 7 is the minimum number of members prescribed in the SOP, 5 of the regular (or alternate) members, including at least one physician and one layperson constitute.



11. Glossary of Terms and Definitions

A quorum and should be maintained throughout the discussions and voting portions of the meeting.

Significant Risk Device (SR)

A significant risk device is an investigational device that: (1) is intended as an implant and presents a potential for serious risk to the health, safety, or welfare of the subject, (2) is purported or represented to be for a use in supporting or sustaining human life and presents a potential for serious risk to the health, safety, or welfare of the subject, (3) is for a use of substantial importance in diagnosing, curing, mitigating, or treating disease, or otherwise preventing impairment of human health and presents a potential for serious risk to the health, safety, or welfare of the subject, or (4) otherwise presents a potential for serious risk to the health, safety, or welfare of the participants.

5.3. Addition / Correction of terms

- ☐ Members are encouraged to propose any additional terms or make correction of any terms defined in this SOP at any time, if he/she feels clarification should be made.
- ☐ Write your proposal.
- ☐ Submit your proposal to the AWHSC-IRB secretariat.

5.4. Approval of the addendum

- The AWHSC-IRB secretariat shall bring the proposal to a meeting.
- The proposal shall be discussed for further opinion.
- Agreement and approval shall be made at the meeting.

6. Glossary

7. ANNEX

8. Reference

1. World Health Organization, Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committees that Review Biomedical Research, 2000
2. \ International Conference on Harmonization, Guidance on Good Clinical Practice (ICH GCP) 1996.
3. Operational Guideline for the Establishment and Functioning of Data and Safety Monitoring Board (www.who.int/tdr/publications/publications/pdf/operat_guidelines.pdf)